

The Architecture of *Grace*

Book 4 · The Façade

*A Complete Year-Long SEL Curriculum in Forgiveness, Grace, and
Self-Compassion*

GRADES 9 · 10 · TEACHER MASTER EDITION

SECULAR · RESEARCH-GROUNDED · TRAUMA-INFORMED · CASEL-ALIGNED

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BOOK FOUR

Architecture of Grace
The Façade
Teacher Master Edition

SECULAR · RESEARCH-GROUNDED · TRAUMA-
INFORMED · CASEL-ALIGNED

TIER 1 UNIVERSAL SEL · 28 LESSONS ACROSS 4 UNITS

CONFIDENTIAL · FOR DISTRICT REVIEW AND
EDUCATOR USE ONLY

INSIDE THIS BOOK

Four Sections

HOW TO USE ·		28 LESSONS · 4	
COLOR & ICON KEY · SAFETY PROTOCOLS · PACING CALENDAR · COUNSELOR SCHEDULE · YEAR-START SCRIPT · CLASSROOM COMPACT		UNITS · DIRECT INSTRUCTION EMBEDDED · SCENARIO CARDS · WORKSHEETS · ANCHOR CHARTS · IN-LESSON SCANS	
SECTION THREE Assessment Suite Reference to standalone Assessment & Outcome Measurement Suite · Instruments · Administration timing		SECTION FOUR Reference & Compliance Framing Essay · Admin Guide · Legal & Clinical · Counselor Calendar · Inclusive Delivery · Family Materials · Glossary	

Daily-use materials at the front · occasional reference at the back

CONTENTS

Table of Contents

SECTION ONE

Teacher Launch Pack

- 1.1 How to Use This Master Document
- 1.2 Color & Icon Key
- 1.3 Safety Protocols — Quick Reference
- 1.4 Year-at-a-Glance Pacing Calendar
- 1.5 Counselor Coordination — Scheduling Summary
- 1.6 Year-Start Student Introduction Script
- 1.7 Classroom Compact Guide
- 1.8 Substitute Teacher Protocol
- 1.9 Student Disclosure Protocol — Quick Reference
- 1.10 Grade Band Overview

SECTION TWO

The Lessons · 28 Lessons across 4 Units

Unit 1 The Curated Self — Identity August–October

- L1 Beyond the Brand · ★ PPRA
- L2 The Social Battery · ★ PPRA
- L3 The Integrity Anchor
- L4 Authenticity in Action
- L5 The Groupthink Trap
- L6 Silencing the Noise
- L7 Unit Reflection — the Identity Shield

Unit 2 Resilience Through Self-Kindness — Self-Compassion November–December

- L1 The Perfectionism Weight · ★ PPRA
- L2 The 'not Yet' Lens
- L3 Sustainable Accountability · ★ PPRA
- L4 Reclaiming the Narrative
- L5 Self-care vs. Self-indulgence
- L6 The Compassionate Witness · ★ PPRA
- L7 The Backpack Audit · ★★ COUNSELOR REQUIRED

Unit 3 Conflict & Context — Empathy & Forgiving Others January–March

- L1 Conflict As Information
- L2 FORGIVENESS vs. RECONCILIATION · ★ PPRA
- L3 The Boundary of Peace · ★ PPRA
- L4 CALLING IN vs. CALLING OUT
- L5 Contextual Empathy · ★ PPRA
- L6 The Grace Challenge
- L7 Unit Reflection — the Grace Audit

Unit 4 Community & Legacy — From Grace to Grace Culture April–June

- L1** What Is Grace Culture?
- L2** Charitable Interpretation
- L3** Bearing Witness
- L4** Grace Under Pressure
- L5** The Grace Audit — Community Scale
- L6** The Grace Legacy
- L7** Year-end Celebration — the Class Legacy

SECTION THREE

Assessment Suite Reference

- 3.1** Grade-Band Instruments
- 3.2** Administration Timing
- 3.3** Who Receives Which Instrument
- 3.4** Built-In Assessment Tools

SECTION FOUR

Reference & Compliance

- 4.1** Framing Essay
- 4.2** Quick Start Guide for Administrators
- 4.3** Executive Summary
- 4.4** Legal & Clinical Compliance
- 4.5** Counselor Integration Calendar
- 4.6** Inclusive Delivery — IEP / SpEd / ELL
- 4.7** Family Engagement Materials — Pre-Year Letter · Unit Transition Letters · Family Grace Guide · Family Grace Audit · Final Reflection · Closing Words · Administrative Forms (PPRA / Opt-Out / District Checklist)
- 4.8** Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary

SECTION FIVE

Professional Development

- 5.1** Professional Development Overview
- 5.2** Half-Day Pre-Year Module
- 5.3** Mid-Year Session
- 5.4** Slide Outline
- 5.5** Participant One-Pager

SECTION ONE

Teacher Launch Pack

Daily-Use Materials · Read Before Lesson 1

1.1 How to Use This Master Document

This document is your single source of truth for delivering Architecture of Grace, Book Four: The Façade to Grades 9 and 10. Everything you need — lesson scripts, worksheets, scenario cards, anchor charts, safety protocols, and reference materials — is in one place, organized so the materials you use daily are at the front, and the materials you reference occasionally are at the back.

WHAT IS IN EVERY LESSON

Opening Review — A 2-minute structured bridge from the previous lesson activating prior knowledge.

Direct Instruction — Scripted instructional sequence with timed steps. Embedded after the Opening Review.

Anchor Charts — Described at each lesson. Draw on chart paper before class. Post on the day indicated. Keep posted all year.

Scenario Cards — Two cards per lesson, embedded directly where they are used.

Worksheets — Embedded at the end of the lesson where distributed. Reproducible. Never collected unless student chooses.

Exit Ticket & Teacher Reflection — Closing formative check and private teacher prompt at every lesson.

In-Lesson Scan — Embedded inline at the precise activity where observation matters. Note privately.

Safety Check — Appears before every elevated and highest-risk lesson. Complete before delivering.

GRADE-BAND NOTE · GRADES 9 · 10

Book 4 operates in the Social Agency & Emotional Regulation register. Grades 9 and 10 are the years of identity reconstruction under social pressure — where the curated digital self meets the authentic interior, where peer hierarchies reorganize, and where the prefrontal cortex is still under active construction. Lessons run 45–55 minutes. The Identity Shield (U1 L7), the Backpack Audit (U2 L7), and the Class Legacy (U4 L7) are the three signature artifacts of the Book 4 year — they belong to the student and travel with them.

1.2 Color & Icon Key

Each visual cue in this curriculum has a consistent meaning. Read this key once and return to it as needed.

Opening Review	TEAL	2-minute structured bridge activating prior knowledge from the last lesson.
Direct Instruction	TEAL	Scripted step-by-step instructional sequence with timed steps. Placed after Opening Review.
Anchor Chart	TEAL	Described at each lesson. Draw on chart paper or display before class. Keep posted all year.
Scenario Cards	PURPLE	Embedded at point of use. Two cards per lesson. Print and laminate before Unit 1.
Worksheet	GOLD	Reproducible student worksheet. Embedded at end of distributing lesson. Never collected unless student chooses.
Exit Ticket & Teacher Reflection	GREEN	Closing formative check and private teacher prompt. Every lesson.
In-Lesson Scan	AMBER	Placed inline at the specific activity it monitors. Watch for named behaviors. Note privately. Do not intervene publicly.
Safety Check	RED	Pre-lesson checklist. Complete before delivering any risk-flagged lesson. Non-negotiable.
★ ★ HIGHEST RISK	RED BANNER	Counselor must be physically on-site the full lesson. No exceptions. No substitutes.
★ HIGH / ELEVATED RISK	AMBER BANNER	Counselor on-site or co-facilitating. Minimum one week advance notice. No pre-break scheduling.
PPRA-Designated	PURPLE NOTE	Parental notification required. All standard opt-out protocols apply. See Section 4 — Legal & Clinical Compliance.
Family Connection	GOLD ITALIC	Conversation-starter sent home after specified lessons. Never homework. Never required.

1.3 Safety Protocols — Quick Reference

Read before Lesson 1. Return before every risk-flagged lesson.

★★ HIGHEST RISK · COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE, FULL LESSON · NO EXCEPTIONS

U2 L7 · The Backpack Audit

★ HIGH / ELEVATED RISK · COUNSELOR ON-SITE OR CO-FACILITATING

U1 L1 · Beyond the Brand **U1 L2** · The Social Battery **U2 L1** · The Perfectionism Weight **U2 L3** · Sustainable Accountability **U2 L6** · The Compassionate Witness **U3 L2** · FORGIVENESS vs. RECONCILIATION **U3 L3** · The Boundary of Peace **U3 L5** · Contextual Empathy

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · APPLIES TO ALL LESSONS

1. Stop the lesson immediately. **2.** Activate your school's mandatory disclosure protocol. **3.** Contact the counselor now — not after class. **4.** Do not leave the student alone. **5.** Do not attempt to assess risk yourself. **6.** Document in writing the same day. See **Section 4** — Legal & Clinical Compliance, Student Disclosure Protocol (Types 1–4) for the complete protocol.

CRISIS RESOURCES · POST BEFORE FIRST HIGHEST-RISK LESSON · KEEP POSTED THROUGH YEAR-END

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Call or text **988 Crisis Text Line** · Text **HOME** to **741741 The Trevor Project** · 1-866-488-7386 or text **START** to 678-678 (LGBTQ+ youth) **AFSP** · afsp.org (safe messaging guidelines)

1.4 Year-at-a-Glance Pacing Calendar

Each lesson runs 45–55 min. Total instructional time: 28 lessons across 4 units, approximately 24–30 contact hours over the school year.

IDENTITY	SELF-COMPASSION	EMPATHY FORGIVING OTHERS	FROM GRACE TO GRACE CULTURE
August–October 7 Lessons	November–December 7 Lessons	January–March 7 Lessons	April–June 7 Lessons

ASSESSMENT TIMING

Pre-Assessment · Administer in the first week of the year — before Unit 1 Lesson 1. **Post-Assessment** · Administer after Unit 4 Lesson 7. **Family Surveys** · Distribute mid-year and year-end. See Section 3.

1.5 Counselor Coordination — Scheduling Summary

Block these dates on the counselor's calendar before Unit 1 Lesson 1 is delivered. No exceptions. The detailed Master Counselor Coordination Calendar — with full scheduling constraints, AFSP guidance, and pre-/post-lesson protocols — lives in Section 4.

STANDING COORDINATION REQUIREMENTS

BEFORE YEAR Counselor receives curriculum binder. Reads disclosure protocol. Attends half-day PD.

BEFORE U1 L1 Counselor + delivering teacher meet to review disclosure protocol, confirm availability for ★ and ★★ dates, and establish same-day communication channel. **MID-YEAR** Counselor attends mid-year PD session. Confirms scheduling for remaining ★★ lessons. **YEAR-END** Counselor + teacher year-end debrief within 5 school days. Identify students who may benefit from continued contact over summer.

1.6 Year-Start Student Introduction Script

Use on the first day of **Unit 1 Lesson 1** — before distributing any materials. Read it aloud or say it in your own voice. Do not skip it. The first three minutes set the register for the entire year.

YEAR-START SCRIPT · READ ON DAY ONE

[OPENING] This year, in addition to your other coursework, we are going to spend some time on something that is not usually taught in school: how to build a life that cannot be broken by shame. This is not a class about feelings. It is not a class where you have to share things you don't want to share. It is a class about giving you tools — practical, structural tools — that adults wish they had been given when they were your age. [FRAME] Three things to know before we begin. First — your journal is yours. Nothing you write in it will be graded. Nothing will be read by me unless you choose to show me. The only exception is if something you share suggests you are in danger or someone else is. In that case, I am required by law to make sure you get help. Second — the Reflection Pass. There are some lessons this year where you may decide you do not want to participate in a specific activity. That is your right. The Reflection Pass — that small card — sits at your seat for those lessons. You can use it without explanation. No one will ask why. There is no penalty. Third — this is not therapy. I am not a therapist. If something comes up this year that feels too big for a journal — too big for a classroom — there is a counselor in this building whose job it is to help. I will help you find them. Asking for help is not failure. [CLOSING] Last thing. The questions in this curriculum are real questions. They are the questions adults are still trying to answer at fifty. You will not finish this year having answered them. That is not the goal. The goal is to give you the language, the practices, and the tools so that when life asks these questions of you — and it will — you have already started thinking about them. Let's begin.

1.7 Classroom Compact Guide

Co-create this compact with students within the first two weeks. Post it on the wall. Refer back to it whenever necessary — especially before risk-flagged lessons. This is the agreement that makes the curriculum's safety promises operational.

WHAT IS SAID HERE, STAYS HERE.

Personal disclosures by classmates are not repeated outside this room — not in hallways, not in group chats, not at home.

YOU CAN PASS.

Any student may decline to share at any moment. 'Pass' is a complete sentence. The Reflection Pass extends this to whole activities.

NO FIXING.

When a classmate shares something difficult, our job is not to fix it, advise them, or suggest solutions. Our job is to witness.

NO COMPARING.

We do not rank suffering. Every weight in this room is real to the person carrying it.

CONFIDENTIALITY HAS ONE LIMIT.

If something a student shares suggests danger to themselves or others, the teacher must follow safety protocols. This is the law and a sign of care, not a betrayal.

THE TEACHER IS IN THIS WITH US.

The teacher participates in the framework — applying the same Compassionate Witness, the same self-compassion, the same grace practices to themselves.

1.8 Substitute Teacher Protocol

The Architecture of Grace is not delivered by substitute teachers. The relational infrastructure of the curriculum requires a known adult holding the room. When the regular teacher is absent, follow this protocol:

REGULAR SEL DAY WITH SUBSTITUTE

Substitute does not deliver the SEL lesson. The lesson is rescheduled to the next regular SEL period.

★ PPRA LESSON WITH SUBSTITUTE

Reschedule the lesson. Do not deliver. Notify the principal of the rescheduled date. PPRA notification windows still apply.

★★ HIGHEST-RISK LESSON WITH SUBSTITUTE

Reschedule the lesson — full stop. Never deliver a ★★ lesson via substitute. Re-confirm counselor on-site availability for the rescheduled date.

MID-UNIT TEACHER TRANSITION (LONG-TERM SUB OR NEW TEACHER)

Pause the curriculum until the new teacher has completed the half-day PD module and the disclosure protocol training.

1.9 Student Disclosure Protocol — Quick Reference

REQUIRED READING

This curriculum will generate disclosure. The full 6-Step Protocol and Post-Disclosure Re-Entry Protocol live in Section 4. This page is for at-a-glance reference.

TYPE 1 · EMOTIONAL RESONANCE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE Tearful, quiet, visibly moved. Not disclosing a specific incident. **REQUIRED RESPONSE** Acknowledge warmly. Monitor across unit.

TYPE 2 · PERSONAL SHARE

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE Voluntarily shares a past experience connected to the lesson. Not a current safety concern. **REQUIRED RESPONSE** Thank them. Follow up privately after class.

TYPE 3 · PAST HARM

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE Significant past harm (abuse, loss, family violence) not currently active. **REQUIRED RESPONSE** Brief counselor same day. Counselor follow-up.

TYPE 4 · ACTIVE SAFETY CONCERN

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE Current harm, self-harm, suicidal ideation, or threat to others. **REQUIRED RESPONSE** STOP. Invoke 6-Step Disclosure Protocol. Mandatory reporting. Do not leave student alone.

1.10 **Grade Band Overview — Book Four: The Façade**

GRADE BAND	Grades 9 and 10
DURATION	Full academic year · 28 lessons across 4 units
LESSONS PER UNIT	7 lessons · 45–55 min each
PRIMARY APPROACH	Socratic seminar · Reflective journaling · Identity work · Peer dynamics
CASEL ALIGNMENT	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management · Social Awareness · Relationship Skills · Responsible Decision-Making
SIGNATURE ARTIFACTS	The Identity Shield (U1 L7) · The Backpack Audit (U2 L7) · The Class Legacy (U4 L7)

DEVELOPMENTAL CONTEXT

Grades 9 and 10 are — from the inside — among the most disorienting years of a human life. The social landscape has reconfigured entirely from middle school. The peer group that defined identity in 7th grade may have dissolved, stratified, or become actively hostile. The freshman who walked into ninth grade with a clear sense of who they were in 8th grade often finds, by October, that the identity they carried did not transfer.

This is developmentally normal. It is also genuinely destabilizing. The Internal Critic — the self-evaluating voice that the Architecture of Grace has been developing tools to address since Kindergarten — is, in high school, at the peak of its developmental power. The adolescent brain is calibrated, by evolutionary design, for social threat detection. The prefrontal cortex will not reach full development until age 25.



SECTION TWO

The Lessons

28 Lessons · 4 Units · Direct Instruction Embedded

BOOK 4

UNIT 1

THE CURATED SELF

IDENTITY

BEYOND THE BRAND	THE GROUPTHINK TRAP
L2 The Social Battery	L6 Silencing the Noise
L3 The Integrity Anchor	L7 Unit Reflection — the Identity Shield
L4 Authenticity in Action	

Beyond the Brand

45–50 min · August Week 1 · First lesson of the year

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students explain the gap between the curated persona and the authentic self and identify one specific cost they personally pay to maintain a curated performance.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · August Week 1 · First lesson of the year
KEY VOCABULARY	curated self · authentic self · performance tax · persona · gap · integrity · self-monitoring
MATERIALS	Student journals · Anchor chart paper · Markers · Scenario Cards B4-1A and B4-1B
OPENING REVIEW	None — first lesson of year. Deliver Year-Start Introduction Protocol first.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

PPRA-designated. Psychological self-examination — students examine the gap between public persona and private self. Advance parental notification required (minimum 10 days prior). Standard 3-tier opt-out protocols apply. Brief counselor at least 2 days before delivery. Do not ask students to share their curated vs. authentic gap with the whole class — journal first, always.

ANCHOR CHART

CURATED SELF FILTERED · SELECTED PERFORMED FOR AN AUDIENCE WHAT YOU SHOW	AUTHENTIC SELF UNFILTERED · PRIVATE COSTLY TO REVEAL WHAT IS ACTUALLY TRUE
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OPENING RITUAL

3 minutes · Year-Start Version 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds. Do not fill it.] 'This is how this class begins. Every time. Not because it is a routine for its own sake — because what this class asks of you takes a moment to actually arrive for. You will understand why by the end of today.' [Post the essential question on the board: 'Who are you when no one is watching?'] 'That is the question this unit is built around. Not who you perform for other people. Not who your applications say you are. Who are you when the audience is gone? Today we start looking at that gap — and what it costs to maintain it.'

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the journal prompt in Step 2, a student who writes immediately, intensely, and at length — clearly accessing well-developed and familiar content without pausing. **MAY SIGNAL** This student has a large, established gap and may be relieved to have language for it — or activated by naming it directly. A well-rehearsed gap at 9–10 is often accompanied by significant shame material underneath. **ACTION** Note privately. Do not acknowledge in class. Flag for counselor awareness before U2-L7 (Backpack Audit).

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who stares at the page for the full time and leaves it blank. **MAY SIGNAL** Either: the gap is so defended that even a private prompt feels dangerous. Or: genuine alignment between curated and authentic selves (less common at this age). **ACTION** Do not approach during the lesson. After class: 'How did today feel for you?' A low-pressure check-in opens more than any direct question.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-1A and B4-1B B4-1A (KAMERON): Whole-class model. All four discussion questions. Key facilitation: 'His best friend says it's all technically true — can something be factually accurate and still misrepresent you?'

B4-1B (PRIYA): Pairs. Key facilitation: 'What has Priya practiced so thoroughly she can no longer access what lies beneath it?' This is the Performance Tax at its most acute.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The gap between my curated self and my authentic self right now is _____. The performance tax I pay for it shows up as _____. One thing I would have more of if the gap were smaller is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

First lesson: resist the urge to push personal depth. Scenario cards carry the emotional weight. The journal prompts are where the real work happens — protect them even if everything else runs short. Total composure about the performance-authenticity gap content is almost always protective at this age — note students who appear entirely unaffected. The Performance Tax is not abstract for students managing identity gaps around race, sexuality, immigration status, or family circumstances — hold that awareness even if it is not named today.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

★ **PRA LESSON** Dear Families, Today in Architecture of Grace, your student examined the concept of the **curated self** — the gap between the identity we perform for others and who we actually are. Using scenario cards, students explored what it costs to maintain a version of yourself that is technically accurate but not fully honest. No student was asked to disclose personal information. All reflection was private and journal-based. A conversation-starter that might open this naturally: "Is there a version of you that people see that feels different from how you actually are inside?" You do not need to pursue this if your student isn't ready. The fact that you asked it — and meant it — is enough.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

THE CURATED SELF — NAME THE GAP

10 MIN

'Open your phones for ten seconds. Look at your profile photo or your most recent public post.' [10 second pause.] 'Now: is the person in that image the same person who woke up this morning? Same mood? Same worries? Same doubts?' [Take 2–3 student responses — brief, no pressure.] 'We all manage how we appear. That is not dishonesty — that is being human. The question is not whether you have a gap between your curated and authentic self. The question is: what is it costing you?' Point to the anchor chart. 'This curriculum calls that cost the Performance Tax. Today we start measuring yours.'

2

THE PERFORMANCE TAX — HOW IT WORKS

8 MIN

Write on board: $TAX = GAP \times TIME$. 'The performance tax is real and measurable. Psychologists call the underlying mechanism self-monitoring: the cognitive effort of continuously tracking how you appear across every context. It runs on working memory — the same working memory you use for everything else that matters. The wider your gap, and the longer you maintain it, the more it consumes.' [Pause.] 'Kameron in the scenario card is anxious and sometimes lonely at home. His curated self is confident and effortlessly social. That gap is not free.' Students journal 3 minutes privately: 'Where am I spending the most performance energy right now? What would I have more of if that gap were smaller?' Do not ask for sharing.

3

IS THE GAP WORTH IT?

7 MIN

'Not all curation is a problem. Choosing what to share with an employer is different from performing a false identity for your closest friends. The question is not whether you adjust your presentation — you do, and so does everyone. The question is whether the gap is costing you more than it is giving you.' Write on board: **SIGNAL QUESTION** — 'Is the gap costing you more than it is giving you?' 'This is not a yes or no question you answer today. It is a question you carry through this unit.' Students write privately: 'One thing my curated self shows that my authentic self doesn't fully believe is ____.' Private. Not shared.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-1A

BEYOND THE BRAND

THE SITUATION

Kameron runs a school Instagram account with 2,300 followers. His posts are perfectly lit, captioned with wit, and carefully curated to show him as confident, funny, and effortlessly social. At home he is often anxious, sometimes lonely, and spends hours crafting posts that look spontaneous. His best friend — someone who has known him since fifth grade — says: 'I barely recognize you on there. It's weird because it's all technically true, but it doesn't feel like you.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the gap between Kameron's curated self and his authentic self — and what is it costing him? The best friend says 'it's all technically true.' Can something be factually accurate and still misrepresent you? How? Kameron's posts show the highlights. What is systematically absent? Is there a version of showing up online that is both genuine and selective? Where is the line? **THE PERFORMANCE TAX** Sustained self-monitoring — constantly tracking how you appear — consumes cognitive and emotional energy. The performance tax is real: the wider the gap between the curated self and the authentic self, the heavier the toll. The question is not whether we present differently in different contexts — that is human. The question is whether the gap is costing you more than it is giving you.

B4-1B**BEYOND THE BRAND****THE SITUATION**

In a college interview, Priya is asked: 'Tell me something about yourself that isn't on your application.' She freezes. Her application is excellent — every accomplishment, activity, and honor documented. But in that moment she realizes she doesn't know how to answer because every version of herself she has practiced presenting is achievement-based. The interviewer smiles: 'Take your time. There's no wrong answer.' Priya's mind is blank. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What has Priya practiced so thoroughly that she can no longer access what lies beneath it? Why is 'tell me something about yourself' so much harder than 'here are my accomplishments'? What would Priya say if the question was: 'What do you love that you have never put on an application?' Priya's application tells the interviewer what she has done. What would it take to tell them who she is? **THE HIGHLIGHT REEL VS. THE REAL SELF** The highlight reel is not dishonest — it is selective. But over time, if we practice the highlight reel long enough, we can lose fluent access to what lies beneath it. Identity is not a résumé. The architecture of who you are is built from your values, your contradictions, your private joys, and your genuine struggles — not your credentials alone.

The Social Battery

45–50 min · August Week 2

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students identify whether they are introvert-dominant or extrovert-dominant in social energy and name two specific environments that charge vs. drain their battery.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · August Week 2
KEY VOCABULARY	social battery · introversion · extroversion · authentic engagement · self-monitoring · energy-charging · energy-draining
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the Performance Tax — what is it?' [Student answer.] 'Today: what does that performance run on — and what happens when it hits zero?'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

PPRA-designated. Self-assessment of social-emotional functioning. Standard opt-out protocols apply. Brief counselor at least 2 days before delivery. Students who identify school as universally draining across all contexts warrant private follow-up — note for counselor awareness.

ANCHOR CHART

CHARGES YOUR BATTERY
SOLITUDE OR SMALL TRUSTED GROUPS DEEP 1:1 CONVERSATIONS CREATIVE OR INDEPENDENT WORK BEING IN YOUR ELEMENT

DRAINS YOUR BATTERY LARGE SOCIAL PERFORMANCES SUSTAINED SURFACE-LEVEL INTERACTION ENVIRONMENTS REQUIRING CONSTANT SELF-MONITORING BEING 'ON' FOR EXTENDED PERIODS

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson we named the Performance Tax. Today: what does that performance run on? Where does the energy come from — and what happens when the battery hits zero?' [Post: 'What charges you — and what drains you — and are you honoring that knowledge?']

UNIT 1 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the Charges/Drains journal in Step 1, a student who lists school in almost every drain category — classroom, hallway, lunch, extracurriculars — with no school-based charge source at all. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be experiencing significant social exhaustion or performance anxiety at school. A battery consistently depleted across the full school environment with no institutional charge source is a wellbeing concern. **ACTION** Note privately. After class: 'I noticed today that school feels draining across a lot of different contexts for you. That's important to know — I'd like to check in with you this week.' Brief counselor if the pattern appears in the Tier 2 worksheet as well.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-2A and B4-2B B4-2A (DIEGO): Whole-class. Key facilitation: 'Diego says he's not antisocial — what distinction is he making, and is he right?' B4-2B (FATIMA AND ZOE): Pairs. Key: 'What would it look like for both of them to honor their battery needs without making the other feel deficient?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"My social battery charges when I _____. It drains most when I _____. One environment I have been misreading — assuming something about a person there that the battery concept reframes — is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most important teaching move: resist valorizing either introversion or extroversion — both are neutral. Watch for students who list school as universally draining — this is a wellbeing signal worth a counselor brief if it also appears in the worksheet. The Misread Problem has an equity dimension: students managing code-switching or cultural performance carry a higher and less-acknowledged performance tax. Name this implicitly in the debrief.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

★ PPRA LESSON Dear Families, Today students explored the Social Battery — a framework for understanding the energy available for genuine social engagement, and what charges or drains it. Students examined how introverted and extroverted patterns are neither flaws nor virtues, but information about how a person is wired. A conversation-starter: "When you've had a full day of being around people, what do you need afterward to feel like yourself again?" This question works regardless of where your student falls on the introvert/extrovert spectrum. There is no correct answer — the goal is simply for them to know their own.

1 WHAT THE BATTERY IS — AND WHAT IT IS NOT

8 MIN

Draw a battery on the board. 'The social battery is not a metaphor for shyness. It measures authentic engagement capacity — the energy available for genuine connection rather than performance. Some environments charge it — they require less performance and more genuine connection. Others drain it — they require sustained self-monitoring.' Students list two columns privately: Charges / Drains. 3 minutes. Private.

2 INTROVERT / EXTROVERT — THE ACTUAL DISTINCTION

10 MIN

'Research on introversion and extroversion shows something more specific than the popular version. Introvert-dominant people charge in lower-stimulation environments — often solitude or small groups. Extrovert-dominant people charge in higher-stimulation social environments. Neither is better. And crucially: you can be an extrovert who is completely drained by performance-heavy environments — because performance and genuine connection are not the same thing.' Write: INTROVERT dominant → charges in LOW stimulation. EXTROVERT dominant → charges in HIGH stimulation. Pairs: 'Where do you land — and does it match what actually charges and drains you?'

3 THE MISREAD PROBLEM — AND THE GRACE EXTENSION

7 MIN

'Fatima thinks Zoe is unfriendly. Zoe thinks Fatima is exhausting. Neither is correct — they are managing different batteries and using their own battery as the universal standard. The skill: knowing your own battery, honoring it without judgment, and extending the same courtesy to people whose batteries work differently.' Pairs: 'Name one person whose battery seems to work very differently from yours. What have you assumed about them that this reframes?'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-2A

THE SOCIAL BATTERY

THE SITUATION

After three weeks of orientation activities, college fairs, and mandatory social events, Diego finds himself dreading lunch. He likes his classmates. He is genuinely interested in them. But he has been 'on' — attentive, engaged, witty — for so long that he can barely carry a conversation. He starts eating in a bathroom stall with headphones in. 'I'm not antisocial,' he tells himself. 'I'm just empty.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Diego's social battery doing — and what does his behavior suggest about what charges it? Diego says 'I'm not antisocial.' What is the distinction he is making — and is he right? What environments or interactions appear to charge Diego's battery versus drain it? What would it mean for Diego to honor his battery's state rather than override it? **THE SOCIAL BATTERY** The Social Battery is a metaphor for the energy available for authentic social engagement. Some environments charge it — they require less performance and more genuine connection. Others drain it — they require sustained monitoring of how you appear. Knowing which is which is not a luxury — it is data you need to function well over time.

B4-2B

THE SOCIAL BATTERY

THE SITUATION

Fatima gets energy from being around people. After a long weekend alone studying, she feels depleted and slightly gray. Her roommate Zoe is the opposite — a long social weekend leaves Zoe quiet, needing hours of solo time to return to herself. Both of them are confused by the other. Fatima thinks Zoe is unfriendly. Zoe thinks Fatima is exhausting. Neither is wrong about themselves. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What does Fatima's battery charge on — and what drains Zoe's? Why does neither experience invalidate the other? Fatima interprets Zoe's withdrawal as unfriendliness. What is she missing? Zoe interprets Fatima's energy as exhausting. What is she missing? What would it look like for both of them to honor their own battery needs without making the other feel deficient? **CHARGING VS. DRAINING** There is no correct social battery configuration. What matters is knowing your own — and not using your battery's needs as a judgment about others' character. Fatima is not shallow for needing social connection. Zoe is not antisocial for needing solitude. Both are managing their own authentic selves as best they know how.

The Integrity Anchor

45–50 min · August Week 3

OBJECTIVE	Students name three personal non-negotiable values and demonstrate how an integrity anchor holds without requiring moral pressure on others.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting) · Responsible Decision-Making (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · August Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	integrity anchor · non-negotiable · values · quiet integrity · anchor test · internal standard
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the Social Battery. Quick — one environment that charges yours?' [Answer.] 'Today: when social pressure pushes hard enough to override even a charged battery — what holds you steady?'

ANCHOR CHART

THE INTEGRITY ANCHOR A RULE: Imposed from outside. Holds because of consequences. AN ANCHOR: Examined from inside. Holds because you chose it. CHARACTERISTICS: Holds quietly. Does not announce itself. Does not require others to change. Simply tells you where your own line is. THE ANCHOR TEST: 'Does this hold when the cost of living it is real and immediate?' An anchor that only holds when it is costless is not an anchor. It is a preference. POST: Before class. KEEP: All of Unit 1 and beyond — the Integrity Anchor is PERMANENT.

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: the Social Battery — what charges it, what drains it. Today: when everything is loud and the pressure is real — what holds you in place?' [Post: 'What holds you steady when social pressure pushes — and does it require anyone else to change?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the pair sharing in Step 2, a student who cannot name a single genuine anchor — who lists only rules or things others expect, with no internally-chosen value. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may not yet have examined their values as genuinely their own — operating primarily from external rules or social expectations. Developmentally understandable at 9–10, not a clinical signal. Worth noting for Unit 2 context — students lacking internal anchors tend to be more dependent on external validation. **ACTION** In the worksheet, prompt more gently: 'Is there anything you would hold onto even if you were the only one who cared about it?'

UNIT 1 · LESSON 3 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-3A and B4-3B B4-3A (MARCUS): Whole-class. Key: 'What is Marcus's anchor — and how does it hold without moralizing at others?' The insight: the anchor is specific, not abstract. B4-3B (YUSUF): Pairs. Key: 'Is Yusuf's position principled or convenient? How would you tell the difference?' This is the Anchor Test in practice.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"My three integrity anchors are ___, ___, and ___. The one most tested right now is ___. What held it in place was ___. The Anchor Test question I will carry into this week is ___." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most important move: push from abstract values ('honesty,' 'kindness') toward specific behavioral anchors ('I will not represent someone else's work as mine'). Abstract values do not function as anchors under pressure — they are too easy to rationalize around. Students who list only rules or externally-imposed standards have not yet developed genuine internal anchors. Normal at 9–10 — note for Unit 2 context. The Integrity Anchor is permanent — stays up for the rest of the year.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

RULE VS. ANCHOR — THE CORE DISTINCTION

8 MIN

'Marcus doesn't use AI to cheat on homework — not because of the rules, but because he wants to actually know the material. That is the difference between a rule and an anchor.' Write: RULE = external / consequence-driven. ANCHOR = internal / value-driven. 'A rule holds because something bad happens if you break it. An anchor holds because breaking it means becoming someone you don't want to be.' Students journal 3 minutes: 'Name three things you would not compromise even under real social pressure. Not rules — not what you're supposed to say. What is actually true for you right now?' Private.

2

THE QUIET ANCHOR — HOW IT WORKS WITHOUT PRESSURE

10 MIN

'Notice what Marcus does NOT do when his friends start cheating. He doesn't lecture. He doesn't leave. He explains his reason once — clearly, without judgment — and they stop pressuring him. That is what a well-articulated anchor does: it doesn't require others to change. It simply holds you in place, clearly enough that others understand it.' Pairs: 'Share one of your three anchors. Just the anchor. Then: how would you explain it to someone who might push back — without moralizing at them?'

3

THE ANCHOR TEST

7 MIN

Write: ANCHOR TEST — 'Does this hold when it costs me something specific, right now?' 'Yusuf fills out his peer evaluation honestly even though staying silent would also benefit him. His anchor — honesty — costs him something real in that moment. It holds. That is an anchor.' Students complete the Integrity Anchor Worksheet (Tier 2): name three anchors, describe the last time each was tested, write what held them in place.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-3A**THE INTEGRITY ANCHOR****THE SITUATION**

When Marcus's friend group started cheating on homework using AI tools, they assumed Marcus would join. He didn't. They assumed he was being judgmental. He wasn't. He explained: 'I just don't want to go into the exam not knowing the material. It's not about the rules — it's about what I want to be able to do at the end of the semester.' His group didn't entirely understand. But they didn't pressure him again. **DISCUSSION**

QUESTIONS What is Marcus's integrity anchor — and how does it hold without requiring him to moralize at others? Marcus says it's 'not about the rules.' What distinction is he making — and why does it matter?

Marcus's group stopped pressuring him. What in his response made that possible? Identify a situation in your own life where your integrity anchor held quietly — without having to announce itself. **THE INTEGRITY ANCHOR** An integrity anchor is not a rule imposed from outside. It is a value you have genuinely examined and committed to — one that holds you steady when social pressure pushes. The anchor does not require you to judge others. It simply tells you where your own line is. When you know it clearly, you rarely have to announce it.

B4-3B**THE INTEGRITY ANCHOR**

THE SITUATION

Yusuf has always said that honesty is one of his core values. In a group project, he discovers that one teammate has inflated their contribution on the final peer evaluation form. Yusuf knows that correcting it will create conflict. He knows that staying silent benefits him too. He fills out his own evaluation honestly. When asked why he didn't flag the discrepancy, he says: 'I can only control mine.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What does Yusuf's anchor value tell him to do — and what does it tell him not to do? Yusuf says 'I can only control mine.' Is this a principled position or a convenient one? How would you distinguish the two? Honesty as a value doesn't require Yusuf to police others — but does it require anything beyond accurate self-reporting? Where is the integrity anchor being tested in this situation — and how does it hold? **ANCHOR TESTS** Your integrity anchor is tested most often not by dramatic moral decisions, but by the small, practical, deniable moments when the cost of living the value is real and immediate. An anchor that only holds when it is costless is not an anchor — it is a preference. Yusuf's choice to control only what he can control is both a principled limit and a form of integrity maintenance.

Authenticity in Action

45–50 min · September Week 1

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish contextual authenticity from self-suppression and place themselves on the Authenticity Gradient in at least two specific contexts.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · September Week 1
KEY VOCABULARY	authenticity gradient · contextual intelligence · self-suppression · selective sharing · genuine presence · adaptation · deletion
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the integrity anchor. What makes an anchor different from a rule?' [Answer.] 'Today: what does being genuine actually look like — and is adjusting for context the same as being inauthentic?'

ANCHOR CHART

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: the integrity anchor. Today: what does being genuine actually look like — and is it possible to adjust how you show up without being inauthentic?' [Post: 'Is there a version of you — in every context — that is genuinely yours? Or are some versions a deletion?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the journal marking in Step 1, a student who places themselves at 0–2 across every context — school, home, close friendships, online — with no context above 3. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be in a significant authenticity deficit — operating in near-total mask mode across their entire life. Associated with significant loneliness, shame-concealment, and in its most acute form, disconnection from a coherent sense of self. **ACTION** Note privately. After class: 'I noticed that every context felt like a low number for you today. I want to understand what that's like — can we talk for a few minutes?' If student deflects, note for counselor.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3 design work, a student whose 'genuine 5' is described entirely in terms of what others will think — 'I could be more like ___ so people would ___.' **MAY SIGNAL** This student has not yet accessed their authentic self as the reference point — still using external validation as the standard. The gradient is being read as a social performance scale rather than a genuine-presence scale. **ACTION** Approach quietly during circulating: 'What would a 5 look like if no one was evaluating it? If the only question was whether it felt true to you?' Redirect gently toward the internal reference.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-4A and B4-4B B4-4A (NIA): Whole-class. Key: 'Is Nia inauthentic at school — or contextually intelligent? How do you tell the difference?' Then: 'Design a version of Nia's classroom self that is genuinely hers — not a performance, but not everything.' B4-4B (JONAH): Pairs. Key: 'At what point does contextual adaptation become self-suppression — and how does a person know when they've crossed that line?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The context where my authenticity gradient is lowest right now is ___. What I suppress there is ___. Whether this is an adaptation or a deletion: ___. A version of me at a genuine 5 in that context would look like ___." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most important move: hold the adaptation/deletion distinction and do not collapse them. Context-shifting is intelligent and human. The clinical signal is deletion sustained over time. Students who mark 0–2 everywhere across contexts warrant private follow-up and counselor awareness. Students who can only describe their 5 in terms of external approval have not yet accessed their authentic self as a reference point — note for Unit 2.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

I

THE GRADIENT — AUTHENTICITY IS NOT BINARY

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Authenticity is not a switch — on or off, real or fake. It is a spectrum.' Point to the gradient. 'A 0 is a total mask. A 10 is radical transparency — everything visible to everyone, all the time. Most healthy adults operate in the 4–7 range: genuinely present, selectively shared, context-aware.' Students mark their position in two specific contexts privately in journals: school and home. 3 minutes. No sharing.

2

ADAPTATION VS. DELETION — THE CORE DISTINCTION

10 MIN

Write: ADAPTATION = adjusting what you show. Something genuine remains. DELETION = removing what matters most. Nothing real remains. 'Nia adjusts at school — contextually intelligent. The question is whether the calibrated version is still genuinely hers. Jonah left his most important parts in the parking lot every morning for six months. He didn't misrepresent himself — he deleted himself. That is not adaptation. That is deletion sustained until it became a pattern.' Pairs: 'Look at your two context marks. Is the lower one an adaptation — or a deletion? How do you tell?'

3

DESIGN YOUR 5

7 MIN

'For every context where you are operating below 4, there is a version of you that is genuinely yours and appropriate to that environment — not everything, but nothing false. A 5.' Students complete the Authenticity Gradient Worksheet (Tier 2): identify one context below 4, name what is deleted, determine whether the deletion is strategic or survival-based, and design what a genuine 5 looks like there. Private work — do not circulate to read over shoulders.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-4A**AUTHENTICITY IN ACTION****THE SITUATION**

Nia has always been fully herself at home — loud, opinionated, deeply funny, and occasionally irreverent. At school she is quieter, more careful, more contained. She doesn't feel like she is hiding herself at school — she just knows that not every context calls for every version of her. One day a teacher says: 'Nia, I wish we saw more of you in class.' Nia thinks: 'Which me?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Nia being inauthentic at school — or is she being contextually intelligent? How do you tell the difference? Nia's teacher wants to see 'more of her.' What might the teacher be noticing — and what might they be missing? What does authenticity look like in a context that doesn't feel safe for full expression? Is partial authenticity authentic? Design a version of Nia's classroom self that is genuinely hers — not a performance, but not everything either. **THE AUTHENTICITY GRADIENT** Authenticity is not binary — it is a spectrum. A 0 is total mask (nothing real showing). A 10 is radical transparency (everything visible, all the time). Most healthy adults operate in the 4–7 range — genuinely present, selectively shared, context-aware. The question is not whether you adjust your presentation. It is whether the adjustment is costing you something real.

B4-4B**AUTHENTICITY IN ACTION**

THE SITUATION

When Jonah started a new job, he spent the first three months being careful — listening more than speaking, agreeing more than pushing back, laughing at jokes he didn't find funny. By month four he had a reputation for being 'easy to work with.' By month six he felt invisible. He hadn't lied about who he was. He'd just left the most important parts of himself in the parking lot every morning. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What was Jonah's strategy — and why did it make sense at first? Jonah didn't misrepresent himself. He edited himself. Is there a meaningful difference? 'Easy to work with' became his reputation. What did he sacrifice to earn that label? At what point does contextual adaptation become self-suppression — and how does a person know they've crossed that line? **AUTHENTICITY AS A SKILL** Authenticity in new environments is a skill — it requires reading context, timing genuine expression, and building trust before vulnerability. But the strategy of indefinite self-editing eventually produces a problem: others cannot connect with who you actually are if who you actually are is never present. The goal is not instant radical transparency — it is honest progression toward your actual self.

The Groupthink Trap

45–50 min · September Week 2

OBJECTIVE	Students explain the preference falsification mechanism and articulate one concrete dissent strategy they can use without confrontation.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Social Awareness (secondary) · Responsible Decision-Making (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · September Week 2
KEY VOCABULARY	groupthink · preference falsification · false consensus · anchor effect · quiet dissent · social courage · dissent toolkit
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: authenticity gradient — adaptation vs. deletion. What is the test for knowing which you're doing?' [Answer.] 'Today: what happens when everyone in a room is adapting simultaneously — and nobody says what they actually think?'

ANCHOR CHART

PREFERENCE
FALSIFICATION
PUBLICLY
EXPRESSING A
VIEW YOU DO NOT
PRIVATELY HOLD
TO AVOID SOCIAL
COST SHORT-TERM
SAFETY · LONG-
TERM COST

THE DISSENT TOOLKIT 1. THE HONEST QUESTION 2. THE PRIVATE DISCLOSURE 3. THE PUBLIC STAND MATCH THE TOOL TO THE COST

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: authenticity in action. Today: what happens when everyone in a room is adapting at the same time? When nobody says what they actually think — and a consensus forms that nobody believes?' [Post: 'What does it cost to stay silent — and what does it cost to speak?']

UNIT 1 · LESSON 5 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3 pair discussion, a student who insists that dissent in their specific social context would have consequences far greater than the lesson acknowledges — and describes those consequences with specificity. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be correct. For students navigating peer groups with real social power dynamics — shaped by race, gender, economic status, or social hierarchy — the cost of dissent can be real and significant. The Dissent Toolkit is not universally low-cost. **ACTION** Validate directly and privately: 'You may be right that the cost in your specific context is higher than what I described. The toolkit is still worth having — knowing which tool fits which context is part of the skill. Thank you for naming that.' Do not dismiss their experience.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-5A and B4-5B B4-5A (AMARA): Whole-class model. Key for Q3: 'If twenty people stayed silent, is it possible the first speaker was also in the minority? What does that suggest?' Let students arrive at this themselves. B4-5B (THEO): Pairs. Key: '"I didn't agree with it" and "I didn't stop it" are different things. What is the distance between them?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"A situation in my life where I have falsified my preference — said or did the group thing when I privately disagreed — is _____. The Dissent Toolkit move I could use in a similar situation is _____. What it would actually cost me to use it is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The equity dimension of this lesson is critical: the Dissent Toolkit is not uniformly low-cost. Do not override students' experience of higher-cost dissent with a generalization. The lesson is most powerful when it acknowledges both the mechanism (real) and the differential cost (also real). The Anchor Effect concept often produces a genuine insight moment — let it land before moving to the toolkit.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

I

PREFERENCE FALSIFICATION — THE MECHANISM

8 MIN

'Amara doesn't speak. Her classmate doesn't speak. Twenty people stay silent. A consensus forms that nobody believes.' Write PREFERENCE FALSIFICATION on the board. 'It does not require dishonesty — only silence. And here is the part that should stop you: the person who spoke first and anchored that consensus probably also didn't represent the majority. They just spoke first.' [Pause. Let this land.] 'If twenty people falsified their preference in that room, it is entirely possible that not a single person actually agreed with the stated consensus. The agreement was a collective performance.'

2

THE ANCHOR EFFECT AND THE COURAGE OF ONE SENTENCE

10 MIN

'The first speaker has disproportionate power. They set the anchor — the position everyone responds to. Write: FIRST SPEAKER → sets anchor → everyone else responds TO the anchor. 'What would it have cost Amara to say one sentence? One sentence — not a speech, not a challenge, just: I see it a little differently.' [Take 3–4 student responses on the cost.] Then: 'What might it have given the room? The student who caught up to Amara after class and said he didn't agree either — he was waiting for exactly that one sentence. The courage of one sentence is not just about you. It gives everyone else who is falsifying permission to stop.'

3

THE DISSENT TOOLKIT

7 MIN

'You do not have to deliver a speech.' Post the three tools from the anchor chart. Walk through each with a concrete example. 'The cost of quiet dissent is almost always lower than it feels in the moment. The anticipation of social cost is almost always larger than the actual cost.' Pairs: 'Design a dissent move for Amara's classroom. Which tool — and what would you say, specifically?'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-5A**THE GROUPTHINK TRAP****THE SITUATION**

During a class discussion, Amara notices that nearly everyone is agreeing with the first student who spoke — even students who, based on earlier conversations with them, she knows have different views. Nobody disagrees. The teacher seems pleased with the consensus. After class, one student catches up to Amara and says quietly: 'I didn't actually agree with any of that.' Amara says: 'Me neither. Why didn't you say anything?' He shrugs: 'Why didn't you?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What mechanism is at work in this classroom — and what is producing the false consensus? Both Amara and her classmate stayed silent. What were each of them afraid of? If twenty people stayed silent in that room, is it possible that the student who spoke was also in the minority? What does that suggest? What would it have cost Amara to say 'I see it differently' — and what might it have given the room? **PREFERENCE FALSIFICATION** Preference falsification is the act of expressing public agreement while privately disagreeing. When enough people do it simultaneously, a false consensus forms — one that nobody actually believes but everyone reinforces. The person who speaks first has disproportionate power to anchor the conversation. The courage to name a different perspective is not contrarianism — it is the antidote to manufactured agreement.

B4-5B**THE GROUPTHINK TRAP**

THE SITUATION

Theo's friend group decides to exclude someone from an upcoming event — not out of explicit cruelty, but by just not mentioning it. Nobody says out loud that they are excluding him. Nobody votes. It just happens, and everyone goes along. Afterward, when Theo reflects, he realizes he didn't actually want to leave his classmate out. He just didn't say anything. 'I didn't agree with it,' he tells himself. 'I just... didn't stop it.'

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is Theo's responsibility in this situation — and where does it begin and end? 'I didn't agree with it' and 'I didn't stop it' are different things. What is the distance between them? What would it have cost Theo to say something at the moment the decision was silently made? Groupthink doesn't require a vote. What does it require — and what makes it so easy to participate in without noticing? **PASSIVE PARTICIPATION** Groupthink does not require agreement — it requires only silence. When a social decision is made by the group's quiet momentum, staying silent is a vote. The Dissent Toolkit gives you options that don't require a dramatic confrontation: asking a question, naming what you're noticing, or simply not going along. The cost of quiet dissent is almost always lower than it feels in the moment.

Silencing the Noise

45–50 min · September Week 3

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish signal from noise and practice the Signal-vs-Noise Pause as a concrete regulation tool.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (primary) · Responsible Decision-Making (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · September Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	signal · noise · Internal Coach · algorithm · external validation · social comparison · Signal-vs-Noise Pause
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: preference falsification — what is the anchor effect?' [Answer.] 'Today: beneath all the noise — algorithms, peers, parents, platforms — what is your actual voice? And how do you hear it?'

ANCHOR CHART

THE SIGNAL REAL
EMOTIONAL
INFORMATION
POINTING TO
SOMETHING TRUE
REQUIRES YOUR
ATTENTION
RESPONDS TO
HONEST INQUIRY

**THE NOISE ANXIETY, SOCIAL COMPARISON CATASTROPHISING RESPONDS TO:
PAUSE + BREATHE DOES NOT REQUIRE IMMEDIATE ACTION**

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: the groupthink trap. Today: beneath the groupthink, beneath the algorithms, beneath what everyone expects you to be — what is actually your voice?' [Post: 'Beneath everything other people and platforms tell you — what is actually your voice?']

NOTE

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND: ADULT REGULATION UNDER PRESSURE — THE SIGNAL-VS-NOISE PAUSE
PLACEMENT: Embedded after Direct Instruction Step 2 — at the moment students have named their noise sources but before they apply the Internal Coach concept. **STRAND SKILL:** Adult Regulation Under Pressure — filtering signal from noise without flooding. **TIME:** 6–8 minutes. **Protected** — do not cut for time. Book 4 Strand Touchpoint 1 of 5. **STEP A — NAME THE SKILL (1 min):** 'This is called the Signal-vs-Noise Pause. It is not a breathing exercise. It is a three-step mental practice you can use in the exact moment when you cannot tell the difference between what you actually think and what the pressure around you wants you to think.' **STEP B — EXPLAIN WHY IT MATTERS (1 min):** 'You have just named the noise sources in your life. You cannot make a signal-based decision inside the noise. You have to step out of it first. The Pause creates that step.' **STEP C — TEACH THE THREE STEPS (2 min).** Write on board as you teach: **STOP** — Physically pause. Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual. (Students already know this — name the connection.) **ASK** — Ask internally: 'Is this thought coming from my signal or from the noise?' Hold the question for 5 seconds before answering. **LOCATE** — 'What would the version of me I am proud of actually think about this?' That answer — however faint — is the signal. **STEP D — TEACHER MODELS (1 min):** Model the Pause aloud with a generic example. Do not use a student's example. **STEP E — STUDENTS PRACTICE (90 sec):** Write one noise source from earlier. Run the Pause privately. Write what the Signal says. **Silence** — do not circulate. **STEP F — ANCHOR AND POST (30 sec):** Post the three steps on the anchor chart. 'Every time the noise gets louder — you have this.' **TEACHING TIP:** Frame as a decision-making tool, not a coping skill. **Common error:** asking students to share their signal aloud after Step E — keep it private. **ELL:** Three steps can be printed on a card (Stop / Ask / Locate). See ELL Supplement, Part D, Unit 1, L6.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the noise-source listing in Step 1, a student who lists only one or two sources — or very generic sources — without specificity. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may not yet be able to consciously observe noise in their own environment. They experience its effects but cannot name its sources. Developmental data point — not a clinical signal. **ACTION** During Step 3 Signal Test, offer: 'Think of a time in the last week when you did something because you thought you should — not because you actually wanted to. What was that should coming from?' That question often surfaces specific noise sources the direct prompt does not.

SCENARIO CARDS • FACILITATION NOTES

B4-6A and B4-6B B4-6A (LAYLA): Whole-class. Key: 'What are the noise sources in Layla's life — and how has each one shaped the signal she can hear?' Name each specifically. **B4-6B (MARCUS'S FEED):** Pairs. Key: '"I know it's not real, but it still gets to me" — why does knowing something is distorted not protect you from its effect?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION**GRADES 9 • 10****GRADES 11 • 12**

EXIT TICKET

"The loudest noise source in my life right now is _____. My actual signal — what my Internal Coach says when I run the Pause — is _____. One concrete practice I can use this week to hear my signal more clearly is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The Regulation & Repair Strand touchpoint is the most important structural element in this lesson — it converts the Internal Coach from a concept into a practice. Do not abbreviate it. The four steps should be posted on the board and the practice completed before the lesson ends. The Internal Coach anchor chart is permanent — positioned where students can see it from their seats for the rest of the year. For students who have spent years code-switching or suppressing who they are in institutional settings, the signal may be genuinely hard to hear — not from algorithm noise but from survival adaptation. Name this explicitly: 'For some people, the noise has been loud enough for long enough that the signal has become quiet. That is what Unit 2 will help with.'

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

★ PPRA LESSON Dear Families, Today students worked with the concept of signal versus noise — distinguishing between the voices and pressures that reflect what they actually value versus the external noise that can drown that signal out. Students learned and practiced the Signal-vs-Noise Pause: a three-step regulation skill they can use in any high-pressure moment. A conversation-starter: "What's one thing you know is true about yourself that is easy to lose sight of when things get loud?" You do not need to have an answer to offer. The question itself — asked with genuine curiosity — is the contribution.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

HOW NOISE WORKS

7 MIN

'Layla nearly forgot she wanted to study architecture because every noise source in her life was pointing away from it. Her parents. Her friends. Her algorithm. None of them were trying to harm her. And the noise almost worked anyway.' Ask: 'What are the noise sources in your life right now? Not the ones you actively resist — the ones you can barely hear yourself beneath.' Students list 4–5 specific noise sources privately in journals — not categories (social media) but specific instances. 2 minutes. Private.

2

THE INTERNAL COACH — WHAT IT IS NOT

8 MIN

'The Internal Coach is not a cheerleader. It is not a critic. It specifically asks: what would the version of me I am proud of do here? That question is the anchor.' Write it large on the board. 'Marcus knows the feed is not real. And it still gets to him. Why? Because knowing something is distorted does not protect you from its effect. What protects you is having a signal loud enough to hear above the noise — a clear enough sense of your own values that you can evaluate your own progress in your own terms.' Introduce the Signal-vs-Noise Pause (from the R&R Strand below) and teach the three steps.

3

THE SIGNAL TEST — PRACTICE

5 MIN

'Run the Signal-vs-Noise Pause on one situation from the past week where the noise was loud — where external pressure, comparison, or expectation was pulling you in a direction that didn't feel fully yours. Work through all four steps privately.' Students write 3 minutes. Then: post the Internal Coach anchor chart. 'This stays up for the rest of the year. Not because I'm telling you what your signal is — but because this question is worth keeping visible.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-6A**SILENCING THE NOISE****THE SITUATION**

Layla has always wanted to study architecture. In tenth grade she started saying it less — partly because her parents were skeptical ('That's not a stable field'), partly because her friends thought it was random ('Why not something more practical?'), partly because her algorithm kept surfacing content about other careers. By eleventh grade she had nearly forgotten why she wanted it. In a quiet moment in the school library, she picked up a book about buildings and felt something click back into place. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What are the noise sources in Layla's life — and how has each one shaped the signal she can hear? Layla's parents and friends are not trying to harm her. Does that make their input signal or noise? What does the library moment tell Layla about the difference between the noise and her actual voice? Design a version of Layla's next conversation with herself — one that sifts the legitimate input from the noise. **THE INTERNAL COACH** The Internal Coach is the voice that asks: what would the version of you that you're proud of do here? It is not the voice that caves to every outside opinion, nor the one that dismisses all input as noise. It is the voice that can hold external perspectives with genuine curiosity — and still return to what is actually true for you. Identifying your signal requires practice, especially in an environment designed to drown it out.

B4-6B**SILENCING THE NOISE**

THE SITUATION

Every time Marcus opens his phone, he sees highlights from people at other schools — better grades, better social lives, more prestigious internships, earlier certainty about their futures. His feed is not showing him reality. It is showing him the top 5% of everyone's curated performance. By the time he closes the app, his own life looks gray by comparison. 'I know it's not real,' he says. 'But it still gets to me.'

DISCUSSION

QUESTIONS Marcus knows the feed is not real — and it still affects him. Why does knowing something is distorted not protect you from its effect? What would Marcus's life look like if he evaluated it against his own baseline — his own growth, his own values — rather than against the feed? What is the Internal Coach's response to what Marcus sees on his phone? Design one concrete practice Marcus could use to reduce the noise-to-signal ratio in his daily life. **SIGNAL VS. NOISE** The algorithm is not designed to show you an accurate picture of reality. It is designed to keep you engaged — which means showing you content that produces comparison, aspiration, and anxiety. Knowing this is not enough to protect you from it. What helps is having a signal that is loud enough to hear above the noise: a clear set of values that grounds your evaluation of your own progress in your own terms.

Unit Reflection — the Identity Shield

50–55 min · September Week 4 · Unit reflection and bridge

OBJECTIVE	Students synthesize Unit 1 learning by building a personal Identity Shield and articulate one intention for Unit 2.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (synthesis across all Unit 1 domains)
DURATION	50–55 min · September Week 4 · Unit reflection and bridge
KEY VOCABULARY	Identity Shield · authentic strengths · non-negotiables · values · synthesis · bridge · carry-forward sentence
MATERIALS	All Unit 1 anchor charts displayed simultaneously · B4-U1-WS1 (Identity Shield — Tier 2) · Scenario Cards B4-7A and B4-7B · Index cards for bridge activity
OPENING REVIEW	None. Open with the full ritual and the display of all Unit 1 charts: 'We have been building something over the last six weeks. Today we look at what we built.'

ANCHOR CHART

S — DISPLAYED SIMULTANEOUSLY Post all Unit 1 anchor charts visible at the same time before class begins: · The Performance Tax (L1) · The Social Battery (L2) · The Integrity Anchor (L3) · The Authenticity Gradient (L4) · Preference Falsification & Dissent Toolkit (L5) · Signal vs. Noise / Internal Coach (L6) — **PERMANENT** Students should be able to see all charts simultaneously from their seats. Do not take them down after this lesson — they continue into Unit 2.

OPENING RITUAL

3 minutes · Unit Reflection Version 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Look at the wall. Everything on those charts — you built that. Not me. I gave you the vocabulary. You did the work of applying it to your actual life.' [Pause 15 seconds. Let them look.] 'Today we take everything from the last six weeks and put it in one place. The Identity Shield. Not a finished portrait — a navigational document. Who you are right now. What you will not trade. What you are choosing to become.' [Post: 'Who are you choosing to become — and what are you not willing to trade to get there?']

UNIT 1 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE As students review their Unit 1 journal work during Shield building, a student whose posture or expression shifts significantly — visible relief, emotion, or a recognition of distance traveled from L1 to now. **MAY SIGNAL** This is the curriculum doing its work. The distance from August to now is sometimes more visible to the student than they expected. **ACTION** Hold the room quietly. Allow the emotion. Do not rush to Step 2. 'Take your time.' This is not a disruption — it is the most important moment of the unit.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Shield building, a student who fills the Authentic Strengths quadrant with accomplishments (grades, awards, leadership positions) and crosses them out repeatedly, unable to access what lies beneath. **MAY SIGNAL** This student has conflated credentials with authentic strengths. Exactly what Unit 2 will address directly — this is not a failure, it is the most important data point for the Unit 2 arc. **ACTION** Approach quietly: 'Those are things you have done. Can you find something that is true about you even when you are not doing anything? The thing people would say about you after spending an hour with you in a room?' This reframe often unlocks the quadrant.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-7A and B4-7B B4-7A (DEJA'S NON-NEGOTIABLES): Whole-class or pairs. Key: 'What does it mean that Deja's non-negotiables feel more solid than her stated values? Are non-negotiables the same as values — or something different?' B4-7B (ZACH'S AUTHENTIC STRENGTHS): Key: 'Zach doesn't know if his authentic strengths count. Count for what — and according to whose criteria?' The insight: authentic strengths are not credential-dependent.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The most important thing I built in Unit 1 is _____. The thing on my Identity Shield I am least sure about — but most want to be true — is _____. The inner voice I most need to work with in Unit 2 is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

TEACHER REFLECTION

Review Shields privately (with student permission) before Unit 2 begins — what you learn will shape how you deliver U2-L1 (The Internal Critic). Students who cannot access Authentic Strengths — who list only accomplishments — are your highest priority in Unit 2. The Internal Critic work is most activating for students who have not yet separated their worth from their performance. The bridge index cards are the most important artifact of this lesson — store them securely. Return them at U4-L7. Brief counselor on the Unit 1 arc before Unit 2 Lesson 1, and flag: students who marked 0–2 on the Authenticity Gradient across all contexts; students whose battery is universally depleted by school; students who are heavily performance-identified with no anchor beneath the credentials.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

★ PPRA LESSON Dear Families, Today students completed Unit 1 of Architecture of Grace by building their Identity Shield — a four-quadrant personal inventory naming authentic strengths, core values, non-negotiables, and the gap between the curated self and the authentic self. The Identity Shield is private. Students were told it will never be collected or graded. It belongs to them. This is the culmination of seven lessons on identity, authenticity, integrity, and the social pressures that shape how young people present themselves to the world. Your student has done significant interior work this unit. A conversation-starter: "If you had to describe yourself to someone who had never met you — not your achievements, but who you actually are — what would you say?" Unit 2 begins next week. It builds directly on the work of Unit 1.

NOTE

TEACHER FACILITATION NOTE — BEFORE DISTRIBUTING Introduce with this language (verbatim or close): 'This is called the Identity Shield. A shield in medieval armor wasn't just decoration — it was a statement of who you were, what you stood for, and what you were protecting. Your Identity Shield is the same thing. It has four quadrants. You fill each one in response to what we've worked on this unit. There are no correct answers. There are only true ones.' Allow students to work in silence. Do not circulate to read over shoulders. The worksheet is private — your job is to hold the space, not inspect the content. Grades 11–12 differentiation: Direct students to also complete the Legacy Connection field at the bottom.

NOTE

THE IDENTITY SHIELD · Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Unit 1 Name (optional): _____ Grade: _____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. It will not be graded. Write what is actually true.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

QUADRANT 1: AUTHENTIC STRENGTHS Not what you have done — who you are. The capacities that show up without you trying. I am someone who: _____

_____ The strength I am most likely to undervalue in myself: _____

QUADRANT 2: CORE VALUES Not what you are told to value — what you actually return to when pressure strips everything else away. What I keep coming back to, even when it costs me: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

_____ The value hardest to hold under social pressure: _____

QUADRANT 3: NON-NEGOTIABLES What you will not trade, even when the cost of not trading it is real. I will not: 1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

_____ The non-negotiable tested most recently: _____

QUADRANT 4: THE GAP The distance between who you perform and who you actually are. This is not a judgment. It is a measurement. My curated self tends to show: _____ My authentic self actually knows: _____ The gap costs me: _____

_____ One thing I could do to close it: _____

NOTE

CLOSING REFLECTION — Complete after all four quadrants: The thing about myself that surprised me most in this unit is: _____ The sentence I want to carry forward from this unit into Unit 2: _____

_____ Grades 11–12 **LEGACY**

CONNECTION: The version of me that is 10 years from now — what would they add to this shield that I can't see yet? _____

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

NOTE

Block all dates below **BEFORE** Unit 1 Lesson 1 is delivered. These cannot be rescheduled reactively.

NOTE

LESSON RISK COUNSELOR REQUIREMENT NOTES & CONSTRAINTS L1: Beyond the Brand ★ Brief counselor 2 days before delivery. Awareness only. No scheduling constraint beyond briefing. Low co-facilitation risk. L2: The Social Battery ★ Brief counselor 2 days before delivery. Awareness only. Low disclosure risk. Standard protocol applies. L3–L5 Standard No counselor requirement. Standard disclosure protocol active. Ensure counselor knows standard disclosure protocol applies. L6: Silencing the Noise ★ + R&R Brief counselor on R&R Strand content before delivery. On standby same day. Moderate disclosure risk. No co-facilitation required. Mon–Wed preferred. L7: Identity Shield ★ + Bridge Brief counselor before delivery. On standby — reachable same day. Mon–Wed preferred. Do not schedule before holiday or weekend.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

STANDING — BEFORE UNIT 1 LESSON 1 Counselor attends teacher PD day. Disclosure protocol reviewed together. Communication channel established: how teacher signals counselor during a lesson (text / hall pass / knock — agree before L1). Calendar blocked for all Unit 1 ★ briefings above. Counselor receives Unit 1 overview and scenario cards B4-1A through B4-7B for background awareness.

NOTE

AFTER UNIT 1 LESSON 7 — REQUIRED DEBRIEF (within 3 school days) Teacher and counselor meet to review: any students who showed concerning patterns in journal behavior, composure signals, or Identity Shield gap responses. Identify: students entering Unit 2 who may carry the highest emotional load into the Self-Compassion arc. Flag: any students for whom the Backpack Audit (B4-U2-L7, ★★) may warrant advance individual counselor contact. This debrief is the bridge between Unit 1 safety infrastructure and Unit 2 counselor calendar setup.

NOTE

Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Unit 1: The Curated Self · COMPLETE MERGED DOCUMENT Tier 1 (Lesson Interiors) + Tier 2 (Operational Layer) · Merge verified — no conflicts School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden, Founder · Pilot Version CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only NEXT: Book 4 Unit 2 — Resilience Through Self-Kindness: Self-Compassion

★★ HIGHEST RISK · PPRA NOTICE

Unit Duration October–December · 7 Lessons · 45–55 minutes each Essential Question What do you do with the voice inside that tells you who you are is not enough? Risk Profile HIGHEST-RISK UNIT IN BOOK 4 · L7 ★★ · L1, L3, L6 ★ PPRA Version Pilot · CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

LETTERS: L1 ★, L3 ★, L6 ★, L7 ★★ (Tier 2) COUNSELOR COORDINATION CALENDAR: Unit 2 entries (Tier 2) MERGE STATUS: Clean — no conflicts between Tier 1 and Tier 2. All elements verified.

NOTE

UNIT 2 STANDING SAFETY NOTE — Read before L1 and return before every lesson Unit 2 asks students to examine the voice inside that judges their worth, capacity, and belonging. It does NOT ask students to perform self-compassion or produce evidence of inner peace. If at any point a student's responses suggest ongoing distress exceeding Tier 1 scope — follow the Disclosure Protocol. BEFORE UNIT 2 BEGINS: Crisis resources posted visibly. L7 counselor date blocked. Counselor briefed on Unit 1 debrief observations.

1

BUILDING THE IDENTITY SHIELD

15 MIN

Distribute B4-U1-WS1 (Identity Shield — see Tier 2 Worksheet below). Introduce: 'This is not a resume. Authentic strengths are not accomplishments — they are capacities that show up regardless of context, often without your trying. The things people remember about you. The things that are true even when you don't perform them.' [Pause.] 'Zach's Shield says: I see people. I notice what they need. I stay. Those are not on his transcript. They are more real than anything on it.' Give students 12 minutes to complete all four quadrants privately. Do not circulate to read over shoulders. The Shield is the most important artifact of Unit 1.

2

SCENARIO CARD DEBRIEF — WHAT THE SHIELD REVEALS

10 MIN

After students complete their Shields, run one scenario card as a whole-class discussion — B4-7A or B4-7B depending on class tone. Use the scenario to surface Shield insights without requiring students to share their own Shields. Key for B4-7A: 'What does Deja's non-negotiables quadrant reveal about what she actually values — even though she wrote it in the negative?' Key for B4-7B: 'What would Zach's Shield tell an employer that no resume could tell them?'

3

BRIDGE FRAMING — UNIT 1 TO UNIT 2

10 MIN

'Unit 1 was about who you are. The performance you manage, the battery that powers you, the anchor that holds you, the gradient you operate on, the noise you filter. You have a language for all of it now.' [Pause.] 'Unit 2 asks a harder question: what do you do with the voice inside that tells you that who you are is not enough? The Internal Critic. We spent Unit 1 building the floor. Unit 2 tests whether it can hold.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-7A

UNIT REFLECTION — THE IDENTITY SHIELD

THE SITUATION

When Deja finishes her Identity Shield, she notices something unexpected: the 'non-negotiables' quadrant is the one that feels most real to her — more than her strengths or her values. What she will not trade is clearer than almost anything else. She has a list of three things: she will not compromise her integrity for an outcome. She will not perform a version of herself she does not believe in. She will not stay somewhere she is not genuinely valued. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What does it mean that Deja's non-negotiables feel more solid than her stated values? Are non-negotiables the same as values — or are they something different? What is the relationship between them? Deja's list is written in the negative ('I will not'). What do her non-negotiables reveal about what she positively stands for? What would it mean to carry Deja's list into an environment that was testing all three? **THE IDENTITY SHIELD** The Identity Shield is not a fixed document — it is a living record of who you are choosing to become at this moment. The non-negotiables quadrant is often the most clarifying: what you will not trade tells you what you value most. The Shield is meant to be returned to, revised, and interrogated. It is a navigational tool, not a finished portrait.

B4-7B

UNIT REFLECTION — THE IDENTITY SHIELD

THE SITUATION

Zach struggles with the 'authentic strengths' quadrant of his Identity Shield. He keeps writing accomplishments — awards, grades, leadership positions — and crossing them out. 'Those are things I've done,' he realizes. 'Not things I am.' When he finally gets quiet with it, he writes: 'I see people. I notice what they need. I stay.' He doesn't know if those count as strengths. They are the truest things he has written all year. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why does Zach keep conflating accomplishments with strengths — and what is the difference? What do 'I see people. I notice what they need. I stay.' reveal about Zach that no award or credential could? Zach doesn't know if his authentic strengths 'count.' Count for what — and according to whose criteria? What would it look like to build a life around the strengths Zach actually has — rather than the accomplishments he has collected? **AUTHENTIC STRENGTHS VS. CREDENTIALS** Credentials are what you have done. Authentic strengths are who you are — the capacities that show up regardless of the context, often without your even trying. Zach's strengths — noticing, staying, seeing — are relational and dispositional. They are not on his transcript. They are the things people remember about him. They are also the things that will matter most in every environment he enters for the rest of his life.

WORKSHEET · REPRODUCIBLE

The Identity Shield

SAFETY NOTE

The Identity Shield · This worksheet is private. It is never collected, graded, or shared. The Reflection Pass is available at all times.

Name _____ Grade _____ Date _____

MY IDENTITY SHIELD

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING ON THIS SHIELD

 _____ How will you know, one year from now,
 that this was real and not just a statement?

BOOK 4

UNIT 2

RESILIENCE THROUGH SELF-KINDNESS

SELF-COMPASSION

THE PERFECTIONISM WEIGHT	SELF-CARE VS. SELF-INDULGENCE
L2 The 'not Yet' Lens	L6 The Compassionate Witness
L3 Sustainable Accountability	L7 The Backpack Audit
L4 Reclaiming the Narrative	

The Perfectionism Weight

45–50 min · October Week 1

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish perfectionism from healthy striving and identify one domain where perfectionism is operating as a defense rather than a motivator.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · October Week 1
KEY VOCABULARY	perfectionism · healthy striving · performance anxiety · freeze · self-worth contingency · Internal Critic
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-8A and B4-8B · WS B4-U2-WS1 (Perfectionism Spectrum)
OPENING REVIEW	'Unit 1: we named the gap between our curated and authentic selves. Today Unit 2 begins — and we go inside. The question changes from who you perform to what you do with the voice that judges that performance.'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

PPRA-designated. Psychological self-examination of perfectionism and performance-worth relationship. Advance notification required. Brief counselor before delivery. Do not ask students to share spectrum marks publicly. Students who mark far left across ALL domains — flag for counselor before L7.

ANCHOR CHART

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Unit 2 begins today. The question changes from who you perform to what you do with the voice inside that says who you are is not enough. Today we meet that voice. It has a name: the Perfectionism Weight.' [Post: 'Is your drive toward excellence actually serving you — or protecting you from something?']

UNIT 2 · LESSON 1 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who marks the far left across every single domain without hesitation. **MAY SIGNAL** Significant perfectionist paralysis across multiple life domains. Risk factor for patterns that will surface in L7 (Backpack Audit). **ACTION** Note privately for counselor awareness before L7. This student may need individual counselor contact before the ★★ lesson.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 4, a student who cannot write a single Compassionate Witness sentence after 3 minutes. **MAY SIGNAL** The Compassionate Witness may be entirely inaccessible — no internal model of kind self-talk to draw from. Clinically significant. **ACTION** Move quietly: 'You can write what you would say to your best friend in the same situation. That counts.' Note for counselor follow-up before L7.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-8A and B4-8B B4-8A (SOFIA'S 91): Whole-class. Key for Q2: 'Sofia's relief lasts three hours. What does that tell you about perfectionism's relationship to actual peace?' Key for Q4: 'What would the Compassionate Witness say to Sofia — honestly, not just reassuringly?' B4-8B (JONAH'S PROCRASTINATION): Pairs. Key: 'How would you reframe Jonah's procrastination to him in a way that opens a door rather than closes one?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The domain where perfectionism is loudest for me right now is _____. The fear underneath it is _____. The difference between perfectionism and healthy striving in my own words is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

First lesson of Unit 2 — the opening prompt about the perfectionist freeze is one of the most important teaching moves of the year. Students labeled lazy or unmotivated may be experiencing perfectionist freeze. Students who mark far left across all domains are your highest priority for counselor awareness before L7. The Compassionate Witness is introduced here as a concept only — it becomes practice in L5 and L6.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 1 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L1 · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students examined perfectionism — not as high standards, but as a fear-based pattern that ties self-worth to performance outcomes. The key distinction: perfectionism (terror masquerading as ambition) from healthy striving (high standards without self-destruction). Students also learned about the perfectionist freeze — procrastination that is actually self-protection from a feared verdict, often misread as laziness. All personal reflection was private. Conversation-starter: 'Is there something you've been putting off starting because the stakes of not doing it perfectly felt too high?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

WHAT PERFECTIONISM ACTUALLY IS

8 MIN

'Sofia has a 97 average. She spent an entire weekend unable to enjoy anything because of a 91 on one quiz.' [Pause.] 'What is happening to Sofia is not high standards. It is perfectionism.' Write: PERFECTIONISM = Failure proves I am worthless. HEALTHY STRIVING = Failure is data I can learn from. 'Perfectionism is not ambition. It is a defense mechanism — terror wearing the costume of ambition. The drive is not toward excellence. It is away from the verdict that you are not enough.'

2

THE PERFECTIONIST FREEZE

7 MIN

'Jonah procrastinates on everything. His teachers assume he doesn't care. What nobody knows — including Jonah — is that the procrastination is protection. If he doesn't try, he cannot definitively fail.' Write: PERFECTIONIST FREEZE = Not trying to avoid the possibility of failing. 'The freeze is fear wearing the costume of laziness or indifference. It is one of the most commonly misread signals in high school.'

3

THE SPECTRUM ACTIVITY

8 MIN

Distribute WS B4-U2-WS1 (Perfectionism Spectrum). 'Mark where you sit in each domain: school, your main activity, social life, family. For each left-side mark: what is the fear underneath it? Write it specifically — not I'm afraid of failing but what failing in that domain would mean about who you are.' 5 minutes private writing. No sharing of spectrum marks. Ever.

4

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS INTRODUCTION

5 MIN

'The Compassionate Witness is the voice we build throughout this unit. Not a cheerleader — the honest, fair, kind voice that knows the difference between what you did and who you are.' Write: COMPASSIONATE WITNESS = Honest + Fair + Kind. Without punishment. 'Write one sentence: what would the Compassionate Witness say to Sofia about her 91?' Private.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-8A

THE PERFECTIONISM WEIGHT ★ SAFETY NOTE

THE SITUATION

Sofia has a 97 average. She spent an entire weekend unable to enjoy anything because she got a 91 on one quiz. She knows intellectually that a 91 is fine. She cannot feel that it is fine. She doesn't tell anyone about the quiz because she is embarrassed by how much it bothers her. She tells herself she will feel better when the next quiz goes well. It does — she gets a 96 — and she feels relief for approximately three hours.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is perfectionism doing to Sofia — and what is it giving her that she hasn't been able to get another way? Sofia's relief lasts three hours. What does that tell you about perfectionism's relationship to actual peace? What is the difference between genuinely high standards and perfectionism as a psychological defense? If Sofia's Internal Coach could speak to her about the 91, what would it say — honestly, not just reassuringly?

B4-8B**THE PERFECTIONISM WEIGHT ★ SAFETY NOTE****THE SITUATION**

Jonah procrastinates on everything. His teachers assume he doesn't care. His parents assume he is lazy. What nobody knows — including Jonah — is that the procrastination is a protection strategy. If he doesn't try, he can't definitively fail. He starts two college essays and abandons them both. He is not avoiding the work. He is avoiding the verdict. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Jonah protecting himself from — and how is perfectionism operating in a way that looks like its opposite? Jonah's procrastination is being interpreted as laziness or indifference. What is actually happening? What would it cost Jonah to try fully — and what might it give him? How would you reframe Jonah's procrastination to him in a way that opens a door rather than closes one? **PERFECTIONIST FREEZE** Perfectionism doesn't always look like relentless effort toward flawlessness. It also shows up as paralysis — the freeze that comes when the cost of trying (risking a verdict) feels greater than the cost of not trying (avoiding the verdict). Perfectionist freeze is often misread as laziness or indifference. It is usually neither. It is fear of the gap between what you hope you are and what the outcome might reveal.

The 'not Yet' Lens

45–50 min · October Week 2 · Standard — no PPRA designation

OBJECTIVE	Students apply the Not Yet reframe to a current failure and articulate the difference between a fixed mindset and growth mindset in their own words.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management (primary) · Self-Awareness (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · October Week 2 · Standard — no PPRA designation
KEY VOCABULARY	Not Yet · growth mindset · fixed mindset · failure as data · reframe · effort and strategy
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: perfectionism — what is the fear underneath the left side of the spectrum?' [Answer.] 'Today: when failure happens — is it a destination or a data point?'

ANCHOR CHART

FIXED FRAMING "I FAILED" "I CANNOT DO THIS" "I AM NOT SMART ENOUGH" CLOSES THE DOOR

NOT YET FRAMING "I HAVE NOT MASTERED THIS YET" "I AM BUILDING THIS CAPACITY" "I AM IN THE PROCESS" KEEPS THE DOOR OPEN

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: perfectionism — the fear that failure proves something permanent. Today: what if failure is not a verdict? What if it is just information about where you are in a process that has not finished yet?' [Post: 'Is failure a destination — or a data point?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 2, a student who writes 'I don't really do that' or leaves the prompt blank. **MAY SIGNAL** Two possibilities: genuine growth mindset (prior work or growth-affirming environment) or significant emotional shutdown where fixed-mindset response is not accessible to conscious reflection. **ACTION** In Step 3, offer: 'You can think about someone you know who treats failure as a permanent verdict. What does the Not Yet lens say to them?'

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-9A and B4-9B B4-9A (PRIYA'S DRIVING TEST): Whole-class. Key for Q3: 'What would Priya need to believe about herself to hold the Not Yet frame when the Not for you frame is pressing?' Key for Q4: apply Not Yet reframe to own life — privately. B4-9B (THEO'S DEFERRAL): Pairs. Key: 'What would Theo need to believe for his friend's reframe to land? If the deferral is a data point — what information does it contain?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"One situation where I have been treating failure as a destination is _____. The three-step diagnosis: what happened was ____; the gap is ____; what comes next is _____. The Not Yet sentence I can say to myself is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Gentlest lesson of Unit 2 — use as a consolidation moment after L1's higher activation. Most important move: resist equating the Not Yet lens with toxic optimism or dismissing genuine difficulty. The reframe is not 'everything will be fine' — it is 'this process is not finished.' Students who cannot access growth mindset may have had their capacity-based beliefs systematically undermined by adults. The closing voice exercise can surface significant family material — note any students who appear activated by it.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

FIXED VS. GROWTH — THE ACTUAL DISTINCTION

8 MIN

'Two sentences: I failed. I haven't mastered this yet. The first closes the loop — treats failure as a complete statement about a permanent condition. The second keeps it open.' Write both on the board. 'The Not Yet lens is not positive thinking. It is an accurate description of how growth actually works.' Students write privately: 'One situation where I have been treating a failure as a destination — a permanent verdict — is _____.'

2

THE NOT YET REFRAME IN PRACTICE

10 MIN

Write: FAILURE AS DATA: (1) What happened? (2) What did it reveal about where the gap is? (3) What does that gap suggest about what comes next? Pairs: 'Apply the three-step failure diagnosis to your situation. Name what happened, name the gap, name one thing that comes next.' 5 minutes. No sharing required.

3

WHEN THE NOT YET VOICE IS HARD TO HEAR

7 MIN

'Closing voices feel authoritative. Opening voices feel uncertain. The Not Yet lens requires believing that effort and strategy can change outcomes.' Students write: 'The voice in my life that most often closes stories for me is _____. What the Not Yet lens says back to that voice is _____.' Private.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-9A

THE 'NOT YET' LENS

THE SITUATION

After failing her driving test twice, Priya's mom said: 'Maybe driving just isn't for you.' Priya's instructor said: 'You're not ready yet — here's what we work on next.' One response ended the story. The other kept it open. Priya noticed the difference, but in the moment, her mom's voice was louder — it always is. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the difference between 'this isn't for you' and 'not yet' — and why does that difference matter? Priya notices the difference but her mom's voice is louder. Why do the voices that close the story often feel more authoritative than the ones that keep it open? What would Priya need to believe about herself to hold the 'not yet' frame when the 'not for you' frame is pressing? Apply the 'not yet' reframe to something in your own life where the story feels closed. **THE 'NOT YET' LENS** Carol Dweck's research on growth mindset shows that the language we use about failure shapes whether we treat it as a destination or a data point. 'I failed' closes the loop. 'I haven't mastered this yet' keeps it open. The 'not yet' lens is not positive thinking — it is an accurate description of a learning process that has not finished. It requires believing that effort and strategy can change outcomes — which the evidence consistently supports.

B4-9B

THE 'NOT YET' LENS

THE SITUATION

Theo applied early decision to his first-choice college and was deferred. He had never not gotten something he worked for. He spent a week in a fog. His best friend said: 'You're treating this like it means something permanent about you.' Theo said: 'Doesn't it?' His friend said: 'No. It means you're not done yet.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Theo treating a college deferral as — and what has he confused? The deferral is real. The fog is real. And the 'not yet' frame is also real. How can all three be true at once? Theo's friend offers a reframe. What would Theo need to believe for that reframe to land? If the deferral is a data point rather than a destination — what information does it contain, and what action does it suggest? **FAILURE AS DATA A** deferral, a rejection, a failed test, a project that collapsed — these are data points in an ongoing learning process, not verdicts about fixed capacity. The fixed mindset treats them as confirmation of a permanent truth. The growth mindset treats them as information: here is where the gap is; here is what comes next. The reframe is not denial. It is an accurate description of how growth actually works.

Sustainable Accountability

45–55 min · October Week 3

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish accountability from self-punishment and apply the four-step accountability structure to a real situation.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management (primary) · Self-Awareness (supporting) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–55 min · October Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	accountability · self-punishment · guilt · shame · living amend · four-step accountability · repair
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-10A and B4-10B · WS B4-U2-WS2 (Accountability Structure)
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: Not Yet lens. Quick — what is the three-step failure diagnosis?' [Answer.] 'Today: what do you do when the failure is not a bad outcome but something you did that contradicts your values?'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

PPRA-designated. Disclosure of personal mistakes and accountability patterns. Standard opt-out protocols. Brief counselor before delivery. Students who describe severe self-punishment in response to minor mistakes — note for counselor before L7. The Friend Test in Step 3 is the highest-activation moment — journal first.

ANCHOR CHART

ACCOUNTABILITY
HONEST
ACKNOWLEDGMENT
GENUINE REPAIR
COMMITMENT TO
DIFFERENT CHOICE
MOVE ON — DO
NOT REVISIT
PRODUCES
LEARNING

SELF-PUNISHMENT REPEATING CONDEMNATION NO REPAIR — JUST SUFFERING
NO COMMITMENT — JUST GUILT CANNOT MOVE ON PRODUCES SHAME, NOT
LEARNING

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'When you make a mistake — not a failure of capacity, but a choice that contradicted your values — how long do you typically spend feeling bad about it versus actually fixing it? Today we look at the difference between those two things. One produces something. One produces nothing.' [Post: 'What is the difference between holding yourself accountable and punishing yourself?']

NOTE

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND: ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT COLLAPSE — THE THREE-PART CHECK · Touchpoint 2 of 5 PLACEMENT: Embed immediately after Step 2 — at the moment students have learned the four-step structure but before they apply it to their own situation. TIME: 6–8 minutes. Protected — do not cut for time. STEP A — NAME THE SKILL (1 min): 'This is called the Accountability Check. A three-part internal practice you use in the exact moment when taking responsibility starts to feel like proof that you are fundamentally broken.' STEP B — EXPLAIN WHY HERE (1 min): 'You have just learned the four-step structure. The reason most people skip Step 4 is that shame pulls them back to Step 0 before they reach it. The Check is how you stay in Steps 1 through 4 without collapsing.' STEP C — TEACH THE THREE-PART CHECK (2 min). Write on board: CHECK A — BEHAVIOR OR BEING? 'I made a choice that caused harm' (accountability) vs. 'I am a person who causes harm' (shame). They feel the same. They are not the same. CHECK B — FORWARD OR INWARD? Pointing FORWARD toward repair = accountability. Pulling INWARD toward self-focus = shame spiral. CHECK C — WHAT IS THE NEXT RIGHT ACTION? Not perfect. Not complete. The next right action. Write it down specifically. STEP D — TEACHER MODELS (1 min): Use a generic example. Narrate all three checks aloud. Do not use a student's example. STEP E — STUDENTS PRACTICE (90 sec): Apply the Check to their Step 2 situation privately in journals. Write the answer to Check C specifically. STEP F — ANCHOR AND POST (30 sec): Post the three checks on the anchor chart next to the Four-Step Accountability Structure. TEACHING TIP: Frame as a cognitive tool: 'Not about feeling better — about staying functional enough to actually fix it.' Common error: students using Check A to minimize impact before genuinely acknowledging it. Check A is precision, not minimization.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the Friend Test in Step 3, a student who gives their friend a genuinely warm, specific, forward-looking response — then appears visibly surprised when asked to say the same thing to themselves. **MAY SIGNAL** This student has functional empathy for others but a significant self-compassion deficit. The gap is visible to them in this moment. This is the curriculum working. **ACTION** Affirm quietly after class: 'That gap you noticed — that's exactly what this unit is about.' No further intervention needed. This student will be a strong presence through L6.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the Living Amend step, a student who describes ongoing harm caused to a specific named person with significant detail and activation. **MAY SIGNAL** A living amend toward ongoing significant harm may require more than behavioral change commitment — may need counselor support to navigate safely. **ACTION** Do not probe during class. After class: 'The situation you were thinking about — if you want to talk it through with someone who can really help, I can connect you with our counselor.' Follow disclosure protocol.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-10A and B4-10B B4-10A (RYN'S CONFESSION): Whole-class. Key: 'Accountability has four steps. Where is Ryn stuck?' She completed Step 1 but is caught between Step 1 and Step 4 — in self-punishment, not accountability. B4-10B (MARCUS AND THE MONEY): Pairs. Key: 'Design a living amend for Marcus — specific, observable, time-bound.'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The difference between accountability and self-punishment in my own words is _____. One time I punished myself when I could have been accountable is _____. A living amend I owe — rather than another apology — is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Accountability vs. Self-Punishment reflection and Living Amend prompt. Standard opt-out protocols apply. Students describing severe self-punishment in response to minor mistakes — flag for counselor before L7. Safe messaging guidelines apply throughout Unit 2.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most important conceptual distinction in Unit 2 outside L6: guilt vs. shame. Guilt = I did something that contradicts my values → repair. Shame = I am someone who contradicts my values → hiding, spiraling, avoidance. Make this distinction explicit. The Living Amend concept is among the most transferable tools in the curriculum — extended significantly in B5-U2-L1. Students who describe significant self-punishment patterns across L1 and L3 are your highest-risk students for L7. Brief counselor on any students fitting this profile before the Backpack Audit.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L3 · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students learned the difference between accountability (four-step process producing forward motion) and self-punishment (shame-based suffering that produces nothing useful). They were introduced to the living amend: genuine accountability measured not by the sincerity of an apology but by the consistency of behavioral change over time. Conversation-starter: 'Is there a difference between someone apologizing and someone actually changing? What does actually changing look like to you?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

THE ACCOUNTABILITY-PUNISHMENT DISTINCTION

7 MIN

'Accountability says: I made a choice that did not fit who I want to be. What do I need to do? Self-punishment says: I am bad. I will suffer.' Point to chart. 'The Internal Critic uses self-punishment to masquerade as conscience — look how bad I feel, that proves I care. But feeling bad is not the same as taking responsibility. Ryn confessed to her teacher — the accountable thing. Then she looped, replaying, catastrophizing, unable to rest. She confused suffering with accountability. They are not the same.'

2

THE FOUR-STEP ACCOUNTABILITY STRUCTURE

8 MIN

Write the four steps on the board as you teach. 'Circle Step 4 — Moving On. Suffering is not on this list. Feeling appropriately bad — yes, that is human and honest. Circling in shame for weeks — no. That is self-punishment masquerading as conscience.' Pairs: 'Name one situation where you held yourself accountable by this standard — all four steps. What happened?' No sharing required.

3

THE FRIEND TEST

8 MIN

'If your best friend came to you and said I did the same thing you just did — what would you say to them? Write that answer first.' [2 min private writing.] 'Now say the same thing to yourself about your own situation. The gap between what you would say to your friend and what you say to yourself is the size of the self-compassion adjustment you are being invited to make.' Distribute WS B4-U2-WS2 (Accountability Structure) — students complete Part 3 (Friend Test) now.

4

THE LIVING AMEND

5 MIN

'An apology is a statement. A living amend is sustained behavioral change over time.' Write: APOLOGY = statement. LIVING AMEND = sustained behavioral change. Students complete Part 4 (Living Amend) of WS B4-U2-WS2. Private. Never shared.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-10A

SUSTAINABLE ACCOUNTABILITY ★ SAFETY NOTE

THE SITUATION

After cheating on a test — a decision she made in a moment of panic and has regretted ever since — Ryn confessed to her teacher. The teacher was disappointed but did not escalate beyond the grade consequence. Ryn expected to feel better after confessing. Instead she found herself looping: replaying the moment, catastrophizing about who she is, unable to let it rest. 'I told the truth,' she said. 'Why can't I move on?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Ryn did the accountable thing — she confessed. What is preventing accountability from producing peace? What is the difference between the guilt that motivated Ryn's confession and the shame spiral she is now in? Accountability has four steps: honest acknowledgment, genuine repair, commitment to a different choice, and moving on. Where is Ryn stuck? What would Ryn's Compassionate Witness say to her about the difference between what she did and who she is?

B4-10B**SUSTAINABLE ACCOUNTABILITY ★ SAFETY NOTE****THE SITUATION**

Marcus borrowed money from a friend and didn't pay it back when he said he would — three times. Each time, he felt bad, apologized, and promised to do better. His friend eventually said: 'I don't need another apology. I need you to actually pay me back.' Marcus felt attacked. He thought: 'I said I was sorry. What more do they want?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What has Marcus confused about what an apology accomplishes? Marcus's friend says they want action, not words. What is the distinction — and is the friend being unfair? What is the difference between a genuine apology and a apology used to relieve the apologizer's discomfort? Design a living amend for Marcus — what would sustained behavioral change actually look like in this situation? **APOLOGY VS. LIVING AMEND** An apology is a statement. A living amend is a sustained behavioral change over time. The distinction matters because repeated apologies without changed behavior are not accountability — they are a pattern that eventually damages trust more than the original harm. Genuine accountability is measured not by how sincerely you apologize but by how consistently you act differently afterward.

Reclaiming the Narrative

45–50 min · November Week 1 · Standard — elevated emotional weight

OBJECTIVE	Students identify one inherited narrative, examine its accuracy, and write the first sentence of Chapter 3.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · November Week 1 · Standard — elevated emotional weight
KEY VOCABULARY	narrative · Chapter 1 / 2 / 3 · narrative agency · author · self-fulfilling narrative
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: accountability vs. self-punishment — what is a living amend?' [Answer.] 'Today: what happens when the story other people have told about you — or that you have told about yourself — becomes the whole story?'

ANCHOR CHART

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Many of us are carrying a story about ourselves that started on one bad day, in one relationship, or in one environment — and we have been living inside that story ever since, treating it as the whole truth about who we are. Today we look at that story — and ask who gets to write the next chapter.' [Post: 'Who is the author of your story — and is that who you want writing it?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 1, a student whose Chapter 2 story involves a specific named person — a parent, teacher, or coach — who told them something damaging and permanent about their worth.

MAY SIGNAL This student is touching material linked to a significant authority relationship. The Chapter 2 story originated with someone who had power over them. Qualitatively different from a self-generated narrative. **ACTION** Do not probe. After class: 'I noticed today might have brought up something significant. I'm available if you want to talk.' If student volunteers information about ongoing harm, follow disclosure protocol.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who stares at the page and writes nothing — or writes 'I don't know what Chapter 3 looks like.' **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be so inside their Chapter 2 story that Chapter 3 is not yet imaginable. This is not failure — it is where they are. **ACTION** Approach quietly: 'It doesn't have to be a big action. Something that takes 30 seconds. Something so small it barely counts — but it contradicts the story.' If still inaccessible, note for counselor.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 4 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-11A and B4-11B B4-11A (AMARA): Whole-class. 'Write Chapter 3 of Amara's story — the chapter she has not yet lived. What could it contain?' Then optionally for themselves. B4-11B (DARIUS): Pairs. 'Darius's story keeps producing evidence. Why is that evidence unreliable?' (Self-fulfilling narrative.) 'What small action begins his new narrative?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"A Chapter 2 story I have been carrying is _____. It started when _____. What a fair Compassionate Witness says about its accuracy is _____. The first sentence of my Chapter 3 is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most emotionally activating element: the Chapter 2 story with a specific named origin — a parent, teacher, or coach as author. Note privately and follow up. The Chapter 3 exercise works best when specific and behavioral — not 'I will be more confident' but 'I will say yes to the next opportunity even if I'm afraid.' This lesson connects directly to L6 — the Chapter 2 story is the script. Do not schedule before a holiday or long weekend.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

THE THREE CHAPTERS

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Amara stumbled in a math presentation in 8th grade. The class laughed. That is Chapter 1. Her Chapter 2: I am just not a speaker. That story has been running for three years. She has turned down opportunities. She has organized her life around a Chapter 2 story that started on one bad day.' Students write privately: 'A Chapter 2 story I have been carrying is _____. It started when _____. I have been living as if it were permanently true.'

2

NARRATIVE ACCURACY — THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS APPLIED

10 MIN

'The Compassionate Witness does not rewrite what happened. Chapter 1 is real. But Chapter 2 — I am just not a speaker — is not an accurate reading of Chapter 1. It is a generalization from one experience, applied permanently, across every future context.' Ask: 'What evidence would a fair Compassionate Witness consider about Amara's capacity as a speaker?' Take student responses. Students write: 'The evidence that my Chapter 2 story is not the whole truth includes _____.'

3

WRITE THE FIRST SENTENCE OF CHAPTER 3

7 MIN

'Chapter 3 is not a happy ending. It is the first action that contradicts the Chapter 2 story — the small thing you do before the new evidence exists. The action comes first. The new evidence follows.' Take 2–3 student responses on Amara's Chapter 3. Then: 'Students write: The first sentence of my Chapter 3 — the action, not the feeling — is ____.' 3 minutes private.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-11A**RECLAIMING THE NARRATIVE****THE SITUATION**

In eighth grade, Amara was publicly embarrassed during a math presentation. She stumbled, the class laughed, and the teacher didn't intervene. She has avoided any situation involving public speaking for three years. She has turned down opportunities, changed her course selections, and told herself 'I'm just not a speaker' — a story that started on one bad day in eighth grade. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the narrative Amara has been carrying — and where did it come from? Is Amara's story accurate? What evidence would a Compassionate Witness consider? The narrative 'I'm just not a speaker' started on one day. What has it cost her in the three years since? Write Chapter 3 of Amara's story — the chapter she has not yet lived. What could it contain? **NARRATIVE AGENCY** Chapter 1 is what happened. Chapter 2 is what you carried. Chapter 3 is what you choose. Many people live the rest of their lives repeating Chapter 2 without knowing Chapter 3 is available. Narrative agency is the capacity to become the author of your story — not by rewriting what happened, but by choosing what it means for what comes next.

B4-11B**RECLAIMING THE NARRATIVE****THE SITUATION**

When Darius's family moved during sophomore year, he told himself: 'I'll never have friends like the ones I left behind.' It became a self-fulfilling story. He stopped trying to connect with new people because the story told him the connections wouldn't be real anyway. Two years later he has acquaintances, not friends, and has convinced himself that's just who he is in this city. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Darius's narrative — and how has it shaped his behavior in a way that seems to confirm it? Darius's story feels true because it keeps producing evidence. Why is that evidence unreliable? The story 'I'll never have friends like those ones' may be true and also not the whole story. How can both be true? What would the first chapter of Darius's new narrative look like — what small action begins it? **THE SELF-FULFILLING NARRATIVE** When a story shapes our behavior in ways that produce the outcomes the story predicts, the story feels confirmed — even if it was never accurate. This is the self-fulfilling narrative: the prediction creates the data. Breaking it requires an action that contradicts the story before the story produces any evidence. The action comes first. The new evidence follows.

Self-care vs. Self-indulgence

45–50 min · November Week 2 · Standard — lighter lesson, use as consolidation

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish genuine self-care from avoidance masquerading as self-care and design one specific restorative practice for the coming week.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management (primary) · Self-Awareness (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · November Week 2 · Standard — lighter lesson, use as consolidation
KEY VOCABULARY	self-care · avoidance · restoration · capacity · restoration test · sustainable functioning
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: narrative agency — writing Chapter 3. Quick — what is the difference between Chapter 2 and Chapter 3?' [Answer.] 'Today is lighter. We look at what actually restores you — and what just feels like it does.'

ANCHOR CHART

GENUINE SELF-CARE LEAVES YOU MORE CAPABLE MORE PRESENT MORE YOURSELF PASSES: THE RESTORATION TEST

AVOIDANCE TEMPORARILY NUMBING LEAVES YOU LESS CAPABLE COST DEFERRED, NOT CANCELLED FAILS: THE RESTORATION TEST

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'The last four lessons have asked a lot. Today is different — shorter, lighter, more practical. We are looking at something you already do: taking care of yourself. The question is whether what you call self-care is actually restoring you.' [Post: 'Does your self-care actually restore you — or does it just feel like it does?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 2, a student who marks every self-care practice as genuinely restorative — no avoidance at all in their self-assessment. **MAY SIGNAL** Unusual at this age. May indicate genuine discernment — or difficulty being honest with themselves. Avoidance at 9–10 is nearly universal; its complete absence from self-report is data. **ACTION** In the design step: 'If you're already doing everything well — what is one area where your capacity is lower than you'd like? What practice might address that?'

UNIT 2 · LESSON 5 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-12A and B4-12B B4-12A (NIA'S WEEKEND): Whole-class. 'Was what Nia did self-care — or something else? Design a recovery weekend for Nia that is restorative rather than avoidant.' B4-12B (JONAH AND ROOMMATE): Pairs. 'The real test is not the activity — it is whether it genuinely restores capacity. How would you measure that? Design a self-care audit for yourself.'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"A practice I have been calling self-care that the Restoration Test suggests is actually avoidance is _____. A practice that genuinely restores my capacity is _____. The one restorative practice I am committing to this week is _____ at _____ for _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

This lesson is intentionally lighter — a processing and consolidation session before L6 and L7. Do not inject high-intensity content. The Restoration Test is the key tool. The design activity (one genuine restorative practice) is the primary artifact — specificity is the quality check. Before U2-L7: confirm counselor co-facilitation is locked. Review L1–L5 observations for students needing extra support. Students who cannot identify any Compassionate Witness response across L1, L3, and L5 are your highest-risk students for L7. Brief counselor specifically before the Backpack Audit.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

THE RESTORATION TEST

7 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Self-care is a word that has been stretched to mean almost anything. The test is not the activity — it is the function it serves. Does this practice, consistently applied, leave you more capable, more present, more yourself?' Write: THE RESTORATION TEST: 'More capable, more present, more myself — after?' 'Nia spends the weekend watching TV, sleeping until noon, avoiding her to-do list. By Sunday night she feels worse than Friday. She calls it self-care. What is actually happening?'

2

THE DIFFERENCE IN PRACTICE

8 MIN

'The gaming might be genuine restoration for the roommate. The running might be self-punishment for Jonah. Neither can be assessed from the outside. Only the Restoration Test, applied honestly from the inside, gives you the answer.' Students run the Restoration Test on their own top 3 claimed self-care practices. Private.

3

DESIGN ONE GENUINE RESTORATIVE PRACTICE

7 MIN

'For this week: design one practice that will genuinely leave you more capable, more present, more yourself. Not what sounds good. What actually works for you — and that you will honestly do.' Specifics required: what, when, how long. Circulate and check for specificity — 'I will rest more' is not a practice. 'I will take a 20-minute walk with no headphones on Tuesday and Thursday after school' is.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-12A**SELF-CARE VS. SELF-INDULGENCE****THE SITUATION**

After a brutal exam week, Nia tells herself she deserves a break. She spends the entire weekend watching TV, sleeping until noon, and avoiding everything on her to-do list. By Sunday night she feels worse than she did Friday — lethargic, anxious, slightly ashamed. 'I took care of myself,' she tells a friend. 'Why do I feel worse?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Was what Nia did self-care — or something else? How would you distinguish between them? Nia feels worse after the 'break.' What does that suggest about the relationship between avoidance and restoration? What would genuine restoration have looked like for Nia — what would have actually rebuilt her capacity? Design a 'recovery weekend' for Nia that is genuinely restorative rather than avoidant. **SELF-CARE VS. AVOIDANCE** Self-care is a practice that genuinely restores your capacity for sustained effort and authentic engagement. Avoidance masquerades as self-care — it temporarily relieves discomfort without building anything. The test: does this practice, over time, leave you more capable or less? Nia's weekend reduced her anxiety in the short term and left her less resourced on Monday. Genuine self-care would have felt harder in the moment and produced more on the other side.

B4-12B**SELF-CARE VS. SELF-INDULGENCE**

THE SITUATION

Jonah's self-care is a thirty-minute run every morning. His roommate's self-care is two hours of video games every evening. Jonah thinks his roommate is wasting time. His roommate thinks Jonah is performing wellness. Neither of them is entirely wrong about the other — and neither has asked whether what they're doing is actually working. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Jonah's run self-care — and is the roommate's gaming self-indulgence? What questions would you ask to find out? The real test is not the activity — it is whether the activity genuinely restores capacity. How would you measure that? Jonah and his roommate are judging each other's practices. What is each of them missing? Design your own self-care audit: What are you currently doing that restores you — and what are you doing that only feels like it does? **THE**

RESTORATION TEST The test for genuine self-care is not the activity itself — it is the function it serves. Does this practice, consistently applied, leave you more capable, more present, and more yourself? If yes, it is self-care regardless of how it looks. If no, it is avoidance regardless of how virtuous it sounds. The running, the gaming, the journaling, the nap — none of these is inherently restorative. What matters is whether it actually restores.

The Compassionate Witness

45–55 min · November Week 3

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students practice the Compassionate Witness through the Friend Test and write a sustained Compassionate Witness statement about a current situation.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management (primary) · Self-Awareness (primary)
DURATION	45–55 min · November Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	Compassionate Witness · Friend Test · gap · honest + fair + kind · Internal Critic · self-compassion
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the Restoration Test. Quick — what is the single test for genuine self-care?' [Answer.] 'Today: the Compassionate Witness. We have been building it since L1. Today we practice it — with each other as mirrors.'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Psychological self-examination. Counselor on standby and reachable same day. Standard opt-out protocols. Students who cannot access any Compassionate Witness response across L1, L3, and L5 must be individually briefed to counselor BEFORE this lesson. Do not deliver L7 without this conversation.

ANCHOR CHART

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS — THE FRIEND TEST LEFT BUBBLE: What I would say to my best friend in this situation. Honest · Fair · Kind. Without punishment. RIGHT BUBBLE: What I actually say to myself. Often harsh. I would never say this to a friend. CENTRAL QUESTION: What is the gap — and what does that gap tell you? THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS IS NOT A CHEERLEADER. It holds you with the same honest care you would extend to someone you genuinely respect and love. The skill you already have is empathy toward friends. We are redirecting it toward yourself. POST: Before class. KEEP: Unit 2 and Unit 3.

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Think about your closest friend. If they came to you in a genuinely hard moment — they had just failed something important, made a mistake they were ashamed of, been hurt by someone they trusted — how would you talk to them? Now: is that how you talk to yourself in the same situation? Today we look at that gap.' [Post: 'The skill you already have is empathy toward friends. Can you redirect it toward yourself?']

UNIT 2 · LESSON 6 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE Before L7 — observe during this lesson: a student who is unable to access any Compassionate Witness response after the full Friend Test exercise. **MAY SIGNAL** A student who cannot access the Compassionate Witness after L1, L3, L5, and now L6 may have deeply entrenched self-critical patterns with no accessible counter-voice. Most significant risk indicator for L7. **ACTION** Raise with counselor before L7 — specifically flag as needing additional individual support during the ★★ Backpack Audit. Do not wait until L7 to make this call.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During partner practice in Step 2, a student who shares significantly more personal content than the activity requires — more like unburdening than practicing. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be using the partner structure as a disclosure vehicle. Content may be appropriate — or may exceed Tier 1 scope. **ACTION** Do not interrupt. After class: check in with both students privately. If content suggests significant distress or harm, follow disclosure protocol. Brief counselor.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-13A and B4-13B B4-13A (PRIYA'S SCIENCE COMPETITION): Whole-class before partner practice. Key: 'What would the Compassionate Witness say to Priya — honest AND kind? What does her current self-assessment miss?' B4-13B (MARCUS'S COACH): Pairs after partner practice. Key: 'Marcus didn't know he was practicing self-compassion. What does that suggest about what self-compassion actually looks like in practice?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"One thing I am currently being harder on myself about than I would be on my best friend is _____. My Friend Test response to myself — honest, fair, kind — is _____. The Compassionate Witness sounds like _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Friend Test partner practice and Compassionate Witness statement. Standard opt-out protocols apply. Counselor on standby — reachable same day. Students who cannot access any Compassionate Witness response across L1, L3, L5, and now L6 must be individually briefed to counselor BEFORE L7. Do not deliver L7 without this conversation.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 6 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

TEACHER REFLECTION

Partner practice is the highest personal disclosure risk of any non-★★ lesson. Students choose partners and level of sharing — your facilitation role is to hold the space and observe, not direct or join. Before L7: confirm counselor co-facilitation is set. Review L1–L6 observations. Students who cannot identify any Compassionate Witness response across all of Unit 2 are highest-risk for L7. Brief the counselor specifically on these students before the Backpack Audit — do not wait.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L6 · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students practiced the Compassionate Witness — applying to themselves the same honesty, fairness, and care they naturally extend to close friends. They used the Friend Test: 'Would I say this to my best friend in the same situation?' When your student is being hard on themselves, try asking: 'Would you say that to your best friend?' Then listen. That question alone is the Compassionate Witness in action. Conversation-starter: 'What would you say to a close friend who made the mistake you're beating yourself up about right now?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

THE FRIEND TEST — THE FOUNDATION

7 MIN

'When your Internal Critic is speaking — ask: would I say this to my closest friend in the same situation? If the answer is no — the critic is not being fair.' Point to both speech bubbles. 'The skill you already have is empathy toward friends. The Compassionate Witness is that same skill redirected inward.' Priya after the science competition: spent the drive home reviewing every mistake. What she would have said to her friend vs. what she said to herself. The gap.

2

PARTNER PRACTICE — STUDENT CHOICE 'STUDENT CHOICE —

15 MIN

pick someone you are comfortable with. Each of you: identify one situation where you have been harder on yourself than you would be on your best friend. Share only what you choose — not with the class. Your partner responds as they would to a friend in the same situation. Then switch.' 12 minutes full exchange. Teacher circulates — do not approach pairs who appear deeply engaged. After: 'What you just gave each other — that is the Compassionate Witness in practice.'

3

WRITE THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS STATEMENT

8 MIN

'Using what your partner just gave you — write a new Compassionate Witness statement about your own current situation. If my friend was going through this, I would say _____. So I am saying it to myself: ____.' 5 minutes private. This is the primary artifact of L6. 'The Compassionate Witness is not the end of the Internal Critic. But now you have a counter-voice — honest, fair, and kind.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-13A

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS ★ SAFETY NOTE

THE SITUATION

Priya spent three months preparing for a regional science competition. She didn't place. On the way home, she reviewed every mistake she made in the presentation — the fumbled transition, the nervous moment, the answer she partially blanked on. She listed them in her journal. When she imagined her best friend telling her the same story, she would have said: 'You prepared for three months. You made it to regionals. You learned what the next level takes.' She did not say that to herself. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the gap between how Priya treats her own performance and how she would treat her best friend's? Priya's list is accurate — she did fumble those moments. Does accuracy make her self-assessment fair? The Compassionate Witness is honest AND kind. What would it say to Priya that her current self-assessment does not? Why do we so reliably apply different standards to ourselves than to the people we love? **THE FRIEND TEST** The Compassionate Witness asks: what would the version of me that I'm proud of say to my best friend if they had done exactly what I just did? The gap between that answer and what we actually say to ourselves is the size of the adjustment we are being invited to make. Accuracy and fairness are not the same thing. You can be accurate about your mistakes while being profoundly unfair to yourself about what they mean.

B4-13B**THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS ★ SAFETY NOTE****THE SITUATION**

Before he knew what the Compassionate Witness was, Marcus had a version of it he called 'the coach.' When something went wrong, he would ask: 'What would Coach say?' The coach in his head was honest — never sugarcoating — but also never condemned Marcus as a person. 'You made the wrong read,' the coach would say. 'Here's what you see next time.' Marcus didn't realize he had been applying self-compassion. He just thought he had a good coach. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What does Marcus's 'coach' do that his Inner Critic doesn't — and what do they have in common? The coach is honest and does not sugarcoat. Is the Compassionate Witness the same as a cheerleader? Marcus didn't know he was practicing self-compassion. What does that suggest about what self-compassion actually looks like in practice? Build your own version of the Compassionate Witness — give it a name or a voice. What does it sound like when it speaks to you? **THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS IN PRACTICE** The Compassionate Witness is not a cheerleader. It does not tell you things are fine when they are not. It holds you with the same honest care you would extend to someone you genuinely respect and love — someone whose growth matters to you. It is specific, fair, forward-pointing, and kind. Research on self-compassion shows that this kind of internal voice is associated with greater resilience, not lesser accountability.

The Backpack Audit

50–55 min · December Week 1 · Unit 2 culminating lesson

★★ HIGHEST RISK · COUNSELOR REQUIRED

OBJECTIVE	Students inventory their psychological weight, examine each stone with the Compassionate Witness, and make a deliberate choice about what to put down and what to carry forward.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (synthesis) · Self-Management (regulation and release)
DURATION	50–55 min · December Week 1 · Unit 2 culminating lesson
MATERIALS	WS B4-U2-WS3 (Backpack Audit — placed FACE-DOWN before students enter) · All Unit 2 anchor charts displayed · Scenario Cards B4-14A and B4-14B (counselor present before distributing)
OPENING REVIEW	SKIP. Begin with the full 3-minute opening ritual. The counselor is already in the room.

NOTE

★★ HIGHEST RISK — COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY IN ROOM — ALL REQUIREMENTS BELOW MANDATORY
Counselor PHYSICALLY IN THE ROOM before the first student enters — not on-call, not in the hallway, IN THE ROOM. Crisis resources posted VISIBLY: 988 Lifeline · Crisis Text Line: HOME to 741741. Lesson NOT scheduled before a holiday, weekend, break, or fire-drill day. No substitute teacher present — only delivering teacher and counselor. You have briefed the counselor on students who showed concerning patterns in L1–L6. Backpack Audit Worksheets placed FACE-DOWN at each seat before students enter. You have confirmed you have enough time to reach the closing ritual — if not, DO NOT START. You have taken 60 seconds to settle yourself before students arrive. Your regulated presence is the room's most important safety tool.

NOTE

COUNSELOR CO-FACILITATION ROLE Sit where you can observe all students without being the centre of attention. Primary job: notice — students who stop writing, leave the room, or show visible distress. If a student leaves the room: COUNSELOR FOLLOWS IMMEDIATELY. Teacher stays with the class. After class: MANDATORY same-day debrief with the teacher — regardless of whether a disclosure occurred. The debrief is for the teacher's state as much as for student follow-up.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

ANCHOR CHART

S — DISPLAYED SIMULTANEOUSLY Post all Unit 2 charts visible from every seat before class begins: · Perfectionism Spectrum (L1) · Failure as Data / Not Yet Lens (L2) · Accountability vs. Self-Punishment (L3) · Three Chapters / Narrative Agency (L4) · Self-Care vs. Avoidance / Restoration Test (L5) · Friend Test / Compassionate Witness (L6) · Signal vs. Noise / Internal Coach (Unit 1 — PERMANENT) Return student journals from L1 (Perfectionism prompt) before class begins.

OPENING RITUAL

3 FULL MINUTES — DO NOT SHORTEN 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 15 seconds. The counselor holds the room with you.] 'We all carry things. Experiences, words someone said, choices we made that we are not proud of, things done to us that we never asked for. Some of these have been in our backpack for so long they feel like part of who we are — when they are actually just heavy.' 'Today we look at what is in the backpack. Not to be dramatic about it — but because you are about to cross a significant threshold, and what you carry across it matters.' [Pause 30 seconds. Do not fill it. The counselor holds the room with you.] 'Everything today is private. The worksheet in front of you will not be read by me or by anyone else. What you write belongs to you. You may choose what to do with it at the end of this lesson.'

NOTE

WHAT TO SAY during this lesson — post on your desk 'You do not have to write more than you have.' 'One word is enough if it is true.' 'The Compassionate Witness does not have to feel true yet. Writing it is the beginning.'

NOTE

WHAT NOT TO SAY during this lesson 'Can you tell me more about what is in your backpack?' — Do not probe. 'Share one stone with your partner.' — Never for this lesson. 'I think you'll feel so much better after you do this.' — Do not promise outcomes. 'Try to get something down — even a sentence.' — Do not pressure production.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE A student who stops writing after Section 1 — naming the stones — and stares or puts their head down. **MAY SIGNAL** Identifying specific psychological weight may be more activating than anticipated — particularly if a stone involves abuse, trauma, or loss. **ACTION** Counselor approaches quietly. Teacher remains with class. Counselor: 'You don't have to write more than you have. You can just sit with it.' Follow disclosure protocol if student speaks.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE A student who leaves the room during the Backpack Audit. **MAY SIGNAL** Highest-disclosure-risk moment of Book 4. Leaving during private writing is a significant signal. **ACTION COUNSELOR FOLLOWS IMMEDIATELY.** Teacher stays with class. Say to class: 'Keep working.' Do not draw attention. Counselor follows the six-step disclosure protocol.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE A student who tears up the worksheet or covers it — then appears very still and withdrawn during Step 3. **MAY SIGNAL** The Compassionate Witness sentence — extending fairness to themselves about their heaviest stone — may be the first time this student has ever considered they deserve that fairness. That realization can be destabilizing before it becomes liberating. **ACTION** Do not retrieve. Do not approach to console. Hold the room. Counselor monitors. After class: mandatory same-day debrief protocol.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-14A and B4-14B ★★ COUNSELOR MUST BE PRESENT BEFORE DISTRIBUTING EITHER CARD. Use ONLY if the room has full capacity after the Audit — do not rush to the scenario cards. B4-14A (FATIMA'S THREE STONES): 'Which of Fatima's stones, if put down, would give her the most capacity — and what would it mean to put it down?' B4-14B (DARIUS'S INVISIBILITY): 'The solution that helped Darius in middle school is now working against him. How do we know when a survival strategy has outlived its usefulness?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The stone I am choosing to put down before Unit 3 is _____. The Compassionate Witness sentence about my heaviest stone is _____. The most important thing I am carrying from Unit 2 into Unit 3 is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★★ HIGHEST RISK · PPRA NOTICE

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★★ HIGHEST RISK LESSON OF BOOK 4. Counselor physically in room — no exceptions. Safe messaging guidelines apply throughout. Do not schedule before any break. No substitute teacher. Crisis resources visibly posted. **MANDATORY** same-day counselor debrief regardless of disclosure. The Backpack Audit **CANNOT** be split across two sessions — if you cannot finish, do not start.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

TEACHER REFLECTION

This is the highest-disclosure-risk lesson of Book 4. Your regulated nervous system is the room's most important safety tool. After this lesson — brief your counselor for your own state, not just for student disclosures. These lessons cost something. That is them working. If you find yourself carrying students' material — difficulty sleeping, intrusive thoughts, heightened reactivity — that is secondary trauma. Speak to your counselor or a mental health professional. Teacher wellbeing is curriculum fidelity. A dysregulated teacher cannot hold a regulated room. MANDATORY same-day debrief. Do not skip it.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L7 · ★★ COUNSELOR CO-FACILITATED Dear Families, Today was one of the most significant lessons of the school year. The school counselor co-facilitated alongside the classroom teacher. Students completed the Backpack Audit — a private, written inventory of the psychological weight they have been carrying: experiences, guilt, shame, relationships, and meanings made from past events. They were asked to examine each stone with the Compassionate Witness they have been building across Unit 2, and make a deliberate choice about what to put down and what to carry forward. The Backpack Audit worksheet was never collected. Students were told they could keep it, seal it, or tear it up — all choices were honored without comment. If your student seems reflective or quiet this evening, that is a healthy response to significant interior work. Please do not press for details about what they wrote. If they seem distressed — more than reflective — please contact the school counselor directly: Counselor: _____ Contact: _____ Conversation-starter (gentle, low-pressure): "Is there anything you've been carrying for a while that you've been thinking about lately? I'm here if you want to talk — no agenda, just listening." Unit 3 begins next week. It builds directly on everything students worked through in Unit 2.

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE — BEFORE DISTRIBUTING 'This worksheet is private. You will mark it and keep it. No one will read it. The only question it is asking is: where are you right now — honestly — in these four areas of your life.' CRITICAL: Spectrum marks are NEVER shared publicly. Do not ask 'who marked themselves on the left side?' under any circumstances.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U2-WS1 · PERFECTIONISM SPECTRUM · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 2, Lesson 1 Name _____ (optional): _____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. Mark what is actually true. PERFECTIONISM ◀──▶ HEALTHY STRIVING

'Failure = I am worthless.' 'Failure = data I can learn from.' SCHOOL / ACADEMICS PERFECTIONISM
 _____ HEALTHY STRIVING The fear underneath: _____
 _____ MY MAIN ACTIVITY (sport, art, music, work, other: _____) PERFECTIONISM _____ HEALTHY STRIVING The fear underneath: _____
 SOCIAL LIFE / FRIENDSHIPS PERFECTIONISM
 _____ HEALTHY STRIVING The fear underneath: _____
 _____ FAMILY PERFECTIONISM
 _____ HEALTHY STRIVING The fear underneath: _____
 _____ COMPASSIONATE WITNESS CHECK: The domain where perfectionism is loudest: _____ If my best friend showed me their spectrum, I would say to them: _____ That same thing — said to myself: _____
 _____ One specific thing I could do differently in the domain I'm most ready to shift: _____
 Grades 11-12 TRANSITION DOMAIN: About the transition ahead — PERFECTIONISM
 _____ HEALTHY STRIVING · Fear: _____

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE — BEFORE DISTRIBUTING 'This applies everything from direct instruction to a real situation in your own life. You choose the situation — a small one where you have been stuck in self-punishment rather than accountability works perfectly.' CRITICAL: Step 4 (Living Amend) may surface situations involving harm to a specific named person. Follow disclosure protocol if a student approaches you during this activity.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U2-WS2 · ACCOUNTABILITY STRUCTURE · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 2, Lesson 3 Name (optional): _____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. Write what is actually true. PART 1 — THE SITUATION: A situation where I made a choice that did not fit who I want to be: _____ How long I have been carrying this: _____ My current response (circle): Self-punishment / Avoidance / Accountability / Not sure PART 2 — THE FOUR-STEP ACCOUNTABILITY STRUCTURE: Step 1 — HONEST ACKNOWLEDGMENT (what I chose, and what it cost): _____ Step 2 — GENUINE REPAIR (what actual repair is available): _____ Step 3 — COMMITMENT TO A DIFFERENT CHOICE (specific, behavioral, real): _____ Step 4 — MOVING ON (what I am giving myself permission to stop doing): _____ PART 3 — THE FRIEND TEST: If my best friend came to me in this exact situation, I would say: _____ Now say that same thing to yourself: _____ THE GAP — what is different between those two responses: _____ PART 4 — THE LIVING AMEND (if applicable): Is there a situation where I owe a living amend — sustained behavioral change — rather than another apology? Yes / No / Not sure If yes — the specific behavioral change: I will _____ Starting: _____ How I will know it is working: _____

NOTE

★★ CLINICAL CARE NOTE — READ BEFORE PRINTING The Backpack Audit Worksheet is the highest-risk reproducible in Book 4. Print exactly the number of students in class. No extras left in the room. Place FACE-DOWN at each seat before students arrive. Do not draw attention to the paper. COLLECTION: NEVER. Students keep, seal, or dispose of their worksheet as they choose. If a student leaves a worksheet on their desk when they leave: do not read it. Place in an envelope. Offer it to the student privately. CRISIS RESOURCES: Printed at the bottom of the worksheet. Fill in counselor contact before printing.

NOTE

TEACHER INTRODUCTION SCRIPT — VERBATIM 'The paper in front of you — face-down — is the Backpack Audit.' 'Turn it over only when you are ready.' 'Everything you write belongs to you. I will not read it. The counselor will not read it.' 'At the end of this lesson you will decide what to do with it — keep it, seal it, or tear it up. All of those choices are fine.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'When you are ready — turn it over and begin with Section 1.'

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U2-WS3 · THE BACKPACK AUDIT · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 2, Lesson 7 This is yours. It will not be collected or read by anyone unless you choose. Work through each section in order. Take your time.

SECTION 1 — NAME THE STONES: A stone is not just what happened. It is what you have been carrying because of it. Stone 1: _____ How long: _____ Stone 2:

_____ How long: _____ Stone 3: _____ How

long: _____ Stone 4 (if ready): _____ Stone 5 (if

ready): _____ The heaviest stone right now:

_____ SECTION 2 — EXAMINE THE HEAVIEST STONE: Is this stone

mine to carry — or placed in my pack by someone else? Mine / Placed by someone else / Both / Not sure

What have I been believing about myself because of this stone? _____

_____ Is that belief accurate — or the story

the stone tells, not the whole truth? _____

_____ What would a fair, honest, kind

Compassionate Witness say about this stone? _____

_____ Is this stone a survival strategy that

may have outlived its usefulness? Yes / No / Not sure / I need more time with this question SECTION 3 —

THE DELIBERATE CHOICE: One stone I am choosing to PUT DOWN before Unit 3: _____

What putting it down means in practice: _____ One stone I am choosing to

CARRY FORWARD — because it still matters: _____ Why I am carrying it:

_____ One stone I am NOT READY to decide about yet —

giving myself permission to leave undecided: _____

SECTION 4 — THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS CLOSING: What the Compassionate Witness says to me

about the weight I have been carrying:

_____ The sentence I am taking from this

audit into Unit 3: _____

_____ What I choose to do with this paper:

[] Keep it [] Seal it [] Tear it up — — — — —

CRISIS RESOURCES: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: call or text 988 Crisis Text Line: text HOME to 741741

School Counselor: _____ [Fill in before printing] If something came up today that feels too

heavy to carry alone — you do not have to.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

NOTE

Block ALL dates below BEFORE Unit 2 Lesson 1 is delivered. The ★★ L7 date must be blocked at the START of Unit 2.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

LESSON RISK COUNSELOR REQUIREMENT SCHEDULING CONSTRAINTS L1: Perfectionism Weight ★ Brief counselor 2 days before. Awareness only. Flag: any student marking far left across ALL domains for counselor awareness before L7. L2: Not Yet Lens Standard No requirement. Standard disclosure protocol active. No constraint. Lighter lesson. L3: Sustainable Accountability ★ + R&R Brief counselor on R&R Strand Touchpoint 2. Awareness only. Reachable same day. Moderate disclosure risk. Monday–Wednesday preferred. L4: Reclaiming the Narrative Standard No requirement. Higher emotional weight — counselor awareness recommended. Do not schedule before holiday or long weekend. L5: Self-Care vs. Avoidance Standard No requirement. Lighter lesson. No constraint. L6: Compassionate Witness ★ Brief counselor. On standby — reachable same day. Monday–Wednesday preferred. Not before holiday/weekend. Brief counselor on any students who still cannot access Compassionate Witness response. L7: Backpack Audit ★★ COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY IN ROOM. Block this date at START of Unit 2. Monday–Wednesday ONLY. No holiday/break within 3 school days. No substitute. No fire drills. Full 55 min required. Mandatory same-day debrief.

NOTE

STANDING — BEFORE UNIT 2 LESSON 1 ★★ BACKPACK AUDIT DATE BLOCKED — confirmed with counselor and administration before Unit 2 begins. Crisis resources posted VISIBLY in classroom (if not already from Unit 1). STAY POSTED for the rest of the year. Counselor and teacher review Unit 2 overview together. Both have read the L7 co-facilitation protocol. Communication channel confirmed: how teacher signals counselor during a lesson. Teacher shares Unit 1 debrief observations — students entering Unit 2 with high emotional load identified. Counselor identifies any students who may need individual contact before L7.

NOTE

AFTER UNIT 2 LESSON 7 — ★★ MANDATORY SAME-DAY DEBRIEF Teacher and counselor meet SAME DAY as L7 delivery — before end of school if possible. REVIEW: Students who showed concerning signals during the Audit (stopped writing, left room, visible distress). FOLLOW-UP: Any disclosure received — confirm appropriate referral and documentation. IDENTIFY: Students entering Unit 3 who may need individual counselor contact before L1. TEACHER STATE: Counselor explicitly checks in on the teacher's own state. 'How are you doing after today?' is not optional. It is part of the protocol. Secondary trauma is real. If the teacher is carrying student material — name it and address it. DOCUMENTATION: Counselor documents disclosures per school protocol. UNIT 3 BRIEF: Before Unit 3 Lesson 1 — confirm readiness together. Unit 3 carries significant forgiveness content.

NOTE

Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Unit 2: Resilience Through Self-Kindness · COMPLETE MERGED DOCUMENT Tier 1 (Lesson Interiors) + Tier 2 (Operational Layer) · Merge verified — no conflicts School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden, Founder · Pilot Version CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only NEXT: Book 4 Unit 3 — Conflict & Context: Empathy & Forgiveness

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

Unit Duration January–March · 7 Lessons · 45–55 minutes each Essential Question What do I do with the people who have hurt me — and with the people I have hurt — without losing myself in either direction? Risk Profile L2 ★ PPRA (highest-disclosure-risk standard lesson) · L3 ★ PPRA · L5 ★ PPRA Version Pilot · CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

Letters: L2 ★, L3 ★, L5 ★ (Tier 2) Counselor Coordination Calendar: Unit 3 entries (Tier 2) MERGE STATUS: Clean — no conflicts. All elements verified.

NOTE

UNIT 3 STANDING NOTE The forgiveness/reconciliation distinction (L2) is the most important concept in the entire 9–12 arc. The Boundary of Peace (L3) is the most clinically sensitive standard lesson in Book 4. Deliver in sequence. Do not skip lessons or reorder. Both Forgiveness and Reconciliation anchor charts are PERMANENT — they do not come down.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

WHAT THE BACKPACK IS

5 MIN

'The backpack is a metaphor for psychological weight. Stones are not just what happened — they are what you have been carrying because of it. The meaning made, the guilt carried, the shame that settled in, the relationships that ended badly.' Write: A stone is not just what happened. It is what you have been carrying because of it.

2

THE BACKPACK AUDIT — PRIMARY ACTIVITY

18 MIN

'The worksheet in front of you is the Backpack Audit. Turn it over only when you are ready. Work through each section privately, in order. I will not be reading what you write. The counselor will not be reading what you write. This belongs to you.' [TEACHER STEPS BACK. Students work completely independently. No pairs. No sharing. Full 18 minutes. Teacher and counselor observe quietly.]

3

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS APPLIED TO THE BACKPACK

5 MIN

'Look at what is in your backpack. Apply the Compassionate Witness to each stone. Not to minimize it — but to ask: is this stone mine to carry? Is what I have been believing about this stone accurate? What would the Compassionate Witness say about the heaviest thing in my pack?' Students write one Compassionate Witness sentence for their heaviest stone. Private.

4

THE DELIBERATE CHOICE

4 MIN

'Not every stone needs to be put down today. Some are worth carrying. Some you may not be ready to put down — and that is honest and true. What matters is that the choice is deliberate.' Students write: 'One stone I am choosing to put down before Unit 3 is _____. One stone I am choosing to carry forward is _____.' Private.

5

THE CLOSING RITUAL

3 MIN

Allow time for the ritual. Closing script — deliver verbatim: 'Decide what to do with what you wrote. Keep it. Seal it. Tear it up. Whatever this moment asks for.' Allow time. Then: 'What you did — or did not do — today is entirely yours. This was not a performance for me. It was for you. The Compassionate Witness that you have been building across this unit — it is yours now. And Unit 3 begins on the other side of what you just did.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-14A**THE BACKPACK AUDIT ★★ HIGH DISCLOSURE****THE SITUATION**

When Fatima looks at her backpack — the inventory of psychological weight she has been carrying — she finds she has three stones: a teacher who told her in sixth grade that she 'wasn't a math person,' her parents' divorce in seventh grade and the guilt she still carries about somehow not being enough to hold things together, and a friendship that ended badly in ninth grade where she was the one who ended it and has never stopped wondering if she was wrong. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which of Fatima's three stones is the heaviest — and why? Fatima is still carrying guilt about her parents' divorce. What would the Compassionate Witness say about a seventh-grader's role in an adult relationship ending? The friendship stone is complicated — Fatima was the one who ended it. How do you carry guilt about your own choice? Which stone, if put down, would give Fatima the most capacity — and what would it mean to put it down?

THE BACKPACK AUDIT The Backpack Audit is not about minimizing what you carry. It is about seeing it clearly — naming each stone, assessing its weight, and making a deliberate choice about what to put down before you cross the next threshold. Some stones are worth carrying. Some have been carried so long that they feel like part of who you are — when they are actually just heavy.

B4-14B**THE BACKPACK AUDIT ★★ HIGH DISCLOSURE**

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

THE SITUATION

Darius has one stone that weighs more than all the others: he was bullied systematically in middle school and never told anyone. He learned to make himself invisible. He got good at it. Now in high school he realizes the invisibility was a solution to a problem that no longer exists — but he doesn't know how to stop. He has been quiet in every class for four years. He carries the middle school version of himself everywhere.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is the stone Darius is carrying — and what solution did he build around it? The solution that helped Darius in middle school is now working against him. How do we know when a survival strategy has outlived its usefulness? Darius is carrying the middle school version of himself. What would it mean to put that version down? What would the first stone Darius might choose to put down be — and what would carrying forward look like for him? **STONES AND SURVIVAL STRATEGIES** Sometimes what we carry is not just a wound — it is a response to a wound that became habitual. Invisibility was Darius's survival strategy. It worked in middle school. It is not serving him now. Recognizing the difference between a stone and the strategy you built to manage it is the first step toward putting down the weight — and choosing what to carry forward instead.

WORKSHEET · REPRODUCIBLE

The Backpack Audit

Book 5 **Unit 2 Lesson 7

SAFETY NOTE

★★ **PRIVATE** • This worksheet is private. It is never collected, graded, or shared. The Reflection Pass is available at all times.

Name _____ Grade _____ Date _____

MY BACKPACK AUDIT · PRIVATE

THE INVENTORY — WHAT AM I CARRYING?

Academic shame (labels received, failures still felt, things told to me about my capacity)

_____ **Social wounds** (moments of exclusion, betrayal, or cruelty that still have weight) _____

_____ **Family weight** (expectations, patterns, or hurt that came from home) _____

_____ **Self-labels** (things I call myself when things go wrong — the names I have accepted)

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

THE HEAVIEST STONE

Name it: _____ How long have you been carrying it?
_____ What has it cost you? _____

THE CHOICE

What I am choosing to put down: _____ What I am choosing to carry forward:
_____ What carrying forward means: _____

THE LETTER TO THE STONE

Written to the weight, not to the person.

Dear _____ ,

I am choosing to put you down because:

What I am keeping:

BOOK 4

UNIT 3

CONFLICT & CONTEXT

EMPATHY & FORGIVING OTHERS

CONFLICT AS INFORMATION	CONTEXTUAL EMPATHY
L2 FORGIVENESS vs. RECONCILIATION	L6 The Grace Challenge
L3 The Boundary of Peace	L7 Unit Reflection — the Grace Audit
L4 CALLING IN vs. CALLING OUT	

Conflict As Information

45–50 min · January Week 1 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish conflict as data from conflict as threat, identify their dominant conflict pattern, and apply the conflict-as-data reframe to one current situation.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · January Week 1 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	conflict as data · conflict as threat · fight · flight · freeze · fawn · unmet need · values friction
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-15A, B4-15B · WS B4-U3-WS1 (Conflict Pattern)
OPENING REVIEW	'Unit 2 ended with the Backpack Audit. Today Unit 3 begins. The question shifts outward: what do I do with the people who have hurt me — and with the people I have hurt? Today: what is conflict actually trying to tell you?'

ANCHOR CHART

WHAT CONFLICT SIGNALS A VALUE HAS BEEN
CROSSED A NEED HAS NOT BEEN
MET A BOUNDARY HAS BEEN
IGNORED A TRUTH NEEDS NAMING

WHAT CONFLICT IS NOT EVIDENCE OF FAILURE SOMETHING TO ALWAYS AVOID
PROOF SOMEONE IS WRONG A THREAT — IT IS INFORMATION

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Unit 3 begins today. The question turns outward. Not what do I do with the voice inside that judges me — what do I do with the people who have hurt me, and the people I have hurt, without losing myself in either direction? Today we start with the basics: what is conflict actually trying to tell you?' [Post: 'What is the conflict in your life right now trying to tell you — if you listened to it as data?']

UNIT 3 · LESSON 1 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 2, a student who marks FAWN as dominant across every context — family, friendships, school, relationships — without variation. **MAY SIGNAL** Pervasive fawning is a survival pattern, often developed in response to high-consequence adult conflict. Not a relationship skill deficit. **ACTION** Note privately. Monitor through L3 (Boundary of Peace) — brief counselor before L3 if pattern appears across multiple students.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who cannot name a single relationship where they respond to conflict — who describes avoiding all conflict entirely. **MAY SIGNAL** Total conflict avoidance may indicate significant anxiety about relational disruption, or an environment where conflict has historically been unsafe. **ACTION** After class: 'Conflict feels like something to stay away from entirely for you — that makes sense. I'd like to talk more about it at some point.' Plant the door without pressing.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-15A and B4-15B B4-15A (NIA AND HER MOM): Whole-class. Key: 'What is this conflict signaling as data? Which pattern is Nia using — and what is it costing her?' B4-15B (DARIUS AND THE GROUP PROJECT): Pairs. Key: 'Darius freezes. What does he lose — and what would responding differently have looked like?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"My dominant conflict pattern is _____. The context where it costs me the most is _____. If I read the conflict in that context as data, the signal it is sending is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The FAWN pattern is the most common dominant pattern among students who have developed strong social performance muscles — they are often rewarded for it and don't recognize it as a pattern. Name it carefully: 'Fawning is not kindness. It is what happens when keeping the peace feels safer than saying what is true.' Before L3 — brief counselor on any students who marked FAWN dominant across all contexts.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L1 Today students began Unit 3 — Conflict and Context. They examined what conflict is actually trying to tell us when we read it as data rather than threat, and identified their dominant conflict pattern — fight, flight, freeze, or fawn. Conversation-starter: 'When conflict comes up in our family, what do you tend to do — and do you think it works?'

1 CONFLICT AS DATA — THE REFRAME

8 MIN

'Most of us treat conflict as a threat — something to win, flee, or survive. But conflict is almost always carrying information: something matters here that is not being met.' Write: CONFLICT = signal that something matters AND something is misaligned. 'When Nia and her mom fight about the same thing for the fifth time, the fight is not the problem. The fight is the signal.' Ask: 'What is the conflict in your life right now — read as data rather than threat — trying to tell you?' 2 minutes journal. Private.

2 THE FOUR DOMINANT PATTERNS

10 MIN

Post the four patterns. 'Everyone has a dominant pattern — the default response when conflict arises. It developed for a reason.' Distribute WS B4-U3-WS1 (Conflict Pattern). Walk through all four patterns with specific behavioral descriptions. 4 minutes private — mark dominant pattern across four contexts.

3 THE COST OF EACH PATTERN

7 MIN

'Every pattern has a cost. FIGHT: win the argument, lose the relationship. FLIGHT: conflict ends, issue remains, goes in the backpack. FREEZE: present but absent. FAWN: keep the peace, lose your position.' Pairs: 'Name one relationship where your dominant pattern is costing you something specific. What would it cost you to respond differently — just once?'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-15A

THE 24-HOUR RULE

THE SITUATION

After a group project meeting dissolved into conflict — disagreements about workload, accusations about effort, raised voices — Marcus sent three texts in rapid succession that he immediately regretted. By the next morning, the messages had been screenshot and shared. What started as a conflict between four people was now a social situation involving fifteen. Marcus's first three sentences destroyed what three months of relationship had built. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What happened in the gap between Marcus's emotional flooding and his first text — and what was missing there? Marcus's texts may have been accurate — he may have had genuine grievances. Does accuracy make the timing right? The 24-hour rule does not say 'never say the hard thing.' What does it say — and why does the distinction matter? Redesign Marcus's approach: what does a response (not a reaction) look like for this situation? **RESPONSE VS. REACTION** A reaction is immediate, emotion-driven, and often accurate in content and wrong in timing. A response is deliberate — it contains the same honest content delivered after the emotional flooding has subsided. The 24-hour rule is not about suppressing what needs to be said. It is about choosing when to say it in a way that the other person can actually hear.

B4-15B

THE 24-HOUR RULE

THE SITUATION

Nia received feedback from a teacher on an essay she had worked hard on. The feedback was detailed and included several significant criticisms. Nia's first impulse was to go to the teacher that period and explain why every criticism was wrong. She stopped herself. She waited until the next day. When she returned, she had three genuine questions and one point of respectful disagreement. The conversation was productive. Her teacher raised her grade. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What changed between Nia's first impulse and the next-day conversation? Nia still had a point of disagreement on day two — the 24-hour rule didn't make her opinion change. What did it change? What would have happened if Nia had followed her first impulse — and what would she not have been able to hear? Identify a recent situation where you reacted instead of responding. What would a 24-hour pause have changed? **THE WINDOW OF DELIBERATION** Emotional flooding impairs the prefrontal cortex — the part of the brain responsible for deliberate reasoning and long-term consequence evaluation. The 24-hour rule creates a window in which that capacity returns. During that window, honest disagreement becomes possible without the content being filtered through someone else's defensiveness. The goal is not to manufacture agreement — it is to create conditions where honest exchange can actually happen.

FORGIVENESS vs. RECONCILIATION

50–55 min · January Week 2

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate the precise distinction between forgiveness and reconciliation and identify one situation where they have confused the two.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Self-Management (supporting) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	50–55 min · January Week 2
KEY VOCABULARY	forgiveness · reconciliation · resentment · release · conditions · internal act · relational act · accountability
MATERIALS	Journals · TWO separate anchor charts · Scenario Cards B4-16A, B4-16B, B4-16C · WS B4-U3-WS2 (Forgiveness/Reconciliation Distinction)
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: conflict as information. Quick — what is your dominant conflict pattern?' [Answer.] 'Today: the most important distinction in this unit.'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Students examine experiences of being harmed and their responses. Advance notification required. Standard opt-out protocols. Brief counselor before delivery. **CRITICAL:** Do not pressure any student toward forgiveness. The curriculum teaches forgiveness as available — never as required. Students in situations of ongoing harm must not be invited to forgive a still-present source of harm.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

ANCHOR CHART

FORGIVENESS
(INTERNAL ACT)
AVAILABLE
WITHOUT THE
OTHER PERSON
DOES NOT
REQUIRE THEIR
APOLOGY DOES
NOT RESTORE
TRUST DOES NOT
RESUME THE
RELATIONSHIP
RELEASES
RESENTMENT —
FROM YOU

**WHAT FORGIVENESS IS NOT SAYING IT WAS ACCEPTABLE RECONCILING THE
RELATIONSHIP RESUMING TRUST FORGETTING WEAKNESS**

ANCHOR CHART

RECONCILIATION
(RELATIONAL ACT)
REQUIRES THE
OTHER PERSON
REQUIRES
CHANGED
BEHAVIOR
REQUIRES REBUILT
SAFETY MAY OR
MAY NOT FOLLOW
FORGIVENESS AN
OFFER — NEVER
AN OBLIGATION

**THE KEY DISTINCTION YOU CAN FORGIVE WITHOUT RECONCILING YOU CAN
RECONCILE WITHOUT FULL FORGIVENESS THEY ARE SEPARATE DECISIONS
BOTH ARE AVAILABLE INDEPENDENTLY**

OPENING RITUAL

90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Today we make a distinction that may change how you think about forgiveness for the rest of your life. Most people confuse forgiveness and reconciliation — and the confusion causes significant damage. Today we separate them.' [Post: 'Is forgiveness something you do for yourself — or for the person who hurt you?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who writes with unusual speed and length — clearly accessing a well-defined, long-carried grievance. **MAY SIGNAL** This student is ready to name something significant. The distinction is giving them vocabulary for something processed alone for a long time. **ACTION** Note privately. After class: 'I noticed today felt meaningful for you. If you ever want to talk about anything this unit brings up, I'm available.'

UNIT 3 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 4, a student who visibly reacts to the 'ongoing harm' language — looks up, changes posture, appears to connect the word to their present reality. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be in a situation of ongoing harm and processing whether the forgiveness they've been asked to extend applies to something still happening. **ACTION** Follow disclosure protocol if the student approaches you. After class if appropriate: 'Today we talked about situations where harm is ongoing. If that connects to something real in your life, the school counselor is the right first stop.'

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-16A, B4-16B, B4-16C B4-16A (AMARA'S FRIENDSHIP RUPTURE): Whole-class. Key: 'Can Amara forgive her friend completely and still choose a different friendship going forward?' B4-16B (THE APOLOGY THAT DIDN'T CHANGE ANYTHING): Pairs. Key: 'The apology affects reconciliation conditions — not the availability of forgiveness.' B4-16C (PRIYA'S FAMILY): Small groups — use only if room has capacity after B4-16A and B4-16B.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"Forgiveness is ___ and reconciliation is ___. The key difference is ___. One situation where I have confused the two is ___. What the distinction changes for me is ___." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Examination of harm experiences and forgiveness patterns. Standard opt-out protocols. CRITICAL: Do not pressure any student toward forgiveness. Students in ongoing harm situations are explicitly protected. Safe messaging guidelines apply throughout Unit 3.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most important lesson in Book 4. Most common delivery error: conflating forgiveness with reconciliation in your language. Watch for it: 'If you forgive them, you can move forward in the relationship' — this conflation must be avoided. The 'ongoing harm' note in Step 4 is non-negotiable — do not skip or soften it. After this lesson: note any students who appeared significantly activated. Brief counselor before L3.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L2: **FORGIVENESS** vs. **RECONCILIATION** · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students learned what may be the **most** important distinction in Unit 3: the difference between forgiveness and reconciliation. Forgiveness is an internal act — releasing resentment for one's own sake, available without the other person's participation, apology, or changed behavior. Reconciliation is a relational act — restoring a relationship, requiring both people and changed behavior. The two are separate. You can extend forgiveness fully and still choose not to restore a relationship. The curriculum teaches forgiveness as available — not required. All personal reflection was private. Conversation-starter: 'Is there someone in your life you've tried to forgive — but the relationship is still complicated? Do you think forgiveness and reconciliation are the same thing there?' If your student seems distressed, please contact the school counselor: _____

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

THE DISTINCTION — THE MOST IMPORTANT CONCEPT IN UNIT 3

10 MIN

Post both charts simultaneously. 'These are two different things.' Write: **FORGIVENESS** = internal, available unilaterally. **RECONCILIATION** = relational, requires conditions. 'Forgiveness does not require the other person to do anything. Reconciliation does. You can extend forgiveness to someone who has never apologized, who has never acknowledged the harm, who has died. You cannot reconcile with someone who has not changed.'

2

WHAT FORGIVENESS IS NOT

8 MIN

Write each on the board as you say it: 'Forgiveness is not saying what happened was acceptable. Is not pretending the harm didn't matter. Is not resuming a relationship. Is not trusting the person again. Is not excusing, minimizing, or explaining away the harm. Is not forgetting.' [Pause.] 'Amara has been told she needs to forgive her friend. What she has been told is that forgiving means everything goes back to normal. What she doesn't know yet is that those are two different things.'

3

FORGIVENESS AS A STONE YOU PUT DOWN

7 MIN

'It is not a gift you give to the person who hurt you. It is a stone you put down. Resentment is weight. Carrying it costs you — your attention, energy, capacity for presence in other relationships.' [Pause.] 'Your forgiveness does not affect their accountability. Your resentment does not increase it.' Distribute WS B4-U3-WS2 (Forgiveness/Reconciliation Distinction). Students work through Parts 1 and 2 privately. 8 minutes.

4

THE PRESSURE TO FORGIVE — NON-NEGOTIABLE NOTE

5 MIN

Write on board: **FORGIVENESS IS AVAILABLE — NOT REQUIRED**. 'Forgiveness is never required. It is available. For students in situations of ongoing harm — who are still experiencing the thing they might be asked to forgive — the curriculum does not invite forgiveness of a still-present harm. Safety comes first. Always.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-16A

CALLING IN VS. CALLING OUT

THE SITUATION

When Jonah's teammate made a comment during practice that was racially insensitive — said without apparent awareness of its weight — Jonah had a choice. He could say something publicly, in front of the whole team. He could say nothing. Or he could find his teammate after and say: 'Hey — can I talk to you about something you said earlier?' He chose the third option. His teammate listened. He didn't know. He apologized. Nothing was destroyed. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did Jonah preserve by choosing to call in rather than call out — and what might he have sacrificed? Is 'calling in' always available — or are there situations where 'calling out' is the only appropriate response? Jonah's teammate didn't know. Does the absence of intent change what Jonah was right to do? When is the goal of accountability better served by a private conversation — and when does it require a public one? **CALLING IN** Calling in is a private, relational approach to accountability — one that treats the person who caused harm as capable of growth and invites them to understand the impact without the social cost of public exposure. It is not always available or appropriate. It is not appropriate when the harm is ongoing, systemic, or involves a power imbalance that makes private conversation unsafe. When it is available, it often produces more genuine change.

B4-16B

CALLING IN VS. CALLING OUT

THE SITUATION

A student at Amara's school has been making sexist comments in class for the entire semester. The teacher has not addressed it. Amara has spoken to him privately. Nothing has changed. She now posts about the specific comments — without using his name — on a student blog. The post goes viral within the school. The student is publicly shamed. The comments stop. Amara wonders if she did the right thing. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Amara tried calling in first — it didn't work. Does the sequence matter for evaluating the public post? Something stopped because of the public post. Does the outcome justify the method — always, sometimes, never? The student's behavior stopped. Has accountability happened — or something else? What criteria would you use to decide when calling out is the right tool? **WHEN CALLING OUT IS NECESSARY** Calling out — public accountability — is sometimes the only mechanism available, particularly when private accountability has been attempted and failed, when the harm is ongoing, or when the harm is systemic and individual conversations are inadequate. The question is not whether calling out is ever justified. It is what it produces, what it costs, and whether a less destructive pathway was genuinely not available.

The Boundary of Peace

50–55 min · January Week 3

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish boundaries from walls, identify one relationship needing a boundary, and practice the Calling-In Language structure.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	50–55 min · January Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	boundary · wall · open door · self-respect · calling-in language · consequence · fawn pattern
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-17A, B4-17B · Boundary Language Cards B4-U3-BLC
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: forgiveness vs. reconciliation. Can you forgive someone fully and still choose not to restore the relationship?' [Answer.] 'Today: what do healthy limits actually look like?'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Students examine relationships where limits are needed — may include family relationships. Counselor on standby same day. Standard opt-out protocols. **CRITICAL:** Boundary-setting language must never be offered as a substitute for safety planning when a student is describing a situation involving genuine danger. Follow disclosure protocol immediately for any safety situation.

NOTE

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND: CALLING-IN LANGUAGE — REPAIR-FOCUSED CONFRONTATION · Touchpoint 3 of 5 **PLACEMENT:** Embed immediately after DI Step 2 (Boundary vs. Wall vs. Open Door) — before pair practice. **TIME:** 6–8 minutes. **Protected.** Distribute Boundary Language Cards B4-U3-BLC during Step C. **STEP A — NAME THE SKILL (1 min):** 'This is called Calling-In Language. Direct, private, repair-focused. Four-part structure. We learn it right now.' **STEP B — TEACH THE STRUCTURE (2 min).** Write on board: (1) When you ___ [specific behavior — not character] (2) The impact on me was ___ [first-person, specific] (3) What I need going forward is ___ [specific, behavioral — the boundary] (4) I am telling you this because ___ [name your investment in the relationship] Step 4 separates calling-in from confrontation — it names why the person is worth the conversation. **STEP C — DISTRIBUTE BOUNDARY LANGUAGE CARDS (30 sec):** Cards B4-U3-BLC — six sentence-starter cards for each part of the structure. 'These are frames — the exact words must be genuinely yours.' **STEP D — TEACHER MODELS (1 min):** Use a generic appropriate example. Narrate each step aloud. **STEP E — STUDENTS PRACTICE (90 sec):** Apply to scenario card B4-17A or own situation — privately in journals. **STEP F — ANCHOR AND POST (30 sec):** Post the four-part structure on the anchor chart. **TEACHING TIP:** Frame as a relationship skill. 'Calling in is an act of respect — for yourself and for them.' Common error: students treating the structure as a script to recite verbatim. It is a framework.

ANCHOR CHART**OPENING RITUAL**

90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: forgiveness does not require reconciliation. Today: what does reconciliation actually require — and what do you do when you're not ready to reconcile but still have to be in a relationship with someone? Today: the boundary of peace.' [Post: 'What is the difference between protecting yourself with a boundary and protecting yourself with a wall?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who describes a family relationship — parent, sibling, or caregiver — with specific, detailed, present-tense description of what is happening. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be navigating a genuinely unsafe or harmful relational dynamic at home. Calling-in language is not the appropriate tool for unsafe family situations. **ACTION** Do not offer boundary-setting language as the primary tool during the lesson. After class: 'I want to make sure I understand what you're describing. Can you tell me more?' If the situation involves ongoing harm or safety risk — follow disclosure protocol immediately.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-17A and B4-17B B4-17A (YUSUF AND HIS FRIEND): Whole-class. Key: 'Is Yusuf's response a boundary or a wall? Write Yusuf's boundary statement using the Calling-In Language structure.' B4-17B (PRIYA AND HER STUDY GROUP): Pairs. Key: 'Priya has been the open door for three months. What does a boundary look like in that group context? Apply Calling-In Language.'

EXIT TICKET

"The difference between a boundary and a wall is _____. One relationship where I need a boundary is _____. The specific limit is _____. I am setting it from _____ [self-respect / retaliation]." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Disclosure of relationships where limits are needed — may include family. Counselor on standby same day. CRITICAL: Boundary-setting language must never substitute for safety planning. Follow disclosure protocol for any safety situation.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most clinically sensitive standard lesson in Book 4. The scan protocol here is the most important scan of Unit 3 — a student describing an unsafe family dynamic needs immediate counselor involvement, not boundary-setting coaching. After this lesson: brief counselor on any students who appeared to be describing situations beyond peer conflict scope.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L3: THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students learned about boundaries — a specific limit set from self-respect, with a specific consequence for the person setting it. A boundary controls only yourself — it describes what you will do if a limit is crossed, not what the other person is allowed to do. Students also learned the Calling-In Language structure: a four-part framework for naming harm in a direct, private, relationship-preserving way. Conversation-starter: 'Is there a relationship in your life where you give more than you receive — and does that feel sustainable to you?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

I

BOUNDARY VS. WALL VS. OPEN DOOR

8 MIN

Post the three-column chart. 'An open door gives unlimited access. A wall closes all access. A boundary: a specific limit, clearly communicated, with a specific consequence.' Write: BOUNDARY = specific limit + clear communication + specific consequence. 'A boundary controls only you. A boundary says: if this continues, here is what I will do. It makes no claim on what they are allowed to do.' Ask: 'Why is that distinction important?'

2

FROM RETALIATION TO SELF-RESPECT

8 MIN

Write: FROM RETALIATION: You can't do that. FROM SELF-RESPECT: If that continues, here is what I will do. 'Yusuf's boundary is from self-respect — not trying to punish his friend, describing what he will do with his own time and energy going forward. His friend can cancel as many times as they choose. Yusuf's boundary describes his response, not their permitted behavior.' [DELIVER R&R STRAND TOUCHPOINT 3 HERE — see Calling-In Language strand block above]

3

WHAT THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE ACTUALLY COSTS

6 MIN

'Setting a boundary will feel wrong at first — especially if your dominant pattern is fawn. Because you have been rewarded for keeping the peace. The Boundary of Peace is not the absence of discomfort. It is the maintenance of your integrity under pressure.' Students write privately: 'One relationship where I need a boundary rather than an open door or a wall is _____. The specific limit is _____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-17A

THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE ★★ HIGH DISCLOSURE

THE SITUATION

After two years of working to forgive her former best friend — who had shared a private confidence that damaged Ryn's reputation — Ryn has reached a genuine place of internal release. She doesn't carry the resentment anymore. She does not trust her former friend. She does not want the friendship back. When people ask if they are 'okay now,' Ryn says: 'I'm at peace with it.' They assume that means reconciliation. It doesn't. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What has Ryn done internally — and what has she chosen not to do externally? Why can both be true at once? People assume 'at peace with it' means the relationship is restored. What does their assumption reveal about how most people understand forgiveness? Ryn doesn't trust her former friend. Does the absence of reconciliation mean the forgiveness isn't real? Write the boundary Ryn has set — in her own words — as a statement of self-protection, not punishment.

FORGIVENESS WITHOUT RECONCILIATION Forgiveness is an internal act — releasing resentment for your own peace. Reconciliation is relational — restoring a damaged connection. These are two separate things. You can fully forgive someone without ever resuming the relationship. The boundary Ryn has set is not a punishment. It is a self-protective limit set from clarity, not bitterness.

B4-17B

THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE ★★ HIGH DISCLOSURE

THE SITUATION

Yusuf's uncle has apologized sincerely for missing key events in Yusuf's childhood — he had a substance use disorder that has since been addressed. He is genuinely different now. The extended family expects Yusuf to 'let it go' and resume the close relationship that never quite existed. Yusuf is choosing to release the resentment — and he is not ready to be close. His aunt tells him he is 'being unforgiving.' He is actually forgiving. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Yusuf's aunt misunderstanding — and what would you say to her? Yusuf is doing the internal work of releasing resentment. What is he not doing — and why is that a separate choice? The uncle has genuinely changed. Does genuine change obligate Yusuf to trust? Why or why not? What is the difference between the boundary Yusuf is maintaining and withholding forgiveness?

TRUST IS REBUILT, NOT RESTORED Trust is a relational resource. It requires demonstrated change over time, genuine safety, and the willingness of both parties to invest in rebuilding. It is never obligatory — not even after genuine growth. Yusuf's uncle's recovery is real. His right to Yusuf's trust must be rebuilt — it cannot be resumed simply because the behavior that damaged it has changed. Forgiveness and trust are two different journeys, on two different timelines.

CALLING IN vs. CALLING OUT

45–50 min · February Week 1 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish calling in from calling out and select the appropriate tool for three distinct scenarios.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills (primary) · Responsible Decision-Making (primary)
DURATION	45–50 min · February Week 1 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	calling in · calling out · accountability · public vs. private · cancel culture · repair-focused · punitive
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the boundary of peace. Quick — what makes a boundary different from a wall?' [Answer.] 'Today: when someone causes harm — what is the right tool?'

ANCHOR CHART

CALLING IN
PRIVATE · DIRECT
ASSUMES GOOD
FAITH PRESERVES
THE RELATIONSHIP
FOR INCIDENTS
GOAL: RESTORE
INTEGRITY

CALLING OUT PUBLIC · NAMED PATTERN ESTABLISHED RELATIONSHIP
SECONDARY FOR PATTERNS GOAL: PROTECT COMMUNITY

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: boundaries from self-respect. Today: when someone causes harm — what is the right response? Private accountability or public? And how do you tell the difference?' [Post: 'Is calling someone out the same as holding them accountable — and is calling them in the same as letting them off the hook?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the cancel culture discussion, a student who becomes visibly activated — defensive, angry, or dismissive. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may have been personally affected by disproportionate calling out — or harmed in a situation where private repair repeatedly failed. Both are valid and different. **ACTION** Do not challenge during the lesson. After class: 'Today's topic felt personal. I'd like to understand your perspective — not to argue, because you are clearly thinking about something real.'

UNIT 3 · LESSON 4 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-18A and B4-18B B4-18A (DIEGO'S EXCLUSION): Whole-class. Key: 'Diego tried calling in. It didn't work. At what point does this become calling-out territory — and what does proportionate calling out look like here?' B4-18B (THE ONLINE CALLOUT): Pairs. Key: 'Was this calling out appropriate — or calling out where calling in was available and sufficient?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"Calling in is ___ and calling out is ___. The question I ask to know which tool fits is ___. A situation where calling in is right: ___. A situation where calling out is right: ___." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Cancel culture discussion is the most politically sensitive moment in Book 4 — hold it carefully and evenhandedly. Do not express personal opinion about specific public cases. Frame as a genuine judgment question requiring genuine criteria. The Tool Selection Framework is the anchor — keep returning to it.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L4 Today students examined the difference between calling in (private, direct, repair-focused) and calling out (public accountability for ongoing, systemic, or community-level harm). They learned a framework for deciding which tool fits which situation. Conversation-starter: 'When someone in your friend group does something harmful — what do you think is the right response?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

THE TWO TOOLS

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Calling in is private, direct, repair-focused. Calling out is public.' Ask: 'When does private repair become inadequate — when does calling out become necessary?' Take 3–4 student responses.

2

THE TOOL SELECTION FRAMEWORK

10 MIN

Write: CALL IN WHEN — relationship still matters · person reachable · private repair available and safe · harm not systemic. CALL OUT WHEN — private repair failed or unavailable · harm ongoing or systemic · others need protection. Apply to Diego scenario: 'He has tried one private conversation — it changed nothing. Is this still calling-in territory?'

3

THE CANCEL CULTURE QUESTION — HELD HONESTLY

7 MIN

'The public discourse conflates proportionate public accountability — often legitimate — with punitive social exclusion beyond what the harm warranted. The question: is the response proportionate, available to the person to address, and aimed at repair or protection rather than punishment?' Pairs: apply the framework to two scenarios — one where calling in is right, one where calling out is right.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-18A**CONTEXTUAL EMPATHY****THE SITUATION**

When Layla discovered that the friend who had betrayed her trust had been under significant pressure at home — a sick parent, financial stress, and a falling grade in a class that threatened her scholarship — she felt something shift. She still felt hurt. She also understood, in a way she hadn't before, how someone she genuinely believed to be a good person had made a decision that hurt her. 'I get it now,' she said. 'I still didn't deserve it.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did understanding the context change for Layla — and what didn't it change? 'I get it now' and 'I still didn't deserve it' are both true. How do you hold both at once? Contextual empathy is not the same as excusing. What is the difference? Does understanding someone's context change what accountability they owe you — or just how you think about them? **CONTEXTUAL EMPATHY** Contextual empathy is the capacity to understand the forces, pressures, and circumstances that shaped someone's behavior — without concluding that those circumstances justify the harm. It is not excuse-making. It is a cognitive act that allows you to see the full person rather than only the harmful act. It is possible to fully understand why someone did something, hold them accountable for the impact, and still be hurt.

B4-18B**CONTEXTUAL EMPATHY**

THE SITUATION

After his friend Darius made a series of decisions that damaged their friendship, Marcus discovered that Darius had been dealing with a family crisis for months without telling anyone. Marcus had no idea. He had interpreted Darius's withdrawal and unreliability as indifference. Learning the context changed how Marcus understood Darius — but he also noticed that he was being asked, implicitly, to excuse behavior that had genuinely affected him. 'I understand it now,' Marcus said. 'I'm not sure that means everything is fine.'

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is Marcus right about — and what is he navigating carefully? Marcos is being asked to let context function as an excuse. What is the difference between understanding context and accepting it as justification? Darius didn't tell Marcus what was happening. Does the lack of disclosure change what contextual empathy requires? Marcus says 'I'm not sure everything is fine.' What does accountability still owe him — and how does contextual empathy fit into that? **UNDERSTANDING WITHOUT EXCUSING** The phrase 'I understand why you did it' is not the same as 'what you did is okay.' Context explains behavior. It does not eliminate accountability. Holding both simultaneously — deep contextual understanding and clear-eyed accountability for impact — is one of the most sophisticated relational skills there is. Marcus is right: understanding does not make everything fine. It makes it possible to engage with honesty and care at the same time.

Contextual Empathy

45–50 min · February Week 2

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students apply contextual empathy without excusing harm and distinguish empathy from agreement and sympathy.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · February Week 2
KEY VOCABULARY	contextual empathy · empathy · sympathy · agreement · context · narrative · humanizing · excusing · systemic factors
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: calling in vs. calling out. Quick — what is the test for knowing which tool fits?' [Answer.] 'Today: can you understand someone who has hurt you without excusing them?'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Students examine the context of people who have caused them harm — may include family members. Standard opt-out protocols. Brief counselor. CRITICAL: Do not press students to apply contextual empathy to anyone currently causing them ongoing harm.

ANCHOR CHART

WHAT
CONTEXTUAL
EMPATHY IS
UNDERSTANDING
WHY WITHOUT
EXCUSING THE
FULL PICTURE OF
WHO THEY ARE
DOES NOT
REQUIRE
AGREEMENT DOES
NOT ELIMINATE
ACCOUNTABILITY
CHANGES THE
RESPONSE
AVAILABLE TO YOU

WHAT IT IS NOT EXCUSING THE HARM AGREEING WITH THEIR VIEW REMOVING
CONSEQUENCES REQUIRED FOR FORGIVENESS CONDITIONAL ON THEIR
REMORSE

UNIT 3 · LESSON 5 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Today: can you understand someone who has hurt you — their full context, history, pressures — without excusing what they did? That is one of the hardest cognitive and emotional tasks a person can do. It is also one of the most freeing. Today we try.' [Post: 'Can you understand someone who hurt you — without deciding that what they did was okay?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 2, a student who becomes very quiet and still — writing slowly with visible weight. **MAY SIGNAL** This student is doing the deep work — applying empathy to someone significant. Exactly what this lesson is for. **ACTION** Hold the room quietly. After class: 'Today seemed to land somewhere important for you. How are you doing?' Do not press for content.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who pushes back sharply — insisting systemic context is used to excuse perpetrators. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be speaking from direct experience. Their pushback is legitimate and important. **ACTION** Validate directly: 'You are naming something real — systemic context has been misused to deflect accountability. The curriculum is not doing that. Let me name it again clearly: understanding context does not mean the harm was acceptable. Both things are true.'

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-19A and B4-19B B4-19A (MARCUS AND HIS FATHER): Whole-class. Key: 'Does understanding his father's context change what Marcus experienced — or only how he understands who caused it?' B4-19B (FATIMA'S TEACHER): Pairs. Key: 'Is Fatima being asked to excuse her teacher — or to understand her?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The difference between empathy and excusing is _____. One person who hurt me — their fuller context includes _____. What that fuller context gives me is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Students examine context of people who have caused harm. CRITICAL: Do not press students to apply contextual empathy to anyone currently causing them ongoing harm. Follow disclosure protocol if a student appears to be applying empathy toward an abusive situation.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 5 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most conceptually challenging lesson of Unit 3. The empathy-without-excusing distinction must be held precisely throughout. The systemic context step will generate the most variation in student response — hold both responses simultaneously as valid. The equity layer is not optional.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L5: CONTEXTUAL EMPATHY · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students studied contextual empathy — understanding another person's behavior in light of their full context, history, and pressures, without excusing the harm they caused. The key: understanding someone's context does not mean their harmful behavior was acceptable. It makes them more three-dimensional — and sometimes makes forgiving them more possible. Conversation-starter: 'Is there someone in your life who hurt you that you understand a little differently when you think about what they might have been going through?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

EMPATHY — THE ACTUAL DEFINITION

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Contextual empathy adds one layer: understanding a person's behavior not just in the moment, but in the full context of their history, pressures, and narrative. The person who cut you off in traffic may have just left a hospital. The friend who said something cutting may be carrying something enormous. This is not about excusing. It is about making the picture accurate.'

2

EMPATHY WITHOUT EXCUSING — THE CRITICAL DISTINCTION

10 MIN

'Understanding context does not make harm acceptable. It makes the person three-dimensional — and sometimes, paradoxically, makes forgiveness more accessible.' Write: THREE-DIMENSIONAL ≠ EXCUSED. 'Both things are true: the person who hurt you was also a person in pain — AND they caused real harm.' Students write privately: 'One person who has hurt me — what was happening in their life that I know or can imagine? What does that fuller picture give me — not in terms of excusing, but in terms of understanding?'

3

SYSTEMIC CONTEXT — THE EQUITY LAYER

7 MIN

'Contextual empathy is not only personal. It is also structural. Some harm is shaped by systems — poverty, racism, intergenerational trauma. This is not a blanket excuse. It is an accurate picture of where harm often comes from.' Students write: 'One person whose behavior I can understand better when I consider the systemic or historical context they are in is ____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-19A

FORGIVENESS AS POWER

THE SITUATION

For three years, Amara let what her former friend group did to her shape which activities she joined, which hallways she walked through, and which opportunities she avoided. She hadn't consciously decided to organize her life around them. She just had. One day she realized: they had moved on. They were not thinking about her. She was the only one still paying. 'They're living rent-free in my head,' she thought. 'And they're not even aware of it.'

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is the cost of Amara's sustained resentment — and who is paying it? Amara organized her life around people who have moved on. What does that tell you about how resentment works? Forgiveness is sometimes described as 'evicting the tenant who stopped paying.' What does this mean in Amara's situation? What specific things would Amara be able to do if she stopped letting the old friend group occupy her mental real estate?

FORGIVENESS AS SELF-DETERMINATION Forgiveness is not a gift to the person who harmed you. It is an act of self-determination — choosing not to let someone else's past behavior continue to define, limit, and organize your present life. The rent-free metaphor captures something real: the person you resent is often not thinking about you, while you are thinking about them constantly. Evicting that tenant is not for them. It is for you.

B4-19B**FORGIVENESS AS POWER****THE SITUATION**

Theo was told by a coach in freshman year that he 'didn't have the mental toughness to play at the varsity level.' Theo proved him wrong — he made varsity as a junior. But he still thinks about that coach. He still wants the coach to know he was wrong. He has structured part of his athletic identity around proving a point to someone who almost certainly doesn't remember the conversation.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is Theo's resentment costing him — and what is it giving him that he hasn't found another source for? Proving the coach wrong is a form of motivation. Is it a sustainable one — and what happens after he 'wins'? Forgiveness doesn't mean agreeing that the coach was right. What does it mean in Theo's situation? What would Theo's athletic identity look like if it were built on something other than disproving someone else's judgment?

SUSTAINABLE MOTIVATION Resentment can be a powerful short-term motivator. The problem is its long-term cost: it keeps the person you resent at the center of your story, even after their relevance has ended. Forgiveness is not letting the coach off the hook. It is choosing to build your athletic identity on a foundation that does not require his acknowledgment to stand. The goal becomes yours — not a response to his.

The Grace Challenge

45–50 min · February Week 3 · Standard — lightest lesson of Unit 3

OBJECTIVE	Students define grace as a chosen extension of goodwill, commit to one specific daily grace practice, and track it over one week using the Grace Challenge Tracker.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills (primary) · Responsible Decision-Making (primary)
DURATION	45–50 min · February Week 3 · Standard — lightest lesson of Unit 3
KEY VOCABULARY	grace · micro-moment · goodwill · charitable interpretation · earned vs. given · Grace Challenge
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-20A, B4-20B · WS B4-U3-WS3 (Grace Challenge Tracker)
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: contextual empathy. Once you understand someone's context — what do you do with it? Today: grace — the smallest unit of the Unit 3 curriculum.'

ANCHOR CHART

GRACE — THE
ACTIVE
EXTENSION
GOODWILL
EXTENDED
DELIBERATELY
BEYOND WHAT
WAS EARNED
AVAILABLE AT ANY
TIME DOES NOT
REQUIRE
RECIPROCITY
CHANGES THE
ROOM

GRACE IS NOT PASSIVITY OR WEAKNESS IGNORING HARM REQUIRED IN EVERY SITUATION IDENTICAL TO NICENESS UNCONDITIONAL APPROVAL

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Today is different from the last four lessons. Lighter — intentionally. Today we land all of Unit 3 in something small and specific. Something you can do tomorrow. Something you can do in the hallway between classes. Today: grace.' [Post: 'What is the smallest unit of grace you could extend to someone today — and what would it cost you?']

UNIT 3 · LESSON 6 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During practice design, a student who designs a practice targeting a specific named person described with significant hostility or contempt. **MAY SIGNAL** The Grace Challenge is designed for everyday friction — not for addressing significant harm or ongoing conflict. **ACTION** Approach quietly: 'The Grace Challenge works best for everyday friction — not for the hardest relationships. Is there another person or context where this practice would be a better fit right now?'

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-20A and B4-20B B4-20A (DEJA'S NAME): Whole-class. Key: 'Why does saying Yusuf's name cost Deja something — and why does she do it anyway? Design a Grace Challenge practice for Deja's context.'

B4-20B (THEO'S INTERPRETATION): Pairs. Key: 'Theo chooses the charitable interpretation when two readings are possible. What does that choice cost him — and what does it give him?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"Grace is _____. My specific Grace Challenge practice for this week is _____. I will know I did it because _____. One grace I received today that I might have missed if I wasn't looking is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The Grace Challenge Tracker is the most important artifact between Units 3 and 4. Do not let students design vague practices — push for specificity at every step. The audit questions (extending and receiving) matter as much as the practice. Explicitly ask students to bring their Tracker back for L7.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L6 Today students took everything from Unit 3 and landed it in something specific: the Grace Challenge. Students designed a one-week daily grace practice — one small, specific, observable act of deliberate goodwill. Examples: saying someone's name when greeting them, assuming the charitable interpretation of an ambiguous message, responding to a difficult person with one degree more warmth than they have earned. Conversation-starter: 'What is one small grace you extended to someone today — and one you received?'

1

WHAT GRACE ACTUALLY IS

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Grace is an active extension of goodwill that exceeds what the other person has earned.' Walk through what grace is NOT: letting someone off the hook, pretending, naivety, resuming a damaged relationship. 'Deja chooses to say Yusuf's name when she greets him. One more degree of warmth than his behavior has earned. Small. Specific. Chosen.' Ask: 'What does that micro-moment cost Deja — and what might it give her?'

2

THE GRACE CHALLENGE — DESIGNING YOUR PRACTICE 'A

8 MIN

one-week commitment to one specific, observable, daily practice. Three requirements: specific · observable · daily.' Distribute WS B4-U3-WS3 (Grace Challenge Tracker). Students design their specific practice in journals first, then transfer. Pairs share for specificity feedback: 'Is this specific enough that you will know each evening whether you did it?'

3

THE GRACE AUDIT — GIVING AND RECEIVING

6 MIN

'The two-part daily audit: (1) Did I do my practice? (2) Did I receive grace today — goodwill extended to me that I might not have earned?' Students add the two audit questions to their Tracker.

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-20A

NAVIGATING CANCEL CULTURE

THE SITUATION

Three years ago, a student at Priya's school was publicly called out for comments she had made in middle school. The comments were genuinely harmful — racist and dismissive. The student apologized publicly and had, by all accounts, genuinely changed. She is now a junior who advocates for the students her comments once dismissed. She still gets brought up in arguments as 'the girl who said those things.' Some students have decided she cannot be trusted. Others see someone who grew. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What does the ongoing reference to her middle school comments do — and who does it serve? Is the question 'can she be trusted now' a reasonable one — or is it using accountability as a permanent verdict? Accountability and social punishment are different things. What would genuine accountability look like in this situation — and what does 'cancel' offer instead? At what point does continued public consequence become punishment rather than accountability? **ACCOUNTABILITY VS. SOCIAL PUNISHMENT** Accountability addresses harm, enables repair, and allows for growth. Social punishment — particularly the permanent kind — treats a person's worst moment as their permanent identity. The two are not the same. The question is not whether harmful behavior deserves consequence. The question is what the goal of the consequence is: repair and growth, or permanent damage. The answer shapes both what we do to others and what we allow others to do to us.

B4-20B

NAVIGATING CANCEL CULTURE

THE SITUATION

When a prominent student leader at Marcus's school was publicly exposed for private messages that were unkind and dismissive about specific classmates, the response split the school. Half felt the exposure was justified — people had been hurt and the pattern was real. Half felt the messages were private and the public exposure disproportionate. Marcus had been the recipient of one of the messages. He hadn't authorized the exposure. He wasn't sure he was glad it happened. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Both sides of the response have a legitimate concern. What is each side actually worried about? Marcus was the person harmed — and he isn't sure he's glad. What does that tell you about who 'cancel' is for? The messages were private but the pattern was real. Does the private context change the public accountability question? Design an alternative accountability pathway for this situation — one that addresses the harm without the irreversibility of public exposure. **THE COMPLEXITY OF PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY** Public accountability is sometimes the only available tool — particularly when private accountability has been attempted and failed. But it carries irreversible costs: reputations, relationships, and the capacity for growth in the person exposed. The question is never simply 'was the harm real?' The harm was real. The question is: what does accountability that allows for growth actually look like — and is that what we are building?

Unit Reflection — the Grace Audit

50–55 min · March Week 1 · Unit reflection and bridge

OBJECTIVE	Students synthesize Unit 3 learning, review their Grace Challenge Tracker, and articulate how the forgiveness/reconciliation distinction has changed one relationship they carry into Unit 4.
CASEL FOCUS	Synthesis across all Unit 3 CASEL domains
DURATION	50–55 min · March Week 1 · Unit reflection and bridge
MATERIALS	Grace Challenge Trackers (students bring) · All Unit 3 anchor charts displayed · Scenario Cards B4-21A, B4-21B
OPENING REVIEW	None — open with the full ritual and the wall of Unit 3 anchor charts.

ANCHOR CHART

S — DISPLAYED SIMULTANEOUSLY Post all Unit 3 anchor charts before class begins: · Conflict as Information — Four Patterns (L1) · Forgiveness — The Internal Act (L2) — PERMANENT · Reconciliation — The Relational Act (L2) — PERMANENT · Calling-In Language Structure (R&R Strand, L3) · Boundary · Wall · Open Door (L3) · Calling In vs. Calling Out (L4) · Contextual Empathy (L5) · Grace — The Active Extension (L6) The Forgiveness and Reconciliation charts are permanent — they do not come down.

OPENING RITUAL

3 minutes · Unit Reflection Version 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Look at the wall. Every chart up there is something you built this unit.' [Pause 15 seconds. Let them look.] 'Today we ask the honest question: did any of it actually produce something real in your relationships — or your internal life? Did the Grace Challenge work?' [Post: 'What did grace actually teach you this week — about the other person, or about yourself?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 1 tracker review, a student who appears distressed by their tracker — very few completions, visible shame about not completing the practice. **MAY SIGNAL** Incomplete practice adherence is the norm, not the exception. This student has confused the tracker with a moral assessment of their character. **ACTION** Approach quietly: 'The tracker is data — not a report card. What did you learn from the days you didn't do it? That is often more useful than the days you did.'

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-21A and B4-21B B4-21A (NIA'S GRACE CHALLENGE): Whole-class — primary L7 scenario. Key: 'The classmate didn't change. But Nia did. Is that a success or a failure of the Grace Challenge?' Grace changes the giver first. B4-21B (THE FORGIVENESS AUDIT): Pairs. Key: 'Marcus has been confusing the two for six months. What changes for him — and what doesn't?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The Unit 3 tool that gave me the most is _____. What the Grace Challenge taught me is _____. The relationship I am carrying into Unit 4 is _____. What has shifted is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Before L7: retrieve the Unit 1 index cards from storage — they are returned in Unit 4 L7. Brief counselor before Unit 4 L1 on any students carrying significant relational weight from Unit 3. The forgiveness/reconciliation charts are permanent — do not take them down.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L7 Today students completed Unit 3 of Architecture of Grace by reviewing their Grace Challenge results and synthesizing everything from the unit. Key learning: conflict carries information; forgiveness and reconciliation are different things; boundaries set from self-respect protect relationships rather than ending them; contextual empathy opens the path to forgiveness; and grace — the daily, specific, chosen extension of goodwill — changes the giver first. Unit 4 begins next week. Conversation-starter: 'Is there a relationship in your life that feels a little lighter than it did a few months ago — and do you know why?'

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE 'This maps your conflict pattern across four contexts. There is no correct answer — only honest ones. All four patterns are understandable. All have costs. The question is whether your pattern is still serving you.' CRITICAL: FAWN-dominant students across all contexts — note for counselor awareness before L3.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U3-WS1 · CONFLICT PATTERN · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 3, Lesson 1 Name (optional): _____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. Mark what is actually true. THE FOUR PATTERNS: FIGHT (confronts directly) · FLIGHT (avoids/exits) · FREEZE (immobile) · FAWN (appeases to stop discomfort) In most situations, my dominant pattern is (circle): FIGHT / FLIGHT / FREEZE / FAWN Does it shift by context? School / academics: FIGHT / FLIGHT / FREEZE / FAWN Close friendships: FIGHT / FLIGHT / FREEZE / FAWN Family: FIGHT / FLIGHT / FREEZE / FAWN Online / social media: FIGHT / FLIGHT / FREEZE / FAWN THE COST: The specific cost my dominant pattern produces in relationships: _____ A situation last month where my pattern did not serve me: _____ One relationship where I want to respond differently: _____ What responding differently would look like: _____ What it would cost me to respond that way: _____ CONFLICT AS DATA: The conflict in my life right now — read as data — is signaling: _____ Specifically: an unmet need for ___ / a values friction around ___ / an expectation gap about ___

NOTE

★ CLINICAL CARE NOTE — READ BEFORE PRINTING Most emotionally significant worksheet in Unit 3. Students apply the forgiveness/reconciliation distinction to situations of real harm. NEVER collected. If a student leaves it on their desk: place in an envelope. Offer it privately. CRITICAL: Do not pressure any student toward forgiveness responses. Worksheet is descriptive, not prescriptive. If responses suggest ongoing harm: follow disclosure protocol. Do not use as a therapeutic tool. CRISIS RESOURCES: Fill in counselor contact before printing. Post before distributing.

NOTE

TEACHER SCRIPT — VERBATIM BEFORE DISTRIBUTING 'The worksheet in front of you applies the distinction we just learned to something real in your life.' 'This is private. It will not be collected. No one will read it.' 'Work through it in order. Take your time. There are no correct answers — only honest ones.' 'If anything comes up that feels too heavy to carry alone — the counselor is available.' [Post counselor contact.]

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U3-WS2 · FORGIVENESS / RECONCILIATION · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 3, Lesson 2 Name (optional): _____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. Write what is actually true. PART 1 — THE DISTINCTION: Forgiveness is:

_____ Reconciliation is:

_____ The key difference:

_____ Forgiveness requires (circle all that apply):

acknowledgment / apology / changed behavior / contact / NONE OF THESE Reconciliation requires (circle all that apply): acknowledgment / apology / changed behavior / mutual willingness PART 2 — APPLY TO YOUR

SITUATION: A situation where I have been carrying resentment: _____

_____ Have I been confusing forgiveness and reconciliation? YES / NO / NOT SURE What I have been believing that may be a confusion:

_____ PART

3 — THE STONE: The resentment I have been carrying: _____ What it has been costing me to carry it: _____ If I applied the forgiveness frame — what might change for me? _____

_____ If forgiveness is not available to me right now — what would I need to feel ready? _____

_____ (Forgiveness is available when YOU are ready. There is no timeline.) PART 4 — RECONCILIATION (separate from forgiveness): Is reconciliation something I want? YES / NO / NOT SURE If yes — conditions that would need to be true:

_____ Is the other person demonstrating those conditions? YES / NO / NOT

YET / UNKNOWN CLOSING: The sentence I am carrying from this worksheet into Unit 3: _____

_____ — — — CRISIS RESOURCES — — —

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: call or text 988 · Crisis Text Line: text HOME to 741741 School Counselor:

_____ [Fill in before printing] If something came up today that feels too heavy to carry alone — you do not have to.

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE 'These cards give you the sentence-starters for the Calling-In Language structure. They are not scripts — they are frames. The exact words must be genuinely yours.' CRITICAL: These cards are NOT appropriate tools for addressing abusive or unsafe relationships.

NOTE

B4-U3-BLC · BOUNDARY LANGUAGE CARDS · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 3, Lesson 3 · Cut along dotted lines CALLING-IN STRUCTURE: (1) When you ____ [specific behavior] (2) The impact on me was ____ [first-person] (3) What I need going forward is ____ [specific, behavioral] (4) I am telling you this because ____ [investment in relationship] - - - - - CARD 2 — NAMING THE SPECIFIC BEHAVIOR: 'When you cancel plans the day of...' · 'When you share what I told you in private...' 'When you interrupt me before I've finished...' · 'When you speak about me in front of others...' - - - - - CARD 3 — NAMING THE IMPACT: '...I feel like I can't rely on our plans.' · '...I feel like what I share isn't safe.' '...I feel dismissed before I've had a chance to contribute.' · '...I pull back from the group.' - - - - - CARD 4 — NAMING WHAT YOU NEED: '...I need a heads-up at least the morning of.' · '...I need to know what I share stays with you.' '...I need space to finish my thought.' · '...I need you to address concerns to me directly.' - - - - - CARD 5 — NAMING YOUR INVESTMENT: '...because this friendship matters to me.' · '...because I want us to actually work.' '...because I'd rather have a hard conversation than lose this.' · '...because I think you'd want to know.' - - - - - CARD 6 — THE BOUNDARY CONSEQUENCE (what YOU will do — not what they must do): 'If this continues, I will stop making plans I can't count on.' · 'If this happens again, I'll need to be more careful about what I share.' FROM SELF-RESPECT — not from retaliation. Controls only YOU, not them.

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE 'The Tracker holds you to the specificity standard. If you can't fill in the daily column because you're not sure whether you did the practice — the practice isn't specific enough.' QUALITY CHECK: 'I will be kinder' → not specific. 'I will say one person's name when I greet them in the hallway' → specific.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

NOTE

B4-U3-WS3 · GRACE CHALLENGE TRACKER · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 3, Lesson 6 Name (optional): _____ Start Date: _____ MY GRACE CHALLENGE PRACTICE (specific enough that I know each evening whether I did it):

_____ I will know I did it because:

_____ Context:

_____ THE TWO-PART DAILY GRACE AUDIT: Part 1

— EXTENDING: Did I do my Grace Challenge practice today? YES / NO Part 2 — RECEIVING: Did I receive grace today — goodwill extended to me I might not have earned? DAY 1 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received:

_____ DAY 2 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received: _____ DAY

3 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received:

_____ DAY 4 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received: _____ DAY

5 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received:

_____ DAY 6 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received: _____ DAY

7 · Date: _____ Practice done? YES / NO What got in the way: _____ Grace I received:

_____ WEEK-END REFLECTION (complete before L7):

Days completed: ___ out of 7 · What made it hardest: _____ What happened as a result:

_____ What the receiving audit taught me:

_____ The most surprising thing about the Grace Challenge:

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

NOTE

Block all dates below BEFORE Unit 3 Lesson 1. The forgiveness/reconciliation lesson (L2) is the highest-disclosure-risk standard lesson in Book 4 — counsel must be briefed before it.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

LESSON RISK COUNSELOR REQUIREMENT SCHEDULING CONSTRAINTS L1: Conflict as Information Standard No requirement. Note FAWN-dominant students for awareness before L3. Review Conflict Pattern Worksheets informally to identify FAWN-dominant students. L2: Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation ★ Brief counselor 2 days before. Review ongoing-harm language together. On standby same day. Monday–Wednesday preferred. Not before holiday/weekend. Highest-disclosure-risk standard lesson in Book 4. L3: Boundary of Peace ★ + R&R Brief counselor before — specifically on FAWN-dominant students from L1 and any students activated in L2. On standby same day. Monday–Wednesday preferred. Brief counselor: boundary language is NOT for unsafe family situations. L4: Calling In vs. Calling Out Standard No requirement. No constraint. Hold cancel culture discussion evenly. L5: Contextual Empathy ★ Brief counselor. Awareness only. On standby same day. Not before holiday. Systemic context may activate students with family/community harm history. L6: Grace Challenge Standard No requirement. Lighter lesson. No constraint. Ensure students leave with the Tracker. L7: Grace Audit Standard Counselor briefed on unit arc. On standby same day. Monday–Wednesday preferred. Not before holiday.

NOTE

STANDING — BEFORE UNIT 3 LESSON 1 Counselor and teacher review Unit 3 overview. Both aware of L2 disclosure risk. Unit 2 debrief observations shared — students with significant relational weight identified. Communication channel confirmed for in-lesson counselor signals. Crisis resources remain posted from Unit 2. Do not take down.

NOTE

AFTER UNIT 3 LESSON 7 — COUNSELOR DEBRIEF (within 3 school days) Review: Students activated in L2 (forgiveness/ongoing harm) or L3 (boundary-setting family context). Identify: Students carrying most relational weight into Unit 4 — need counselor contact before Unit 4 begins. Note: Unit 4 is community-facing and future-focused — risk profile drops significantly. Students still processing L2/L3 need counselor support before it begins.

NOTE

Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Unit 3: Conflict & Context · COMPLETE MERGED DOCUMENT Tier 1 (Lesson Interiors) + Tier 2 (Operational Layer) · Merge verified — no conflicts School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden, Founder · Pilot Version CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only NEXT: Book 4 Unit 4 — Community & Legacy: From Grace to Grace Culture

NOTE

Unit Duration March–May · 7 Lessons · 45–55 minutes each Essential Question What kind of room — what kind of culture — does the person you are becoming build around them? Risk Profile Standard across all 7 lessons · Highest legacy weight of any Book 4 unit Version Pilot · CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

Letters: L6, L7 (Tier 2) Counselor Coordination Calendar: Unit 4 + Year-End entries (Tier 2) MERGE STATUS: Clean — no conflicts. All elements verified.

NOTE

UNIT 4 STANDING NOTE Unit 4 does not introduce new concepts. It takes everything from Units 1–3 and scales it. The essential move in every lesson: from individual to collective. From personal to social. Unit 4 closes Book 4 and opens the door to Book 5: The Capstone. The Year-End Celebration (L7) includes the return of the Unit 1 index cards — retrieve from storage before L7.

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

GRACE CHALLENGE TRACKER REVIEW

12 MIN

'Take out your Grace Challenge Tracker. I am not collecting it — but look at it honestly.' Students review privately. Four journal questions: (1) Did you do the practice? How many days out of seven? (2) What made it hard? (3) What happened as a result? (4) Did the receiving audit teach you something you would have missed? 8 minutes private. Students may share tracker patterns with a partner if both choose.

2

SCENARIO CARD DEBRIEF — WHAT GRACE LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE

10 MIN

Run B4-21A as whole-class. Key: 'Nia completed the Grace Challenge with her most difficult classmate. The classmate didn't change. But Nia did. What does that tell us about what grace is actually for?'

3

THE FORGIVENESS ARC — WHERE DID UNIT 3 LEAVE YOU?

13 MIN

'Where did this unit leave you in terms of one specific relationship you are carrying? You do not have to have forgiven anyone. You do not have to have resolved anything. But something has shifted — even if only in how you understand the situation.' Students write privately: 'The relationship from Unit 3 I am carrying into Unit 4 is _____. What has shifted is _____. The Unit 3 tool that gave me the most is _____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-21A

UNIT REFLECTION — CHOOSING PEACE

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

THE SITUATION

After the full arc of Unit 3, Layla writes in her journal: 'I used to think that choosing peace meant I was letting people off the hook. Now I think it means I am choosing not to let what they did write the rest of my story. The peace is mine. The choices they made are theirs. Those are different things.' She is not sure she is all the way there yet. But she can see the difference. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What has shifted in Layla's understanding of what 'choosing peace' means? Layla says 'I'm not all the way there yet.' Is partial progress toward peace valuable — or does it only count when complete? Layla distinguishes between her peace and other people's choices. What does that distinction protect? Write your own current understanding of what choosing peace means — where you are in the journey, not where you think you should be. **THE PEACE CHOICE** Choosing peace is not a single moment — it is a direction. It is not letting people off the hook. It is deciding that what they did will not be the organizing principle of your life going forward. The peace is yours to give to yourself. The choices that caused the harm belong to someone else. These are two different things, and holding that distinction is the heart of what this unit has been teaching.

B4-21B

UNIT REFLECTION — CHOOSING PEACE

THE SITUATION

At the end of Unit 3, Marcus has one stone he is not ready to put down. He knows it. His teacher has not pressured him. The curriculum has given him language for it: he is not at the release point yet — he is at the 'naming the weight' point. Knowing the difference is new. He writes: 'I know what I'm carrying. I know what it costs. I'm not ready yet. That's different from not knowing.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why is 'knowing what I'm carrying but not ready yet' different from simply not having done the work? Marcus is being honest about where he is rather than performing readiness he doesn't have. Why does that honesty matter? The curriculum has not pressured him toward a particular timeline. What does that communicate about how forgiveness works? What would the next step look like for Marcus — not the full release, but one small movement in the right direction? **THE HONEST TIMELINE** Forgiveness is not linear, and there is no correct timeline. What matters is that the process is genuine — not performed for the room, not rushed by pressure, not abandoned because it is hard. Naming the weight clearly, knowing what it costs, and being honest about where you are is not failure. It is the beginning of the journey, not evidence that the journey cannot happen.

BOOK 4

UNIT 4

COMMUNITY & LEGACY

FROM GRACE TO GRACE CULTURE

WHAT IS GRACE CULTURE?	THE GRACE AUDIT — COMMUNITY SCALE
L2 Charitable Interpretation	L6 The Grace Legacy
L3 Bearing Witness	L7 Year-end Celebration — the Class Legacy
L4 Grace Under Pressure	

What Is Grace Culture?

45–50 min · March Week 2 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate the difference between grace culture and performance culture and identify which currently dominates their immediate community.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · March Week 2 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	grace culture · performance culture · default assumption · goodwill · repair · psychological safety · contagion
OPENING REVIEW	'Unit 3 ended with the Grace Challenge. Today Unit 4 begins. The question shifts: from what do I practice individually to what do I build collectively. What does a community look like when grace is the default?'

ANCHOR CHART

GRACE CULTURE
DEFAULT
ASSUMPTION:
GOOD FAITH
REPAIR IS
EXPECTED, NOT
EXCEPTIONAL
ACCOUNTABILITY
IS RESTORATIVE
MISTAKES
GENERATE
LEARNING WHOLE
PEOPLE — NOT
JUST
PERFORMANCES

**PERFORMANCE CULTURE DEFAULT ASSUMPTION: EVALUATION MISTAKES
GENERATE PUNISHMENT ACCOUNTABILITY IS PUNITIVE IMAGE OVER
SUBSTANCE PARTS OF PEOPLE — THE USEFUL PARTS ONLY**

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Unit 4 is the final unit of Book 4. It asks one question: what kind of room does the person you are becoming create? Today: the difference between a culture of grace and a culture of performance.' [Post: 'What kind of room does the person you are becoming create around them?']

UNIT 4 · LESSON 1 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who names a home or family environment as the room they want to build differently — with visible weight and present-tense specificity. **MAY SIGNAL** This student is carrying significant family context into Unit 4. Building grace culture in a genuinely unsafe family environment is not a Tier 1 classroom activity. **ACTION** After class: 'The room you named — I want to make sure you have support in thinking about what grace culture looks like in that particular context. Can we talk about it?' Involve counselor if safety concerns are present.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-22A and B4-22B B4-22A (NIKA'S CLASSROOM): Whole-class. Key: 'What performance culture norm is Nika disrupting — and what does she replace it with? Design five specific norms for a grace culture version of her classroom.' B4-22B (THE TEAM): Pairs. Key: 'The team's performance culture produces results at the cost of belonging. What would a grace culture version look like without sacrificing the standards?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The difference between grace culture and performance culture is _____. The room I most want to build differently is _____. The one grace practice I could sustain in that room is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Make the research on psychological safety concrete and credible — this is not feel-good curriculum. Grace culture is associated with measurably better outcomes. Students skeptical of grace as a serious alternative need the research. Amy Edmondson's work is your anchor — know it with specificity.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L1 Today students began Unit 4 — Community and Legacy. They examined the difference between performance culture (image management is primary, mistakes are terminal) and grace culture (goodwill is the default, repair is expected, mistakes are recoverable). Conversation-starter: 'What is one norm in our family — or a community you're part of — that you wish were different? What would the grace culture version look like?'

1 PERFORMANCE CULTURE — WHAT IT COSTS

8 MIN

Post the anchor chart. 'Most of you have spent three years in a high school performance culture — the curated identity (Unit 1), the perfectionist freeze (Unit 2), the conflict patterns that prioritize image over relationship (Unit 3). All of that is performance culture at the interpersonal level.' Ask: 'Describe the performance culture of one community you belong to right now — one specific norm that tells you image matters more than reality.' Name student responses on the board.

2 GRACE CULTURE — WHAT IT REQUIRES

10 MIN

Write: GRACE CULTURE = goodwill as default + repair as expected + mistakes as recoverable. 'Amy Edmondson's research on psychological safety at Harvard shows that teams with high psychological safety are more creative, more productive, and more willing to take the risks that produce genuine innovation. Grace culture is not soft. It is what high-performance communities actually run on.' Pairs: 'Describe one grace culture you have been part of — at any scale. What made it feel different?'

3 GRACE IS CONTAGIOUS — THE ONE-PERSON SHIFT

7 MIN

'The research on social contagion shows that one person who consistently operates from a different set of norms can shift a community's culture over time.' [Pause.] 'The Grace Challenge you did in Unit 3 was personal. What happens if you don't stop?' Students write: 'One specific room I want to build differently is _____. The one grace practice I could sustain in that room is _____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-22A

THE ANONYMOUS ACT

THE SITUATION

Every year before graduation, one senior anonymously pays the unpaid lunch balance for the entire elementary school across the street. Nobody knows who it is. The tradition has continued for seven years. The person doing it gets nothing — no recognition, no thanks, no social credit. 'The whole point,' a former student said, 'is that it's not about you. It's about them. When you are the only one who knows, you find out who you actually are.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What makes this act different from public generosity — and why does the anonymity matter? 'When you are the only one who knows, you find out who you actually are.' What does this mean? Acts of grace that cost the giver something are sometimes described as more genuine than those that don't. Do you agree — and why or why not? Design an anonymous act you could execute this week. What is its Grace Gap — the space in your environment where grace is absent?

ANONYMOUS GRACE An act of grace becomes most revealing when it is anonymous — when no social credit is available. What you choose to do when no one is watching tells you more about your actual values than any stated commitment. Anonymous generosity is not superior to named generosity. But it is a particular test of character: it requires that the motivation be genuinely other-focused, not image-focused.

B4-22B

THE ANONYMOUS ACT

THE SITUATION

Nia noticed that one student in her class always had to borrow supplies and always seemed slightly embarrassed by it. She started keeping an extra set of pens and pencils in her bag that she left on the corner of her desk without comment. The student took them, always, without making eye contact. Nia never mentioned it to anyone. She didn't think of it as an act of grace. She thought of it as just noticing.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS Nia didn't think of what she was doing as grace — she thought of it as 'just noticing.' What is the relationship between noticing and grace? Nia preserved the other student's dignity by not drawing attention. What does that cost — and why does it matter? Small, consistent acts of grace are described in research as more impactful than occasional large ones. What does Nia's practice suggest about this? What is a Grace Gap in your immediate environment that you could step into the way Nia stepped into hers? **NOTICING AS GRACE** Grace often begins with attention — the willingness to see what others overlook. Nia's act required no grand gesture, no public announcement, and no acknowledgment. It required only that she notice something real about another person's experience and respond to it with quiet consistency. This is what grace looks like in practice, most of the time: small, unannounced, and directed toward dignity.

Charitable Interpretation

45–50 min · March Week 3 · Standard — light consolidation

OBJECTIVE	Students apply the charitable interpretation as a default cognitive practice and distinguish it from naivety, willful blindness, and excuse-making.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · March Week 3 · Standard — light consolidation
KEY VOCABULARY	charitable interpretation · uncharitable interpretation · ambiguity · default assumption · naivety · one data point vs. pattern
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: grace culture — goodwill as the default. Today: what does that look like in the micro-moment?'

ANCHOR CHART

**GENEROUS
READING (APPLY
WHEN...) THE
EVIDENCE IS
GENUINELY
AMBIGUOUS ONE
DATA POINT ONLY
THE PERSON HAS
NOT ESTABLISHED
A PATTERN YOU
CHOOSE THE
MORE GENEROUS
EXPLANATION**

**RECALIBRATE (APPLY WHEN...) PATTERN ESTABLISHED EVIDENCE IS CLEAR
GENEROUS READING REQUIRES IGNORING FACTS WILLFUL BLINDNESS IS NOT
CHARITY**

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: grace culture as the room you build. Today: the smallest unit of grace culture — the charitable interpretation. The choice you make in the moment when the evidence is ambiguous.' [Post: 'When the evidence is ambiguous — what is your default reading?']

UNIT 4 · LESSON 2 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who applies the 'established pattern' frame to what appears to be a single recent incident — with significant emotional force. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be processing something significant from a specific relationship that exceeds the lesson's conceptual frame. **ACTION** Do not challenge during the lesson. After class: 'The situation you were thinking about seems significant. Do you want to talk about it?'

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-23A and B4-23B B4-23A (THEO'S TEAMMATE): Whole-class. Key: 'Walk through the evidence for the uncharitable and charitable reading. Design a rule: when do you apply charitable interpretation, when has the pattern accumulated enough for recalibration?' B4-23B (THE PARTY INVITATION): Pairs. Key: 'What would change for Nia if she held the generous reading for 24 hours before deciding?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"My default reading when a situation is ambiguous is _____. The Generous Reading Question produces _____. One relationship where I can apply it this week is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Lightest lesson of Unit 4 — use as consolidation. The one-data-point vs. established-pattern distinction is the most important nuance. Without it students will either apply charitable interpretation naively to clear patterns of harm, or reject it as impractical. With it, they have a calibration tool.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L2 Today students practiced charitable interpretation — choosing the most generous available reading of an ambiguous situation before the threatening one. Key distinction: one ambiguous moment is not a pattern. You can reinforce this at home by modeling it aloud: 'I wonder what was going on for them — that message felt sharp, but maybe they were having a rough day.' Conversation-starter: 'Is there a situation lately where you assumed the worst about what someone meant — and it turned out you were wrong?'

1 THE DEFAULT READING — HONEST SELF-ASSESSMENT

7 MIN

'When a close friend sends a one-word reply to a long message — what do you think?' Take 3–4 responses. 'Notice that the most common default is the self-referential threat reading. This is not a character flaw — it is the brain's default under ambiguity.' [Pause.] 'The charitable interpretation is not the naive reading. It is the deliberate choice to apply the most generous interpretation consistent with the evidence before applying the threatening one.'

2 THE PRACTICE — HOW TO DO IT

8 MIN

Write: **GENEROUS READING QUESTION:** 'What is the most generous interpretation consistent with the evidence?' 'The generous reading for the one-word reply: they are tired, they are in a rush, something happened before they saw my message. None of these are naive — all are plausible.' Walk through Theo scenario. Ask: 'What does choosing the charitable reading cost Theo — and what does it give him?'

3 WHEN THE CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION STOPS WORKING

7 MIN

Write: **ONE DATA POINT** = ambiguous → charitable reading. **ESTABLISHED PATTERN** = evidence → recalibrated reading. 'The charitable interpretation does not require you to pretend patterns don't exist. It requires that you not construct a pattern from a single ambiguous moment.' Students write: 'One relationship where I apply an uncharitable default to ambiguous moments is _____. The charitable reading I could apply is _____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-23A

CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION 2.0

THE SITUATION

Zach sent a detailed text to his project partner about a plan they had discussed. His partner read it and responded with a single 'k.' Zach spent forty minutes interpreting the 'k': passive aggression, dismissal, frustration, maybe even a signal that the partnership was over. He composed three different follow-up texts. He sent none of them. The next day his partner arrived at school having done the full plan. The 'k' meant 'okay.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did Zach's brain offer as the first interpretation — and how did it treat that interpretation? Zach composed three follow-up texts and sent none of them. What stopped him — and was that the right call? The Pause Practice suggests: notice your first interpretation, pause, and ask what the most reasonable charitable explanation is. What was the charitable explanation for 'k'? Design a personal Pause Practice rule for yourself: what will you do in the gap between receiving ambiguous communication and responding? **THE PAUSE PRACTICE IN DIGITAL COMMUNICATION** Digital communication removes the tonal and contextual cues that help us interpret ambiguous messages. As a result, the negative attribution default — the brain's tendency to assume threat in ambiguity — has enormous power in text-based exchanges. The Pause Practice is not about being naive. It is about choosing deliberately: what is the most reasonable, generous explanation for what I just received? Act on that unless you have clear evidence otherwise.

B4-23B

CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION 2.0

THE SITUATION

Marcus's close friend consistently forgets to ask how Marcus's events went — the games, the competitions, the things Marcus works hard at. Marcus has interpreted this as indifference. It has been building for months. One afternoon he finally says something. His friend looks genuinely confused: 'I didn't know I wasn't asking. I thought you'd tell me if something big happened.' Both of them were right. Neither knew the other's expectation. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What charitable interpretation was available to Marcus that he didn't use — and why didn't he use it? Marcus and his friend both had reasonable assumptions. How can two people both be right and still be in conflict? Charitable interpretation doesn't require you to suppress real needs. What would it have looked like to apply CI AND raise the real concern? Identify someone in your life where your CI runs out — where you consistently attribute negative intent. What would a pause reveal? **IN-GROUP VS. OUT-GROUP CI** We apply charitable interpretation automatically to people we feel close to — and apply negative attribution almost as automatically to people we feel more distant from. Marcus has been applying out-group CI to his closest friend. The irony is real: our most important relationships are sometimes the ones we are least generous with, because they matter most and therefore hurt most when we feel unseen.

Bearing Witness

45–50 min · April Week 1 · Standard — elevated empathic weight

OBJECTIVE	Students identify the distinction between bearing witness and performing empathy, and practice the four skills of witnessed presence.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills (primary) · Social Awareness (primary)
DURATION	45–50 min · April Week 1 · Standard — elevated empathic weight
KEY VOCABULARY	bearing witness · performing empathy · presence · fixing · attunement · silence as skill · witness sentence
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: charitable interpretation. Today: what do you do when someone you care about is in genuine pain — when there is nothing to fix?'

ANCHOR CHART

BEING WITH FULL
PRESENCE NO
AGENDA TO FIX 'I
AM HERE'
TOLERATES
DISCOMFORT THE
THING ITSELF

DOING FOR SOLVING · ADVISING CHANGING THE SUBJECT FILLING THE SILENCE
AVOIDING DISCOMFORT OFTEN FOR OUR SAKE

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Think of a time you were in genuine pain — not a problem to solve, just something heavy. Did the person next to you try to fix it? Or did they just stay? Today: the difference between those two things.' [Post: 'Can you be with someone in pain without needing to fix the pain?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the pair practice in Step 2, a student who shares something genuinely heavy — far beyond what the low-stakes framing suggested — and their partner appears uncertain. **MAY SIGNAL** The pair practice occasionally surfaces real material. The structure of the exercise created permission the student needed. **ACTION** Do not intervene during the pair unless content suggests a disclosure-level event. After class: check in with both students. Follow disclosure protocol if needed. The partner may need support too.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 3 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-24A and B4-24B B4-24A (NIA AND HER MOM): Whole-class. Key: 'Rewrite the conversation — what would bearing witness have looked like instead?' B4-24B (MARCUS AND HIS FRIEND): Pairs. Key: 'Marcus stays. He says almost nothing. What specific skill of witnessed presence is he using — and how does the silence function?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"Bearing witness is ___ and performing empathy is ___. The four skills of witnessed presence are ___. The sentence that communicates bearing witness most directly is ___." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Students reference this lesson years later as something that changed how they are present with people they love. The pair practice is the pedagogical heart — protect it unconditionally. Most common delivery error: the teacher intervenes in the pair practice to offer advice. Do not. The Witness Sentence should be said aloud and written on the board — some students need to hear it in their body before they can offer it to someone else.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L3 Today students studied bearing witness — the skill of being genuinely present with someone in difficulty without needing to fix the problem or offer silver linings. At home, the most powerful thing you can sometimes offer is exactly this: 'I am here. You don't have to be okay right now.' Conversation-starter: 'Is there something you're carrying right now that you haven't found the right words for? You don't have to have the words. I can just be here with you.'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

I

PERFORMING

8 MIN

vs. BEARING — THE HONEST DISTINCTION 'When someone we care about is in pain, most of us feel an immediate pull to fix it. We call this empathy — but it is often performance. Not because we don't care — because we do — but because their pain activates our discomfort, and fixing is how we relieve our discomfort while appearing to help.' Write: PERFORMING = motivated by own discomfort. BEARING = motivated by care for them. 'Nia's mom gives advice, offers silver linings, redirects. None of it helps — because Nia doesn't need solutions. She needs to not be alone.'

2

THE FOUR SKILLS OF WITNESSED PRESENCE

10 MIN

Write as you teach: (1) PRESENCE WITHOUT AGENDA — no plan to fix, redirect, or resolve. (2) OPEN QUESTIONS over advice — 'What is this like for you?' not 'What you should do is.' (3) SILENCE AS SKILL — the pause between their words is held, not filled. (4) THE WITNESS SENTENCE: 'I am here. You don't have to be okay right now.' Pairs: one person shares something low-stakes but real. The other practices all four skills for 3 minutes. No advice. No silver linings. Then switch.

3

BUILDING A WITNESSED-PRESENCE ROOM 'A'

7 MIN

grace culture is, in part, a room where people experience being witnessed — where showing up as you actually are is safe.' Write: WITNESSED-PRESENCE ROOM = it is safe to not be okay here. 'Your bearing-witness practice is one of those interactions — built one conversation at a time.' Students write: 'One person in my life who bears witness for me. One person I want to practice bearing witness for — and what it would cost me to stay, just stay, without fixing.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-24A**THE GRACE GAP IN FRIENDSHIPS****THE SITUATION**

Priya's closest friend has been in a difficult stretch — distracted, inconsistent, occasionally unreliable. She has missed two events Priya cared about and been slow to reply for weeks. Priya's first instinct is to pull back — to protect herself before she gets hurt further. Her second thought is: 'Is this who she is, or is this who she is right now? And what would I want her to do if this were me?' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the Grace Gap Priya is being asked to step into? Priya distinguishes between 'who she is' and 'who she is right now.' Why does that distinction matter for how you respond? Priya asks what she would want if the situation were reversed. Is reciprocal grace the same as unconditional grace? How do you decide when giving a friend room to be imperfect is grace — and when it is absorbing mistreatment? **THE GRACE GAP IN RELATIONSHIPS** Friendships contain Grace Gaps — the spaces where one person needs more than they can reciprocate right now. Stepping into that gap is not unconditional tolerance. It is choosing, with full awareness, to give someone room to be imperfect, inconsistent, and in process. The limit is genuine: grace with a difficult person is not the same as accepting mistreatment. The question is whether this is difficulty or pattern.

B4-24B**THE GRACE GAP IN FRIENDSHIPS**

THE SITUATION

After his friend group got into colleges, the social dynamics shifted. Some pulled away. Some became competitive. Marcus noticed that the easiest version of him — the most guarded, most performative, least vulnerable version — was starting to take over. 'I'm watching myself become the version of myself I like least,' he wrote in his journal, 'because I'm too afraid to be the version I like most with people who might not stay.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the Grace Gap Marcus is not stepping into — and what is he protecting himself from? Marcus is describing a kind of preemptive self-protection. When does self-protection stop protecting and start isolating? Grace in friendships sometimes means being willing to be seen even when staying hidden would be safer. What would it cost Marcus to stay open? Design a Grace Gap practice for Marcus — one small, concrete choice he could make this week that would be genuine.

GRACE AND VULNERABILITY Stepping into the Grace Gap in a friendship sometimes means offering the real version of yourself when the guarded version feels safer. It is a form of relational courage. Marcus has identified the gap accurately: he is protecting himself from potential loss by becoming someone who is less worth staying for. The irony is real, and he knows it. Grace — including grace toward the people around you — sometimes begins with being willing to be seen.

Grace Under Pressure

45–50 min · April Week 2 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students identify their grace-collapse conditions and design a contingency plan using the Grace Recovery Protocol.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · April Week 2 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	grace collapse · trigger · Grace Recovery Protocol · notice · pause · choose · repair sentence
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: bearing witness. Today: the hardest version of grace — when everything inside you wants to respond with something other than grace.'

ANCHOR CHART

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Think about the last time you tried to extend grace and failed. Today: that moment is not a failure. It is the most important moment in a grace practice — where you learn your actual limits. Today we name those limits — and design what to do when you hit them.' [Post: 'Where does your grace practice collapse — and what do you do next?']

NOTE

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND: GRACE UNDER PRESSURE — GRACE RECOVERY PROTOCOL · Touchpoint 4 of 5 PLACEMENT: Embed immediately after Step 1 — at the moment students have named their collapse triggers. TIME: 6–8 minutes. Protected. STEP A — NAME THE SKILL (1 min): 'This is called the Grace Recovery Protocol. Not about preventing grace collapse — about recovering from it. Three steps. In order.' STEP B — EXPLAIN WHY HERE (1 min): 'You just named your collapse conditions. The Recovery Protocol is what you use in those conditions — not before, not after, IN them.' STEP C — TEACH THE THREE STEPS (2 min). Write on board: NOTICE — 'I am in a grace collapse right now.' Name it. This interrupts the automatic response. PAUSE — One breath. Both feet. Signal-vs-Noise check: 'Am I responding to this situation — or to my reaction to it?' CHOOSE — One small recovery action. The smallest available grace move. STEP D — TEACHER MODELS (1 min): Use a realistic, generic example. Narrate all three steps. STEP E — STUDENTS PRACTICE (90 sec): Apply to their own highest-risk collapse scenario. Private journal. STEP F — ANCHOR AND POST (30 sec): Post NOTICE / PAUSE / CHOOSE. Add THE REPAIR SENTENCE: 'I wasn't at my best there. I want to try that again.' TEACHING TIP: Frame as a regulation skill — 'Giving your prefrontal cortex a chance to get involved before the limbic system makes all the decisions.' Common error: framing grace collapse as a failure. 'Grace collapses are expected. The Recovery Protocol is what you do next.'

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 1, a student who describes collapse conditions suggesting they operate under chronic stress — where grace collapse is not occasional but constant. **MAY SIGNAL** This student may be in an environment where the conditions for grace are chronically absent. This is an environment problem, not a grace practice problem. **ACTION** After class: 'The conditions you named today sound exhausting to be in consistently. I want to make sure you have support. Can we talk about what is actually going on?' Involve counselor if appropriate.

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-25A and B4-25B B4-25A (NIA'S COLLAPSE): Whole-class. Key: 'Apply the Grace Recovery Protocol to Nia's collapse. Write the repair sentence Nia could say.' B4-25B (DARIUS'S PUBLIC MOMENT): Pairs. Key: 'Darius collapses publicly. The repair happens privately. Why is the private repair still worth doing?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"My specific grace collapse conditions are _____. The Grace Recovery Protocol: Notice ____, Pause ____, Choose _____. The repair sentence is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The R&R Strand Touchpoint 4 is the most operationally sophisticated strand touchpoint in Book 4 — do not abbreviate it. The repair sentence is worth saying aloud multiple times until it sounds natural. Most important reframe: grace collapse is not a moral failure — it is human. The Recovery Protocol is what comes next. Students who have collapsed on people they care about and never repaired are carrying that weight. The repair sentence gives them a way in.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L4 Today students examined what happens when a grace practice collapses — and learned the Grace Recovery Protocol: Notice (name the collapse internally), Pause (create space), Choose (one small recovery action). They also practiced the repair sentence: 'I wasn't at my best there. I want to try that again.' Conversation-starter: 'Is there a moment recently where you wish you'd responded differently — and what would it look like to go back and try again?'

1 NAME THE COLLAPSE CONDITIONS 7 MIN

'Grace under pressure begins with honesty about the specific conditions under which your grace practice collapses.' Write: COLLAPSE CONDITIONS = exhaustion + humiliation + repeated harm + public exposure. Students write privately: 'The specific conditions under which my grace practice most reliably collapses are _____. The trigger that is most reliable — the button that makes grace feel impossible — is _____.'

2 THE RECOVERY PROTOCOL — EMBEDDED R&R STRAND [DELIVER THE R&R STRAND TOUCHPOINT 4 HERE — 8 MIN

see Regulation & Repair Strand block above. Walk through all six steps. Post NOTICE / PAUSE / CHOOSE and THE REPAIR SENTENCE on the board. This is the core DI of this lesson.]

3 REPAIR AFTER COLLAPSE 7 MIN

'Here is what most people skip after a grace collapse: repair. Sometimes just: I wasn't at my best there. I want to try that again.' Write: REPAIR SENTENCE: 'I wasn't at my best there. I want to try that again.' Pairs: 'Name one grace collapse from the past month. Walk your partner through the Recovery Protocol. Then: what would the repair sentence look like?'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-25A

SCHOOL CULTURE ADVOCACY

THE SITUATION

At Nia's school, the hallway outside the cafeteria is where the social sorting happens — who sits where, who gets acknowledged, who gets looked past. Nia has watched new students arrive and stand at the edge of that hallway for days before anyone speaks to them. She proposes one concrete change to her advisory: a 'first week welcome' where older students are assigned — voluntarily — to introduce themselves to new students on their first three days. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the Grace Gap Nia identified — and what makes it systemic rather than individual? Nia's proposal is small and voluntary. Why might that make it more sustainable than a mandatory program? School culture is built from hundreds of individual micro-decisions. Where does Nia's proposal sit in that larger picture? Identify one Grace Gap in your school's culture — not a person, but a pattern. Design one concrete, sustainable intervention. **CULTURE AS MICRO-DECISIONS** School culture is not a policy — it is the accumulated weight of how individuals treat each other across thousands of small moments. Grace Gaps in culture are the places where the accumulated weight goes in the wrong direction: where certain students are routinely overlooked, where certain spaces signal exclusion, where belonging is unevenly distributed. One student cannot change a culture. One student can begin to change a pattern.

B4-25B

SCHOOL CULTURE ADVOCACY

THE SITUATION

When Darius's school was dealing with a pattern of conflict between two student groups, a student-led 'listening circle' was proposed — a voluntary, structured conversation with trained student facilitators. It was small. Only twelve students attended the first one. But something shifted in how those twelve students moved through the school after — and it was noticed by others. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What made the listening circle's approach different from a school-wide policy intervention? Twelve people is a small number for a school of eight hundred. Why might it still matter? Darius was one of the twelve. What did he experience that a policy could not have produced? Design your own small-scale culture intervention — one that could be tried without institutional permission and might spread if it worked. **SMALL-SCALE CHANGE** The most durable culture changes often begin small — not because ambition is wrong, but because small interventions can be tried, refined, and proven before they scale. Twelve students in a listening circle can produce something that an all-school assembly cannot: genuine contact, genuine conversation, and the specific experience of being actually heard. That experience travels. Culture change begins with what individuals do in rooms.

The Grace Audit — Community Scale

45–50 min · April Week 3 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students apply the Grace Audit to a community they belong to and design one specific sustainable grace contribution.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Responsible Decision-Making (primary)
DURATION	45–50 min · April Week 3 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	Grace Audit · community · assets · deficits · sustainable contribution · leverage point
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-26A, B4-26B · WS B4-U4-WS1 (Community Grace Audit)
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: grace under pressure — collapse and recovery. Today: instead of where does MY grace practice collapse, we ask: where does THIS COMMUNITY's grace practice collapse?'

ANCHOR CHART · COMMUNITY GRACE AUDIT

WHAT WE ARE BUILDING Grace culture indicators Default assumption in this class · How repair happens · What mistakes produce · Who is included in decision-making Performance culture indicators Default assumption · How failure is received · Who speaks and who doesn't · What the rewards actually go to The honest audit Where are we actually operating? · What do we want to build? · What is one specific change we can make?

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: grace under pressure — what to do when your own practice collapses. Today: zoom out. What is the grace culture gap in a community you belong to — and what is your specific, sustainable contribution to closing it?' [Post: 'What is the grace culture gap in a community you belong to — and what can you actually contribute?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 1, a student who chooses their family as the community and describes significant grace deficits that suggest an unsafe or harmful home environment. **MAY SIGNAL** Building grace culture in a genuinely unsafe family environment is not appropriate as a Tier 1 classroom activity. **ACTION** After class: 'The community you chose — I want to make sure I understand what is actually going on there. Can we talk?' Involve counselor if safety concerns are present.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 5 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-26A and B4-26B B4-26A (NIA'S TEAM): Whole-class. Key: 'What is Nia's leverage point — and why is it specifically effective for her in this community?' B4-26B (DARIUS'S NEIGHBORHOOD): Pairs. Key: 'Name the deficit and the leverage point — and design the sustainable contribution that matches both.'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The community I chose is _____. Its grace assets are _____. Its grace deficits are _____. My leverage point is _____. My sustainable contribution is _____. I will know I did it each day because _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The Community Grace Audit is the Unit 4 answer to the Unit 2 Backpack Audit — same rigorous structure, applied outward. The leverage point concept moves students from 'I should be kinder in general' to 'here is the specific place where my specific practice produces the most impact.' After this lesson, begin preparing for L7's year-end synthesis — retrieve the Unit 1 index cards from storage before the final lesson.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L5 Today students applied a Grace Audit to a community they belong to — identifying grace assets, grace deficits, and the specific leverage point where one person's consistent practice would have the most impact. They designed a sustainable grace contribution: a specific, daily practice matched to their community's highest-impact grace gap. Conversation-starter: 'What is one thing you could do consistently — in a community you care about — that would gradually make it a different kind of place?'

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3

1

CHOOSE YOUR COMMUNITY AND ASSESS IT

8 MIN

'Choose one specific community you belong to and actually care about.' Distribute WS B4-U4-WS1 (Community Grace Audit). 'Part 1: name the community. Describe its current culture in one sentence. Name two grace assets. Name two grace deficits.' 5 minutes private.

2

IDENTIFY THE LEVERAGE POINT

10 MIN

Write: LEVERAGE POINT = where your practice intersects with the community's highest-impact grace gap. 'Nia's team has a charitable interpretation deficit. Nia's leverage point: she applies the charitable interpretation publicly — naming it aloud — every time she can. Over time, her public naming shifts the room's default.' Ask: 'What is the leverage point in your chosen community — where your consistent practice has the most traction?'

3

DESIGN THE SUSTAINABLE CONTRIBUTION

7 MIN

Write: SUSTAINABLE = specific + daily + realistic + yours. 'Not I will be kinder to everyone. I will apply the charitable interpretation aloud to one team member's behavior in every team meeting for the next month.' Students complete Part 3 of the worksheet. Pairs share for specificity feedback: 'Is this specific enough that you will know each day whether you did it?'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-26A

MENTORSHIP

THE SITUATION

When Priya was a freshman struggling in her AP Chemistry class, a senior she barely knew noticed and offered to meet with her twice a week. The senior didn't make it a big deal. She just showed up and explained the concepts that weren't landing. At the end of the year Priya passed the exam. She is now a junior who has been meeting with two freshmen for three months. She has not told either of them about her own freshman year struggles. She just shows up. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did the senior's mentorship give Priya that a tutor or a resource couldn't have? Priya hasn't told her mentees about her own struggles. Is that a choice worth examining — or is it appropriate? Mentorship often gives as much to the mentor as to the mentee. What might Priya be getting from this relationship? Design your Mentor Path: one younger student you could invest in this year, and what you would specifically offer them. **THE MENTOR PATH** Genuine mentorship is not expertise delivered downward. It is a relationship in which someone further along the path turns around and offers specific, honest, sustained investment to someone earlier. The investment is not advice alone — it is presence, attention, and the willingness to show up consistently. What you know is less important than whether you stay.

B4-26B

MENTORSHIP

THE SITUATION

Marcus, a junior, signs up to mentor a freshman — mostly because his advisor asked him to. By November he is thinking about his mentee more than he expected. The freshman is navigating a situation Marcus recognized from his own freshman year. Marcus finds himself saying things he wished someone had said to him. By December he has written more in his own journal than in any other month of high school. 'I thought I was helping him,' Marcus says. 'I think he's helping me.'

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What is Marcus getting from the mentorship relationship that he didn't anticipate? Marcus signs up mostly because he was asked. Does the origin of the motivation matter — or only what it becomes? 'I thought I was helping him. I think he's helping me.' What is happening in both directions? Design the 'mentee' side of your Mentor Path: who in your next environment might mentor you — and what would you ask them?

BIDIRECTIONAL MENTORSHIP Mentorship is often described as something given by someone older to someone younger. The reality is more mutual: the mentor is consistently invited, by the mentorship relationship, to articulate what they actually know, to reflect on their own journey, and to discover what they believe by being asked to share it. The investment runs in both directions. Marcus's surprise is not unusual — it is one of mentorship's most consistent features.

The Grace Legacy

50–55 min · May Week 1 · Standard — highest legacy weight of Book 4

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate their grace legacy and write a Grace Legacy Statement naming who they are becoming and what that becoming asks of them.
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making (primary) · Self-Awareness (supporting)
DURATION	50–55 min · May Week 1 · Standard — highest legacy weight of Book 4
KEY VOCABULARY	grace legacy · legacy statement · orchard · planting vs. harvesting · becoming · forward-facing identity
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-27A, B4-27B · WS B4-U4-WS2 (Grace Legacy Statement)
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the Community Grace Audit — leverage point, sustainable contribution. Today: zoom out further. Not just what you build this month — what you leave behind. Today: the Grace Legacy.'

ANCHOR CHART

THE GRACE LEGACY — THE ORCHARD FRAME THE ORCHARD FRAME: You are planting trees under whose shade you may never sit. Legacy is not about what you receive. It is about what you leave. GRACE LEGACY: The specific relational and communal impact that the person you are becoming leaves in every room you enter. Not a grand project — the accumulated effect of daily practice over time. THE LEGACY QUESTION: 'When you leave a room — what is different because you were there?' BECOMING vs. PERFORMING: A grace legacy is not a reputation you manage. It is the natural consequence of who you are becoming. POST: Before class. KEEP: Unit 4 — reference in L7.

OPENING RITUAL

90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'There is an old idea — from many traditions — that the best time to plant a tree is twenty years ago. The second best time is today. You are planting trees right now whose shade you may never sit under. The Grace Legacy is that tree. Today we name what you are planting.' [Post: 'When you leave a room — what is different because you were there?']

UNIT 4 · LESSON 6 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the Grace Legacy Statement writing, a student who writes for the full 15 minutes with visible intensity and focus. **MAY SIGNAL** This student is doing profound interior work. The Legacy Statement has connected with something real in their self-concept. **ACTION** Do not interrupt. Do not approach unless they initiate. After class: 'I noticed today was significant for you. I hope you keep what you wrote.' No further intervention needed — this is the curriculum working at its highest level.

NOTE

LEGACY CONNECTION The Grace Legacy Statement is the foundation document for Book 5: The Capstone. In B5-U4 (Orchard Legacy), students return to the legacy frame at the near-adult threshold. If students are moving into Book 5, remind them: 'Keep this statement. You will return to it.'

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-27A and B4-27B B4-27A (DEJA'S ORCHARD): Whole-class — before the Legacy Statement writing. Key: 'What is Deja planting — and why does the planting matter even if she never sees the harvest?' B4-27B (THE TEACHER'S LEGACY): Pairs — optional after writing if time allows. Key: 'What made the teacher's grace practice memorable enough to carry?'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The orchard frame means _____. The legacy question — my honest answer for one community is _____. My Grace Legacy Statement: I am becoming _____, it requires _____, and what will be different is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The Orchard Frame should be delivered with care — it carries genuine weight. The 15-minute protected writing time is non-negotiable. Do not collect these statements. Do not evaluate them. Simply hold the room. Optional voluntary sharing must be genuinely optional. Before L7: retrieve the Unit 1 index cards from storage.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L6: THE GRACE LEGACY Dear Families, Today students wrote their Grace Legacy Statement — a personal document naming who they are choosing to become, what daily practice that becoming requires, and what will be different in the rooms they enter because they are becoming this person. The framing: the best time to plant a tree is twenty years ago. The second best time is today. A grace legacy is built daily, in small practices, over time. Conversation-starter: 'What is something you do — or want to do — that you hope someone else will carry forward, even if they never know where they got it from?'

1

THE ORCHARD FRAME — PLANTING WHAT YOU WON'T HARVEST

10 MIN

'The grace legacy is not about what you receive. It is about what you leave.' [Pause.] 'Deja's quiet practice of bearing witness — staying with her friend through the hardest year of her life — planted something. Years later her friend will do the same for someone else, without thinking about where they learned it. That is the orchard. Deja may never see it.' Ask: 'What is one thing someone planted for you — that they may not even know produced something in you?' Take 3–4 responses. 'That is the orchard. Today we name what you are planting.'

2

THE LEGACY QUESTION — APPLIED HONESTLY

10 MIN

Write: LEGACY QUESTION: 'What is different in this room because you are in it?' 'This requires honesty. Some rooms are unchanged by our presence. Some are genuinely better — not because we tried to improve them, but because our consistent practice created something.' Distribute WS B4-U4-WS2 (Grace Legacy Statement). Students work through Section 1 privately: the legacy question applied honestly to three communities. 7 minutes.

3

WRITE THE GRACE LEGACY STATEMENT

10 MIN

'The Grace Legacy Statement answers three questions: (1) Who am I choosing to become? (2) What daily practice does that becoming require? (3) What will be different in the rooms I enter because I am becoming this person?' Students complete Section 2 — 15 minutes protected time. Teacher holds the room. No pairs. No sharing. After: 'If you are willing — and only if you are willing — share your legacy statement with one person in this room. Not for feedback. For witness.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-27A

THE CLASS LEGACY**THE SITUATION**

The senior class at one school decided their legacy project would be a collection of handwritten notes — one from each senior to one incoming ninth-grader they had never met. The notes contained one piece of honest advice: not inspiration, not platitude, but something the senior actually wished they had known. The freshmen received them on the first day of school. Several kept them for the rest of high school. None of the seniors knew whose note reached whom. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What made the note project meaningful — and why did the anonymity matter again? The seniors were asked to write something genuinely useful rather than inspirational. What is the difference? A legacy is something you plant for people who come after you. What makes this project a genuine legacy? Design your class legacy: one small, concrete, sustainable contribution your class could make to those who come after you. **THE LEGACY DESIGN** A class legacy is not a memorial — it is a gift. The test of a genuine legacy is whether it benefits those who receive it more than it glorifies those who gave it. The note project passes that test: anonymous, honest, and specifically designed for the person receiving it rather than the person writing it. That orientation — genuine other-focus — is what separates a legacy from a monument.

B4-27B

THE CLASS LEGACY

THE SITUATION

When Jonah's class decided to do a legacy project, the first five ideas were all about creating something visible — a mural, a garden, a trophy case display. One student finally said: 'What if the legacy isn't something you can see? What if it's something you can feel?' The class eventually decided to leave behind a culture: a set of norms for how people are treated in their advisory program, written by the students who had lived them. The norms stayed on the wall for three years after they graduated. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS**

What is the distinction between a visible legacy and a felt one — and why might a felt one last longer? The norms were written by students who had lived them. Why does that matter for whether they carry weight? Jonah's class shifted from 'what can we make' to 'what can we leave.' What does that shift reveal about what a real legacy is? What is one norm — one principle for how people treat each other — that your class has embodied this year that you want to name and leave behind? **CULTURE AS LEGACY** The most durable legacies are not physical — they are behavioral. A set of norms, a way of treating each other, a standard for what a community owes its members: these outlast murals and trophies. They outlast the people who wrote them. The students who wrote Jonah's class norms were putting language to something they had already built. The writing made the building visible — and made it possible to hand it forward.

Year-end Celebration — the Class Legacy

55–60 min · May Week 3 · Year-end culminating lesson

OBJECTIVE	Students synthesize the full year's arc, receive their Unit 1 index cards, and contribute to the Class Legacy Chart.
CASEL FOCUS	Synthesis across all Book 4 CASEL domains
DURATION	55–60 min · May Week 3 · Year-end culminating lesson
MATERIALS	All Book 4 permanent anchor charts displayed · Unit 1 index cards retrieved from storage · B4-28A scenario card · Class Legacy Chart (large blank paper — see Tier 2 instructions) · Grace Legacy Statements from L6
OPENING REVIEW	None — open with the full 3-minute ritual. The room holds everything from the year.

ANCHOR CHART

S — YEAR-END DISPLAY Post EVERY PERMANENT anchor chart from the full year before class begins:
 PERMANENT: The Performance Tax (U1-L1) · The Integrity Anchor (U1-L3) · Signal vs. Noise / Internal Coach (U1-L6)
 PERMANENT: Forgiveness — The Internal Act (U3-L2) · Reconciliation — The Relational Act (U3-L2)
 UNIT 2: The Perfectionism Spectrum · The Compassionate Witness · The Friend Test
 UNIT 3: Conflict Patterns · Boundary Wall Door · Calling In vs. Out · Contextual Empathy · Grace
 UNIT 4: Grace Culture · Charitable Interpretation · Bearing Witness · Grace Recovery Protocol Community Grace Audit · The Grace Legacy / Orchard Frame
 This is the full record of everything this class built together. Hang it before students arrive.

OPENING RITUAL

3 FULL MINUTES — YEAR-END VERSION 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 15 seconds.] 'Look at the walls.' [Pause 20 seconds. Let them look at the full year's anchor charts.] 'You built all of that. Not me. I gave you the vocabulary. You did the work of making it true in your actual lives.' [Pause 15 seconds.] 'Today is not a test. It is not a review. It is a witness — to what this particular group of people, in this particular room, in this particular year, built together. That is not nothing. That is actually something.' [Post: 'What has shifted in you since August — and what are you carrying forward?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During the index card return in Step 1, a student who reads their card and appears visibly moved — tears, long stillness, recognition of distance traveled from August to now. **MAY SIGNAL** This is the curriculum's deepest proof of concept — the distance from who a student was in August to who they are in May, made visible in a single handwritten sentence. **ACTION** Hold the room. Do not rush to Step 2. This moment is the lesson. 'Take your time.'

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 2, a student who writes that nothing has shifted — insisting they are the same person they were in August. **MAY SIGNAL** May be in developmental arrest — the year did not reach them. Or protecting themselves from the vulnerability of naming change. **ACTION** After class: 'I read what you wrote today. I want to ask you honestly: is that true? Because from where I sit, I have seen ____.' Name one specific thing you actually observed.

NOTE

SCENARIO CARD · B4-28A B4-28A (THE CLASS THAT BUILT SOMETHING): Whole-class — use only if the room has capacity after Steps 1–3. Key: 'What did this class build that none of them could have built alone?' Use the fictional class as a mirror for this room if direct naming feels too vulnerable.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

EXIT TICKET

"The most important shift in me since August is _____. The tool from this year I will still be using at 25 is _____. What this class built together is _____. The sentence I am carrying forward is _____." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

TEACHER REFLECTION

The final lesson of Book 4. Your regulated presence matters more here than in any other lesson — allow yourself to be moved. The closing script is the most important thing you will say all year — say it slowly, looking at the room, meaning it. After this lesson: the mandatory year-end counselor debrief. File the Class Legacy Chart photograph. This is curriculum evidence of what grace culture actually produces.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L7: YEAR-END CELEBRATION Dear Families, Today was the final lesson of Architecture of Grace, Book 4: The Façade. Students received the index cards they wrote in September — a single sentence about who they wanted to stop performing and start actually being. They read what they wrote eight months ago, reflected on what has shifted, and participated in building the Class Legacy Chart: a collective record of what this particular group of people built together over the year. The closing ritual: each student turned to the person next to them and said one true thing they had noticed about that person this year. Not a compliment — something actually observed, specific and real. What your student built this year does not stay in the classroom. It travels with them. Conversation-starter: 'What is one thing you know about yourself now that you didn't know in September?' Thank you for supporting this work. It is not small. It is the kind of thing that matters for the rest of a life.

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10

GRADES 11 · 12

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

SAFETY NOTE If a student chooses their family as the community and describes significant grace deficits suggesting an unsafe or harmful home environment — follow disclosure protocol. Building grace culture in an unsafe family environment is not a Tier 1 classroom activity.

NOTE

B4-U4-WS1 · COMMUNITY GRACE AUDIT · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 4, Lesson 5 Name (optional): _____

_____ Date: _____ This is yours. It will not be collected. PART 1 — THE

COMMUNITY: The community I am auditing: _____ Current culture

— one honest sentence: _____ GRACE ASSETS already present: Asset 1:

_____ Asset 2:

_____ GRACE DEFICITS limiting the culture: Deficit

1: _____ Deficit 2:

_____ PART 2 — THE LEVERAGE POINT: The place where my consistent grace practice would have the most impact: _____

_____ Why this leverage point fits my specific practice: _____

_____ PART 3 — THE SUSTAINABLE CONTRIBUTION (share with partner for specificity feedback): WHAT I will do (specific action): _____

_____ WHEN (daily trigger or time): _____

_____ HOW LONG I will sustain it: _____

_____ HOW I will know each day whether I did it: _____

_____ Partner specificity feedback: _____

_____ PART 4 — WHAT CHANGES IF I SUSTAIN IT: If I sustain this for one month, what might be different in this community? _____

NOTE

TEACHER NOTE — BEFORE DISTRIBUTING 'This is called the Grace Legacy Statement. Not a mission statement. A description of who you are becoming and what that becoming asks of you. Section 1 applies the Legacy Question honestly — not what sounds impressive, what is actually true. Section 2 is the statement itself. You have 15 minutes of protected writing time.' During the 15-minute writing period: do not circulate to read over shoulders. Simply be present. Your quiet, unhurried presence is the most important facilitation move. Optional sharing after writing — not for feedback, for witness. Genuinely optional — monitor for peer pressure toward sharing.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

B4-U4-WS2 · GRACE LEGACY STATEMENT · Architecture of Grace · Book 4, Unit 4, Lesson 6 Name _____ Date: _____ This is yours. Write what is actually true. You may return to this at 20, at 30, at 40. SECTION 1 — THE LEGACY QUESTION (7 minutes): 'When you leave this room — what is different because you were there?' Apply honestly to three communities. Community 1: _____ What is different because I am in it: _____ Honest assessment: _____ Community 2: _____ What is different because I am in it: _____ Honest assessment: _____ Community 3: _____ What is different because I am in it: _____ Honest assessment: _____ What surprised me about my honest answers: _____ SECTION 2 — THE GRACE LEGACY STATEMENT (15 minutes — protected writing time): QUESTION 1 — WHO AM I CHOOSING TO BECOME?

_____ QUESTION 2 — WHAT DAILY PRACTICE DOES THAT BECOMING REQUIRE?

_____ QUESTION 3 — WHAT WILL BE DIFFERENT IN THE ROOMS I ENTER BECAUSE I AM BECOMING THIS PERSON?

_____ MY GRACE LEGACY STATEMENT (in your own words, whatever form feels true):

_____ Grades 11–12 CAPSTONE CONNECTION: This statement is the foundation document for Book 5, Unit 4: Orchard Legacy. Keep it. The version of you that is 10 years from now — what would they add to this statement?

NOTE

MATERIALS AND PREPARATION One very large piece of blank chart paper (full butcher paper preferred). Multiple markers — one per table or group. Camera or phone for photographing the completed chart. Before class: title the chart — THE CLASS LEGACY · [Year] · [Class/Period]. Hang where all students can reach it and all can see it. Place markers nearby.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NOTE

FACILITATION QUESTIONS (choose 2–3 based on the room's readiness) · 'What changed in this room this year that couldn't have happened without everyone here?' · 'What can you say in May that you couldn't say in September — about yourself, about conflict, about grace?' · 'What is this room better at now than it was eight months ago?' · 'What did you learn from someone in this room — not from the curriculum, from a person?' · 'What will you remember about this particular group of people?' RECORDING: Teacher writes student responses verbatim — no editing, no curating. Attribute to 'this class,' not to individuals. No student names on the chart. After generation: read the chart aloud in full — slowly. Let students hear what they built collectively. PHOTOGRAPH: Multiple photographs before class ends. File with lesson records. DISPLAY: Post permanently if space allows. At minimum, post for the final week.

NOTE

LESSON RISK COUNSELOR REQUIREMENT NOTES L1–L4 Standard No requirement. Standard disclosure protocol. Lowest risk profile of any Book 4 lessons. L5: Community Grace Audit Standard No requirement. Safety note for family-as-community scenario. If a student describes unsafe family environment — disclosure protocol applies. L6: The Grace Legacy Standard No requirement. Counselor reachable. Students writing Legacy Statements may surface full-year material. L7: Year-End Celebration Standard Counselor briefed before L7. On standby same day. Index card return may be activating. Cumulative year-end weight.

NOTE

YEAR-END COUNSELOR DEBRIEF — REQUIRED WITHIN 5 SCHOOL DAYS OF L7 Required for both teacher and counselor. Not because the lesson is high-risk — because the full year of AoG is a significant shared professional experience that deserves formal closure. REVIEW: Any students activated in L7 (index card return, year-end reflection). FOLLOW-UP: Students flagged across the year who need counselor contact over summer or at Book 5 start. TEACHER STATE: Counselor explicitly asks — 'What was this year like for you?' 'Was there a lesson or a student that cost you something you're still carrying?' Secondary trauma can accumulate across a full year of emotionally significant instructional work. BOOK 5 HANDOFF: If Book 5 is delivered by a different teacher — formal counselor-facilitated handoff required before B5-U1-L1.

NOTE

Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Unit 4: Community & Legacy · COMPLETE MERGED DOCUMENT Tier 1 + Tier 2 · Merge verified — no conflicts · Book 4 complete — all 28 lessons across 4 units School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden, Founder · Pilot Version CONFIDENTIAL — For District Review and Curriculum Development Use Only NEXT: Book 5: The Capstone · Grades 11–12 · Unit 1: The Compass of Values

1

THE INDEX CARD RETURN

10 MIN

Distribute sealed index cards. 'Open it only when you are ready.' 2 minutes of silence for students to open and read. Then: 'Write in your journal: what did you write in September? What do you notice about it now? What has shifted?' 5 minutes private reflection.

2

THE YEAR-END SYNTHESIS

12 MIN

'The year moved through four units. Today: where did the year leave you?' Students write privately for 8 minutes: 'The most important shift in me since August is _____. The unit that asked the most of me was _____. The tool from this year I will still be using at 25 is _____. The person I am becoming is _____.' After 8 minutes: optional whole-class sharing — teacher models by sharing their own answer first.

3

THE CLASS LEGACY CHART

15 MIN

Bring out the large blank chart paper titled THE CLASS LEGACY · [Year] · [Class]. 'Now we build something together. Not the curriculum — the actual thing. The culture. The trust. The room that was different at the end than it was at the beginning.' Facilitate structured whole-class discussion. Teacher records student responses verbatim, attributed to the class, not to individuals. After generation: read the chart aloud in full. 'This is what you built. Collectively. It did not exist before you built it.' Photograph the chart.

4

THE CLOSING RITUAL — THE FINAL BRIDGE

8 MIN

First: 'Turn to the person next to you — anyone — and say one true thing you have noticed about them this year. Not a compliment. Something you actually noticed — specific and real.' Allow 3 minutes. Second — closing script — deliver verbatim: 'Everything you built in this room this year — the framework, the vocabulary, the practice — it travels with you. The Identity Shield, the Backpack Audit, the Compassionate Witness, the Grace Legacy Statement — those are yours. They do not belong to this classroom. They belong to you. Whatever room you walk into next year, or in five years, or in twenty years — you walk in as someone who has done this work. That is not nothing. Take good care of each other out there.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-28A

UNIT REFLECTION — CULTURE CELEBRATION

THE SITUATION

At the end of the year, Amara's teacher asks: 'What is one thing this class did this year that you want to name out loud?' Students take turns. The answers are specific: 'We didn't let Jaylen get left out when his group changed.' 'We told Marcus when we thought he was wrong and didn't make it weird afterward.' 'We celebrated Nia's regional win like it mattered, even though some of us didn't make the team.' None of these are in the curriculum. All of them are evidence of it. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What do the specific moments students name tell you about what the class actually built this year? None of the things students name are formal curriculum activities. What does that reveal about where culture lives? What is the difference between a class that performs grace and a class that actually builds it? Name one specific thing your class did this year — not a formal activity, but a real moment — that evidenced the culture you were building. **THE EVIDENCE OF CULTURE** Culture is not built in curriculum — it is evidenced by it. The specific, small moments students recall at year-end are the real data: not what the class studied, but what the class actually did when no one was evaluating. These moments are the architecture of grace in practice. They cannot be planned, assigned, or performed. They can only be grown — slowly, in a community that takes them seriously.

B4-28B

UNIT REFLECTION — CULTURE CELEBRATION

THE SITUATION

In his final journal entry of the year, Marcus writes: 'I didn't think this class would matter. I thought it would be another box to check. The thing I didn't expect is that I actually know people differently now. I know what Nia is afraid of. I know what Jonah is working on. I know that Priya has been carrying something heavy for two years. None of that was in a lesson plan. It just happened because we were in a room that made it okay to be real.' **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did the class create that allowed Marcus to know people differently — and how did it get created? Marcus says none of it was in a lesson plan. What was in the lesson plan that made the unplanned things possible? A room that makes it 'okay to be real' does not happen automatically. What conditions produce it? As you leave this class, what is one thing you know about another person in this room that you want to carry forward? **THE ROOM THAT MADE IT OKAY** Safety — psychological, relational safety — is the foundation on which genuine growth becomes possible. The curriculum creates structure. The room — the specific community of people who show up to it — creates the conditions in which the structure produces something real. Marcus's journal captures what the curriculum is ultimately trying to build: a room where being real is okay. That room is not the lesson. It is what the lessons are for.

SECTION THREE

ASSESSMENT SUITE

Grades 9–10 · Pilot Year

3.1 Overview & Administration Timing

The Architecture of Grace Assessment & Outcome Measurement Suite contains eight instruments covering all grade bands. For Book 4 (Grades 9–10), the four instruments most relevant to the classroom — and to district reporting for this grade band — are reproduced in full below as Section 3. They may be photocopied and distributed within the licensed adopting district.

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE — APPLIES TO ALL INSTRUMENTS BELOW

The instruments in this section were developed by large language models (LLMs) at the recommendation of an AI-generated curriculum review panel. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. These are unvalidated working-draft tools for the pilot year. They must be reviewed by a qualified educational measurement specialist before any high-stakes use, including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy.

INSTRUMENT F · GRADES 9–10

PURPOSE: Pre/post measure of self-awareness, self-compassion, and grace orientation across the year.

ADMINISTRATION: 30–35 minutes. Group-administered. Anonymous unless student requests otherwise.

WINDOWS: Pre — First week of year, before U1 L1. Post — Within 2 weeks after U4 L7.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

ADMINISTRATION WINDOWS

PRE-ASSESSMENT · Week 1 of the school year. Before any Unit 1 lesson is delivered. MID-YEAR FAMILY SURVEY · End of Unit 2. Distribute 2 weeks before winter break. POST-ASSESSMENT · Within 2 weeks after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Same instrument as pre-assessment for paired comparison. YEAR-END FAMILY SURVEY · End of Unit 4. Distribute with year-end communications.

3.2 Who Receives Which Instrument

RECIPIENT MAP

STUDENTS · Pre and post — same instrument administered by delivering teacher. FAMILIES · Mid-year and year-end family survey. Optional. Anonymous return. TEACHERS · Self-reported teacher fidelity log — completed at end of each unit. COUNSELORS · Counselor coordination log — same-day notes after every ★ and ★★ lesson.

3.3 Built-In Assessment Tools

EMBEDDED FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

Exit Tickets · Every lesson. Three-sentence student stem. Private. Never graded. Teacher Reflection · Every lesson. Private prompt to inform instruction. In-Lesson Scans · Behavioral observation cues embedded at specific activities. Note privately.

3.A1

INSTRUMENT F — STUDENT SELF-SURVEY (PRE/POST)

Student Self-Report · Written · Grades 9–10 · 16 Items + 4 Open-Response Prompts

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

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ADMINISTRATION NOTES

- Administer in the first week of the school year, before Unit 1 Lesson 1 (pre). Administer in the final week, after Unit 4 Lesson 7 (post).
- Introduce as a reflection tool, not a test: 'These questions help me understand how the year is going for you. There are no right answers.'

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

- Allow 15–20 minutes. Students work independently in silence.
- Store pre-assessments privately. Return alongside post so students can see their own Pre/Post Change column.
- Store by Student ID code only — never by student name. See FERPA compliance guidance below.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · GRADES 9–10

Student Self-Survey Circle one: BEGINNING OF YEAR / END OF YEAR Name (optional): _____

Grade: _____ Date: _____ Directions: For each statement, circle the number that best describes you right now. 1 = Not at all like me 2 = A little like me 3 = Mostly like me 4 = Definitely like me

CONSTRUCT 1 — IDENTITY AUTHENTICITY

1. I can identify a set of core values that stay steady regardless of social pressure.	1	2	3	4
2. I know the difference between the identity I perform for others and who I actually am.	1	2	3	4
3. I make choices based on my own values after genuinely considering input from others — not just to please or rebel.	1	2	3	4
4. My sense of who I am does not collapse when a significant outcome (grade, admission, recognition) doesn't go my way.	1	2	3	4

CONSTRUCT 2 — SELF-COMPASSION & ACCOUNTABILITY

5. When I make a significant mistake, I can hold myself accountable without condemning myself as a person.	1	2	3	4
6. I know the difference between an apology (a statement) and a living amend (sustained changed behavior).	1	2	3	4
7. I have a sustainable daily practice that genuinely restores my capacity — not just numbs or avoids.	1	2	3	4
8. I am able to view my own failures with the same honest, fair perspective I would offer a person I respect.	1	2	3	4

CONSTRUCT 3 — FORGIVENESS & RELATIONAL INTELLIGENCE

9. I understand that forgiveness is an internal act for my own peace — separate from trust and separate from reconciliation.	1	2	3	4
10. I can understand the context behind hurtful behavior without excusing it.	1	2	3	4
11. I know what it means to hold concurrent truths: I can forgive someone AND maintain appropriate protective distance.	1	2	3	4
12. I can identify at least one significant pattern or cycle in my history that I am choosing not to repeat.	1	2	3	4

CONSTRUCT 4 — GRACE & LEGACY THINKING

13. I practice giving people the benefit of the doubt — especially people who feel different from me.	1	2	3	4
14. I can articulate the kind of environment I want to build in my future workplaces and relationships.	1	2	3	4
15. I have a sense of what I want to contribute — something I can plant for people who come after me.	1	2	3	4
16. I know what kind of person I am choosing to become, independent of what I achieve.	1	2	3	4

OPEN RESPONSE PROMPTS — GRADES 9–10

Students complete all four at post-assessment. Pre-assessment: complete prompts 1 and 2 only.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

1. What is one thing you know about yourself now that you would want your future self to remember?

2. Describe a mistake or failure that has shaped you. What did it cost, and what did it make possible?

3. What does forgiveness mean to you after this year? How has your understanding of it changed?

4. THE CORNERSTONE QUESTION: What are you planting — right now, this year — for people who may never know your name?

SCORING & INTERPRETATION — GRADES 9–10

FOR TEACHER USE ONLY

Scoring: 1 pt → 4 pts per item. Maximum = 64. Compare pre and post totals at individual and class level. Open response prompts are qualitative — do not score; use for portfolio and conversation purposes. Class-level: Items where 50%+ of students score 1–2 at post-assessment identify areas for Year 2 reinforcement. Individual: Students scoring 1 on all Construct 2 or Construct 3 items at post may benefit from counselor awareness. Screening signal only — not diagnostic. What to claim and not claim: You can say 'Students self-report higher levels of identity clarity, self-compassion, and understanding of forgiveness by year-end — based on an original curriculum-aligned perception measure.' You cannot say 'Our students demonstrated clinically significant SEL gains.'

3.A2

INSTRUMENT E — TEACHER FIDELITY OBSERVATION CHECKLIST

All Grade Bands · Used by Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, Curriculum Directors

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

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UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

PURPOSE: Instrument E provides a structured observation protocol for administrators conducting informal walk-throughs and formal fidelity observations. Use at least once per semester per delivering teacher. First observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 1 (informal). Second observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 3 (formal).

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE — TEACHER FIDELITY OBSERVATION CHECKLIST

Observer: _____ Teacher: _____ Date: _____ Unit/
Lesson: _____ Grade Band: _____

LESSON STRUCTURE & SEQUENCE

Lesson follows the stated unit sequence — not skipped or reordered	☐	☐
Opening ritual/hook is present and predictable before content begins	☐	☐
Students have journals and are using them independently	☐	☐
Grade-level differentiation is visible (appropriate band pacing and scaffolding)	☐	☐
Lesson concludes with a structured exit ticket	☐	☐

VOCABULARY & CURRICULUM LANGUAGE

Teacher uses curriculum vocabulary naturally (grade-appropriate: e.g., Oops vs. Forever / shame vs. guilt / internal critic / impact vs. intent / grace gap)	☐	☐
Key vocabulary is visible in the classroom during the lesson	☐	☐

EMOTIONAL CLIMATE & HOLDING

Students appear physically settled and emotionally present at lesson start	☐	☐
Teacher maintains non-anxious presence — neither dismissive of emotion nor destabilised by it	☐	☐
Discussion participation is voluntary — no student is pressured to share	☐	☐
Teacher responds to emotional moments without shutting them down or amplifying them	☐	☐

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)
DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL READINESS

Teacher knows the disclosure protocol (can describe the 4 types and 6-step response if asked)	☐	☐
School counselor is aware of today's lesson content	☐	☐
For high-risk lessons (as designated ★★ in each book): counselor is present or immediately available	☐	☐

EQUITY & ACCESSIBILITY

Multiple engagement modalities are available (writing, drawing, partner discussion, verbal response)	☐	☐
ELL scaffolding materials are present for students who need them	☐	☐
IEP/504 accommodations are in evidence for students with documented plans	☐	☐
No student is pressured toward forgiveness or emotional disclosure	☐	☐
Culturally responsive delivery is evident — not a one-size framing of constructs	☐	☐

FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

Family Connection prompts are being sent home at unit transitions	☐	☐
Year-start PPRA notification letter was distributed at least 10 days before Lesson 1	☐	☐

OVERALL FIDELITY RATING

☐ Strong (90%+ of items present) — Curriculum delivered with high fidelity. ☐ Developing (70–89% of items present) — One targeted follow-up conversation recommended. ☐ Needs Support (below 70%) — Schedule a direct conversation; consider mid-year coaching session. Observer Notes / Follow-up Actions:

3.A3

INSTRUMENT G — FAMILY ENGAGEMENT SURVEY

Grades 9–10 · Distributed at End of Unit 2 (Mid-Year) and End of Unit 4 (Year-End) · Anonymous

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

This instrument was developed by large language models (LLMs) at the recommendation of an AI-generated curriculum review panel. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. This is an unvalidated working-draft tool for the pilot year. Do not use for high-stakes decisions — including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy — without independent professional review by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

PURPOSE: Instrument G captures anonymous family perception at two points in the year — after Unit 2, when the self-compassion and internal critic work has been delivered, and at year-end. Results are shared with delivering teachers before the mid-year coaching session and used to improve second-half delivery and Year 2 implementation.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE — FAMILY ENGAGEMENT SURVEY

School: _____ Grade Band: _____ Distribution: ☐ Mid-Year (after Unit 2) ☐ Year-End (after Unit 4) Date: _____ This survey is anonymous. Please do not write your name or your child's name.

PART 1 — PROGRAM AWARENESS & COMMUNICATION

I have received clear information about the Architecture of Grace curriculum at my child's school.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understand the goals of the curriculum and what my child is learning.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I know how to opt my child out of any specific lesson if I wish to.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel my voice as a parent/guardian is welcomed by the school regarding this curriculum.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 2 — OBSERVED CHILD IMPACT

My child has talked at home about something they learned in this class.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have noticed my child using language or skills from this class outside of school (e.g., naming feelings, taking ownership, repairing).	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child seems more able to handle mistakes without becoming destabilized.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My child has demonstrated more self-compassion or self-kindness this year.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 3 — FREQUENCY & ENGAGEMENT

How often has your child discussed SEL class at home?	☐	☐	☐	☐
How often have you used the optional Family Connection prompts sent home?	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 4 — OPEN RESPONSE (OPTIONAL)

Is there anything about this curriculum you would like the school to know — a concern, a positive observation, or a question?

Results from this survey are compiled anonymously and shared with delivering teachers before the mid-year coaching session and at year-end. Individual responses are never attributed. Results are used for programme improvement only — not for teacher evaluation.

3.A4**INSTRUMENT H — PILOT YEAR DATA PROTOCOL**

For District Assessment Coordinators · All Grade Bands · Pilot Year

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

PURPOSE: Instrument H is the district-level guide to collecting, storing, analyzing, and (optionally) submitting data from the Architecture of Grace pilot year. It covers the full collection timeline, FERPA and mandatory reporting compliance, effect size benchmarks, equity analysis guidance, and recommended validated supplementary instruments for districts that wish to build a more rigorous evidence base.

▲ SCOPE OF THIS PROTOCOL

The pre/post student surveys are original, unvalidated instruments measuring self-reported perception. They are appropriate for programme-level reflection and improvement. They are not appropriate for high-stakes claims about student outcomes, teacher effectiveness, or programme efficacy without additional validation by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

SECTION 1 — DATA COLLECTION TIMELINE

Week 1 of school (before U1L1)	Grade-appropriate pre-assessment	Classroom teacher. Store by Student ID code only — never by name.
End of Unit 2 (mid-year)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Returned to building administrator. Anonymous.
September / January / May–June	Administrator Monitoring Protocol	Building principal or district coordinator. Three checkpoints.
Once per semester per teacher	Fidelity Observation Checklist	Instructional coach or building principal during lesson observation.
Final week (after U4L7)	Grade-appropriate post-assessment	Same classroom teacher. Return pre alongside post for student self-comparison.
End of Unit 4 (year-end)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Anonymous.
After post-assessment is collected	Calculate gain scores & complete pilot data summary	District Assessment Coordinator. Aggregate by grade band — no individual student data.
Optional — June deadline	Submit aggregate anonymised data to School of Life Foundation	Voluntary. Contributes to ESSA Tier 2 evidence base. No individual data submitted.

SECTION 2 — FERPA & MANDATORY REPORTING COMPLIANCE**FERPA REQUIREMENTS**

Student ID codes: Match pre and post assessments by a de-identified Student ID code — never by student name. The key connecting ID codes to student names must be stored separately and securely. Storage: All completed assessment instruments stored in a password-protected digital system or locked physical location. Access limited to the classroom teacher and district assessment coordinator. Sharing: No individual student data is shared with parents, other teachers, administrators, or the School of Life Foundation. Only aggregate, anonymised data is compiled for programme review. Year-end disposition: Pre and post assessments are returned to students at year-end, or destroyed securely. They are not retained in the student's permanent academic record. 18-year-old student rights: Under FERPA, students who have turned 18 hold their own educational records rights. For Books 4 and 5, student consent (not parental) is required for any records sharing. This applies to all 9–12 instruments.

SECTION 3 — EFFECT SIZE BENCHMARKS

The following benchmarks are provided for districts that wish to assess whether observed pre/post gains are educationally meaningful. These are guidance values for programme reflection — not performance thresholds.

$d < 0.2$	Negligible	Pre/post change is within normal variation. No strong signal of curriculum impact at the construct level. Review delivery fidelity.
$d \geq 0.2$	Small	Modest signal. Students are moving in the right direction on self-report measures. Consistent with low-intensity SEL exposure.
$d \geq 0.3$	Target threshold	The pilot year target for Architecture of Grace. Consistent with Tier 2 ESSA evidence expectations for SEL programmes.
$d \geq 0.5$	Moderate	Strong signal for a self-report measure. Indicates meaningful programme impact is likely if delivery fidelity is confirmed.
$d \geq 0.8$	Large	Very strong signal. Uncommon in self-report SEL instruments without clinical intervention. Warrants validation with external measure.

Calculating d : $d = (\text{Mean Post} - \text{Mean Pre}) / \text{Pooled Standard Deviation}$. Use the composite score (sum of all items) for the calculation. Calculate separately by grade band — do not combine K–2 and 9–12 data.

SECTION 4 — EQUITY ANALYSIS

Aggregate data alone may mask meaningful disparities. After calculating overall gain scores, disaggregate by the following subgroups where data is available. No student should be identifiable from reported data.

ELL / English Language Learner status	Comparable pre/post gain to non-ELL peers. Lower gain may indicate scaffolding gaps.
Students with IEP / 504 plans	Comparable access and engagement. Lower gain warrants review of accommodation implementation.
Race / Ethnicity	No systematic gap in gain scores by racial/ethnic group. Differential outcomes warrant curriculum equity review.
Grade level (within a band)	Comparable gains across Grades 3/4/5, 6/7/8, or 9/10/11/12. Significant variance by grade may indicate pacing mismatch.
Teacher (where multiple teachers deliver)	Comparable gains across classrooms. Significant variance warrants fidelity review for lower-gain classrooms.

SECTION 5 — RECOMMENDED VALIDATED SUPPLEMENTARY INSTRUMENTS

For districts seeking externally validated measures to supplement the Architecture of Grace pre/post surveys, the following instruments are recommended. These are independent of the School of Life Foundation and require separate licensing.

DESSA-3 (Devereux Student Strengths Assessment)	K–12	Social-emotional competence across 8 subscales. Teacher-rated. ESSA evidence-based. Provides validated external benchmark for self-compassion and relationship skills constructs.
SSIS-SEL (Social Skills Improvement System)	K–12	CASEL-aligned SEL competencies. Both teacher-rated and student self-report versions. Covers all five CASEL domains addressed in this curriculum.
Neff SCS-SF (Self-Compassion Scale – Short Form)	Grades 7–12	Validated 12-item self-report measuring the three components of self-compassion (Neff, 2003). Directly aligned to Unit 2 constructs across all grade bands.
Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale	Grades 6–12	10-item validated self-report. Not a direct curriculum measure, but provides external validity check on identity and self-worth constructs from Units 1 and 4.
BASC-3 BESS (Behavioral and Emotional Screening System)	K–12	Brief universal screener for behavioural and emotional risk. Can identify students who may need Tier 2 or Tier 3 support beyond this Tier 1 curriculum.

SECTION 6 — VOLUNTARY DATA SUBMISSION TO SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

WHAT IS SUBMITTED — AND WHAT IS NOT

Eligible to submit: Aggregate, anonymised pre/post gain score data at the grade-band level. Total N (number of students assessed). Delivery fidelity summary. Family survey aggregate results. No individual student data. No teacher-identified data. Never submitted: Individual student names, ID codes, or scores. Teacher names or classroom-level data. Any data that could identify a student, family, or educator. What submission does: Contributes to the Tier 2 (Moderate Evidence) ESSA pathway for the Architecture of Grace curriculum. Helps the School of Life Foundation improve instruments, implementation support, and equity guidance across the pilot cohort. Submission is voluntary. It has no bearing on continued access to the curriculum, district support, or licensing.

SECTION FOUR

Reference & Compliance

Framing Essay · Admin Guide · Legal & Clinical · Counselor Calendar

4.1 Framing Essay

On The Façade

There is a moment, somewhere around the start of high school, when a young person realizes that the self they have been performing is not the same as the self they actually are. Sometimes this realization comes as relief. Sometimes it comes as alarm. Most often, it comes as a quiet, persistent, half-acknowledged awareness — the sense that something is off, and that it has been off for some time, and that nobody else seems to be naming it.

Book 4: The Façade is the curriculum's response to that moment. It does not assume the gap between curated and authentic self is pathological. It assumes the gap is normal, often necessary, and always worth examining. The question is not whether you adjust your presentation across contexts — you do, and so does everyone. The question is whether the gap is costing you more than it is giving you.

The four units move from inside to outside, from interior to community: identity, self-compassion, empathy and forgiveness, and grace as a chosen practice. Each unit builds on the previous one, and each one is structured around a single signature artifact that the student keeps. The Identity Shield. The Backpack Audit. The Class Legacy. These are not just classroom activities. They are the architecture. They are what travels with the student into the next year, the next school, the next chapter.

What this curriculum cannot do is replace the quality of the relationship between teacher and student. The materials in this book are tools. They become a curriculum only when a teacher chooses to be in the room with the work.

4.2 Quick Start Guide for Administrators

BEFORE THE SCHOOL YEAR BEGINS

CURRICULUM ADOPTION Building principal confirms district adoption of Architecture of Grace as Tier 1 universal SEL curriculum. **STAFFING** Identify delivering teacher(s). One teacher per cohort. Delivering teacher must complete half-day PD. **COUNSELOR LOAD** Confirm counselor availability for ★ and ★★ dates. Block all dates on counselor calendar before U1 L1. **FAMILY NOTIFICATION** PPRA notifications distributed 10+ days before any PPRA-designated lesson. See Section 4.4 for full PPRA framework. **MATERIALS** Confirm scenario card sets are printed, laminated, and ready for U1 L1. Confirm anchor chart paper supply for entire year.

4.3 Executive Summary

Book Four: The Façade • Social Agency & Emotional Regulation. Twenty-eight lessons across four units. 45–55 min per lesson. Four signature student artifacts. Aligned to all five CASEL competencies, with primary emphasis on self-awareness in Unit 1, self-management in Unit 2, social awareness and relationship skills in Unit 3, and responsible decision-making in Unit 4.

WHAT DISTRICTS SHOULD EXPECT

OUTCOMES Measurable improvement in student self-reported self-compassion, identity stability, and forgiveness orientation across the year. Pre/post instrument data triangulates against teacher and family observations. **DISCLOSURE** This curriculum will surface disclosures. Counselor capacity must be in place. The Disclosure Protocol is non-negotiable. **FIDELITY** Tier 1 universal delivery to all students in the grade band. Reflection Pass available; no opt-out from the curriculum itself except via formal PPRA opt-out for designated lessons. **STAFFING** Delivering teacher must be a known adult who has completed PD. Substitutes do not deliver SEL lessons. See Section 1.8.

4.4 Legal & Clinical Compliance

PPRA • PROTECTION OF PUPIL RIGHTS AMENDMENT

PPRA-designated lessons require parental notification at least 10 school days before delivery. Standard 3-tier opt-out protocols apply: (1) opt-out of the specific lesson with alternative academic activity; (2) opt-out of the unit with alternative SEL coursework; (3) opt-out of the curriculum entirely with district-approved Tier 1 alternative.

FERPA • FAMILY EDUCATIONAL RIGHTS AND PRIVACY ACT

Student journals, exit tickets, and worksheets are educational records protected under FERPA. They are never shared, displayed, or quoted without explicit student consent. The default disposition of all student-generated material is private and non-collected. Material the student chooses to surrender becomes part of the FERPA-protected record.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

MANDATORY REPORTING

Mandatory reporting obligations apply as in any other classroom context. The curriculum's privacy promise to students has one explicit limit: if a student's disclosure suggests danger to themselves or others, the teacher follows the school's mandatory reporting protocol. This limit is named in the Year-Start Script and the Classroom Compact, and is reaffirmed before every PPRA lesson.

STUDENT DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · 6-STEP PROCEDURE

STEP 1 Stop the lesson. Do not continue with prepared content. **STEP 2** Activate the school's mandatory disclosure protocol — same channel used for any disclosure. **STEP 3** Contact the counselor immediately — not after class. **STEP 4** Do not leave the student alone. Do not attempt to assess risk independently. **STEP 5** Document the disclosure in writing the same day. **STEP 6** Follow the Post-Disclosure Re-Entry Protocol when the student returns to class.

4.5 Counselor Integration Calendar

ANNUAL COUNSELOR CALENDAR · STANDING COMMITMENTS

PRE-YEAR Half-day PD attendance. Receives curriculum binder and disclosure protocol. **BEFORE U1 L1** Coordination meeting with delivering teacher. All ★ and ★★ dates blocked. **EVERY ★ DATE** Counselor briefed before delivery. On standby same day. **EVERY ★★ DATE** Counselor physically on-site for full lesson. No exceptions, no substitutes. **MID-YEAR** Mid-year PD session. Anonymized observations on student wellbeing. **YEAR-END** Year-end debrief within 5 school days of Unit 4 Lesson 7.

4.6 Inclusive Delivery — IEP / SpEd / ELL

IEP / 504 ACCOMMODATIONS

All standard accommodations apply to Architecture of Grace as to any other instructional context. The curriculum's reflective and discussion-based format tends to accommodate well — extended time, alternative response formats (drawing, verbal response), and quiet workspace are all easily incorporated.

SPECIAL EDUCATION

For students receiving SpEd services, the curriculum can be co-delivered with the SpEd teacher or paraprofessional present. Concept density may be modulated while preserving core lesson architecture. The signature artifacts (Identity Shield, Backpack Audit, Class Legacy / Compass of Integrity, Graduation Charter) are designed to be completed at the student's own pace and depth.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNERS

The curriculum's vocabulary load is moderate and is supported by anchor charts in every unit. ELL students benefit from advance access to the Key Vocabulary list at the start of each lesson. Native-language journaling is fully acceptable; the journal is private to the student. Scenario cards may be paired with vocabulary glosses for ELL students at lower English proficiency levels.

4.7 Family Engagement Materials

FAMILY CONNECTION LETTERS

Sent home after specified lessons. Each letter names what was explored, offers a single conversation-starter for home, and explicitly states that no follow-up is required. Family Connection letters are never homework. They are an invitation, not an obligation.

MID-YEAR AND YEAR-END FAMILY SURVEYS

Distributed at the close of Unit 2 and Unit 4. Anonymous return. Captures family-reported observations of student-level changes in self-awareness, self-compassion, conflict resolution, and grace orientation. Findings inform the year-end teacher reflection and any program-level adjustment for the following year.

OPTIONAL FAMILY WORKSHOPS

Two optional 60-minute family workshops are available — one at the start of the year (Year-Opening Workshop), one at mid-year (Mid-Year Bridge Workshop). Districts may schedule these as standalone evening sessions or integrate them into existing parent-teacher conference cycles.

4.7.A

Pre-Year Family Letter & PPRA Notification

Reproduce on school letterhead. Distribute minimum 10 calendar days before Unit 1 Lesson 1. The PPRA notification language below satisfies federal requirements; the surrounding family letter establishes context and tone.

TEACHER NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS PACKET

The Pre-Year Letter (4.7.A) and the four Unit Transition Letters (4.7.B) are the structured family-engagement spine of Book 4. Send each on the schedule indicated. The Family Grace Guide (4.7.C) is offered to families optionally at the start of Unit 4. The Family Grace Audit (4.7.D), Final Reflection (4.7.E), and Closing Words (4.7.F) are sent home as a single packet at the end of the year alongside the Year-End Letter. The Administrative Forms (4.7.G) are not for families — they are the formal compliance documents the district keeps on file.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

Dear Families, This year, your ninth or tenth grader will participate in Architecture of Grace, Book 4: The Façade — a research-grounded, secular social-emotional learning curriculum running across the full academic year in 28 lessons of 45–55 minutes each. Book 4 meets adolescents at the developmental moment they are actually living in. Grades 9 and 10 are the years of identity reconstruction under social pressure — where the curated digital self meets the authentic interior, where peer hierarchies reorganize around new social currencies, and where the prefrontal cortex is still under active construction. The work of this curriculum is built around questions that define this season: What part of me is performance, and what part is real? What do I actually believe, when nobody is watching? How do I disagree with someone without becoming the noise? Across four units — The Curated Self, Resilience Through Self-Kindness, Conflict & Context, and Community & Legacy — students develop a working internal vocabulary for navigating their own lives. The three signature artifacts of the year are the Identity Shield (the four-quadrant self-portrait completed at the close of Unit 1), the Backpack Audit (the Unit 2 capstone — a structured inventory of what they are still carrying and what they are choosing to put down), and the Class Legacy (the collective artifact this specific class chooses to leave for the cohort behind them). **This curriculum is secular.** The terms grace, mercy, and forgiveness are used in their psychological sense throughout. Your family's religious tradition belongs to your family, and the curriculum is explicit that it is not a substitute for, replacement of, or commentary on any religious framework. **This curriculum never requires forgiveness.** Students learn what forgiveness looks like for people who choose it. They also learn, explicitly and repeatedly, that forgiveness is never required of them when someone is currently still hurting them. "I choose not to forgive yet" is treated with the same respect as "I choose to forgive." **PPRA Notification.** Eight lessons in Book 4 are designated as PPRA-protected (Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment, 20 U.S.C. § 1232h). You will receive a separate lesson-specific notice 10 calendar days before each. The PPRA-flagged lessons are: U1 L1 (Beyond the Brand), U1 L2 (The Social Battery), U2 L1 (The Perfectionism Weight), U2 L3 (Sustainable Accountability), U2 L6 (The Compassionate Witness), U3 L2 (Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation), U3 L3 (The Boundary of Peace), and U3 L5 (Contextual Empathy). One additional lesson, U2 L7 (The Backpack Audit), carries the ★★ Counselor Required designation; the school counselor is on-site for the full lesson. **Your rights.** You may inspect any curriculum material before it is taught — a physical copy of Book 4 is available in the school office within 5 school days of any request. You may opt your child out of any specific lesson, any cluster of lessons, or the entire programme. Opt-out is non-punitive. The Opt-Out Request Form is in Section 4.7.G and at the school office. Every student also has a Reflection Pass on every lesson day — a small physical card that allows them to opt out of a specific activity without explanation. How you can support this work without doing it for them. The most useful thing you can do is let your adolescent come to YOU with the language. Don't pursue. Don't quiz. Don't require them to translate their school day into a debrief at the dinner table. When they bring you a piece of curriculum vocabulary — the Curated Self, the Integrity Anchor, the Compassionate Witness, the Backpack — take it seriously. Don't make them defend it. You will receive a brief letter at the close of each unit so you know what your child has been working with and what is coming next. At the end of the year you will receive the Family Grace Audit packet — a private self-reflection tool for your family that no one but you ever sees. If you have questions, please contact: School Counselor:

_____ Teacher: _____ Principal:
_____ Sincerely, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

4.7.B

Unit Transition Letters

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FAÇADE (9–10)

Four short letters home, distributed at the close of each unit. Each letter names the unit's vocabulary and what is coming next. The point is to give parents the same words their adolescent is learning — not to make them re-teach it.

LETTER 1 • END OF UNIT 1 • TRANSITION TO UNIT 2

Distribute at the close of Unit 1 Lesson 7.

Dear Families, Your child has just completed Unit 1 of Book 4 — The Curated Self, Identity. They have worked with the following vocabulary, which may now show up in conversations at home: · Beyond the Brand & the Curated Self — the difference between the version of yourself you present to an audience and the version that is actually there when no one is watching. The curated self is not the enemy. It just isn't the whole story. · The Social Battery — the felt experience of social capacity, depletion, and recovery. Some students discovered they have been running on empty. · The Integrity Anchor — the values that hold position under pressure. The thing in you that says no when everyone else is saying yes. · The Groupthink Trap — the moment when the group's thinking becomes louder than your own. · Silencing the Noise — the practice of distinguishing peer signal from personal signal in moments of pressure. · The Identity Shield (Unit 1 Lesson 7) — the four-quadrant self-portrait your student completed: core values, authentic strengths, non-negotiables, and the adult I am becoming. This is a private artifact that travels with them through the year. In Unit 2 — Resilience Through Self-Kindness — we move into the most internally focused unit of the year. Your child will encounter the Perfectionism Weight, the 'Not Yet' Lens, Sustainable Accountability, the Compassionate Witness as a corrective to the Internal Critic, and the year's second signature artifact: the Backpack Audit (U2 L7), which carries the ★★ Counselor Required designation. Five Unit 2 lessons are PPRA-protected. **How to support this work at home:** if you hear your child being harsh with themselves, you do not need to fix it. You can name it the way the curriculum does: "That sounded like the Internal Critic. I wonder what the Compassionate Witness would say." Then drop it. They heard you. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

LETTER 2 • END OF UNIT 2 • MID-YEAR • TRANSITION TO UNIT 3

Distribute at the close of Unit 2 Lesson 7, alongside the Family Mid-Year Survey.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FAÇADE (9–10)

Dear Families, We have reached the mid-year point of Book 4. Your child has just completed Unit 2 — Resilience Through Self-Kindness. This is the most internally demanding unit of the year. It asks adolescents to do something many adults still struggle with: notice the voice in their own head, hear it for what it is, and choose the Compassionate Witness instead of the Internal Critic. They worked with Sustainable Accountability (the practice of owning a mistake without using it to attack themselves), the 'Not Yet' Lens (the difference between 'I can't' and 'I haven't yet'), and Self-Care vs. Self-Indulgence. Lesson 7 (The Backpack Audit) is the ★★ Counselor Required lesson of Unit 2. The school counselor was on-site for the full lesson. The Backpack Audit is a structured inventory of what your student is still carrying — the labels, the wounds, the self-narratives — and what they are choosing to put down. It is a private artifact. If something from that work surfaces at home in the days and weeks ahead, please contact the counselor or teacher directly. This is normal and expected. In Unit 3 — Conflict & Context, Empathy & Forgiving Others — we shift outward. Your child will work with Conflict as Information, the crucial distinction between Forgiveness and Reconciliation, the Boundary of Peace, Calling In vs. Calling Out, Contextual Empathy, and the Grace Challenge. Four Unit 3 lessons are PPRA-protected. **Enclosed:** Family Mid-Year Survey. Your responses are anonymous and shape the next pilot year. Approximately 8 minutes. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

LETTER 3 • END OF UNIT 3 • TRANSITION TO UNIT 4

Distribute at the close of Unit 3 Lesson 7.

Dear Families, Your child has just completed Unit 3 — Conflict & Context. Across seven lessons they worked with several distinctions that take most adults decades to internalise: · Conflict as Information — conflict is not always a failure. Often it is data about a difference that needs to be named. · Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation — forgiveness is internal, between you and you, and requires only the forgiver. Reconciliation is relational, requires changed behaviour over time, and is never owed. · The Boundary of Peace — a limit set because you respect yourself, not because you are punishing the other person. · Calling In vs. Calling Out — the difference between addressing harm in a way that invites accountability and addressing it in a way that performs righteousness. · Contextual Empathy — understanding what is happening for someone else without using that understanding to excuse what they did. · The Grace Challenge — a chosen, voluntary practice of extending grace to one specific person or situation across one defined period. In Unit 4 — Community & Legacy, From Grace to Grace Culture — your child works with Grace Culture itself, Charitable Interpretation, Bearing Witness, Grace Under Pressure, the community-scale Grace Audit, the Grace Legacy, and the year's capstone: the Class Legacy (Unit 4 Lesson 7). Unit 4 closes the year on a forward-leaning, outward-facing register. **What you may notice at home:** Unit 3 carries significant emotional weight. Some students arrive at Unit 4 lighter; some arrive heavier. Both are normal. Unit 4 is structurally lighter and more action-oriented — which is the rhythm by design. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

LETTER 4 • END OF UNIT 4 • YEAR-END

Distribute after Unit 4 Lesson 7 (Year-End Celebration — the Class Legacy), alongside the Family Grace Audit packet (Sections 4.7.D–F) and the Family Year-End Survey.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

Dear Families, Architecture of Grace, Book 4, is complete. Your child has spent a school year with a vocabulary most adolescents are never given at this developmental moment: Beyond the Brand and the Curated Self, the Social Battery, the Integrity Anchor, the Groupthink Trap, the Identity Shield, the Perfectionism Weight, the 'Not Yet' Lens, Sustainable Accountability, the Compassionate Witness, the Backpack Audit, Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation, the Boundary of Peace, Calling In vs. Calling Out, Contextual Empathy, the Grace Challenge, Charitable Interpretation, Bearing Witness, Grace Under Pressure, and — their final synthesis — the Class Legacy this specific cohort chose to leave for the students coming up behind them. They will not have mastered any of these. Nobody does in one year, and the Grade 9–10 season of life is not when the answers settle. What they have done is hear, see, and practise these distinctions dozens of times in a holding environment — a classroom where the Compassionate Witness standard applied to how people spoke to each other. **Enclosed with this letter:** three sections from the master document — the Family Grace Audit (Section 4.7.D), the Final Reflection (Section 4.7.E), and the Closing Words to Families (Section 4.7.F). Together they form a private, unscored self-reflection packet for your family. The school does not collect any of it. Also enclosed: the year-end Family Survey, which IS returned, anonymously. Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year. Book Five awaits in Grades 11–12. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

4.7.C

Family Grace Guide

Optional take-home guide for families wanting to extend the Architecture of Grace practice into their home. Distribute at the start of Unit 4. This guide is not a worksheet and is not collected. It is a reference.

WHAT THIS GUIDE IS · AND IS NOT

This guide is a reference for adults in the home of a 9th or 10th grader. It is not a worksheet, not an assignment, and not something the school collects. Your child does not need to know you are reading it. At this developmental moment, adolescents learn very little from being lectured at. They learn enormously from what they overhear when they are not the topic of conversation. The single most useful thing you can do with the curriculum vocabulary is take it into your OWN life, out loud, where they happen to hear it. When you notice your own Curated Self performing for a colleague, name it. When you set a Boundary of Peace with a difficult relative, name it. When you choose Charitable Interpretation in traffic, narrate the choice. They are listening.

SIX THINGS THAT HELP · SIX THAT HURT

WHAT HELPS

- Modelling out loud, on yourself. The Internal Critic is not their problem; it is everyone's. When yours speaks up, name it: "That was my Internal Critic. The Compassionate Witness would say something different."
- Letting them come to you. 9th and 10th graders rarely process at the dinner table. They process in the car, late at night, sideways, in a passing comment. Be there. Don't pursue.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FAÇADE (9-10)

- Repair when you mess up. When you snap, when you get it wrong, when you raise your voice — circle back. Name the impact, not just the intent. Adolescents who see their parents repair learn that repair is possible. This is the most powerful single intervention available to you.
- Charitable Interpretation, in the kitchen. Out loud. Without making a point of it. The driver, the cousin, the news story, the cashier — take the most generous reading available. Your child is calibrating their own defaults to yours.
- Distinguishing forgiveness from reconciliation. They learned this in Unit 3 and it is the most useful single distinction in the curriculum. Forgiving someone is not the same as letting them back in. You can model this with your own difficult relatives, ex-friends, ex-bosses — out loud.
- Knowing when not to talk. Sometimes the most loving response to a 14-year-old is silence and proximity. A car ride, a kitchen counter, a long walk. The point is not to extract the conversation. The point is to be present when they are ready.

WHAT HURTS

- Lecturing. Especially right after a difficult moment. The lesson does not land. The lecture lands.
- Bringing up old mistakes as ammunition. Once a thing is repaired, it is repaired. Reaching back for it is a betrayal of the repair.
- Treating their feelings as a problem to solve. The goal is not to fix the feeling. The goal is to be in the room while they have it.
- Public humiliation, even mild. Especially in front of siblings, friends, or relatives. The cost is far higher than the moment seems to warrant.
- Requiring forgiveness. The curriculum is explicit. Nobody is required to forgive anyone, on any timeline, on demand.
- Surveilling their digital life as a default. There is occasional safety justification for it. There is no everyday justification for it. Trust, once broken on the privacy axis, takes years to rebuild.

CONVERSATION STARTERS • UNIT BY UNIT

Use these only when the conversation is wanted. If your adolescent does not want to talk, the right move is not to talk. The vocabulary is doing its work whether you discuss it or not.

UNIT 1 • THE CURATED SELF

- "Where in your life do you feel most curated? Where do you feel most yourself?"
- "Who in your life lets you take the curated self off?"
- "What's in your Identity Shield that you'd be okay sharing with me?"

UNIT 2 • RESILIENCE THROUGH SELF-KINDNESS

- "What does your Internal Critic sound like when it's loudest? When is it quietest?"
- "Is there something you put down in the Backpack Audit that you'd be willing to tell me about?"
- "Where in your life are you actually striving, and where are you just being a perfectionist?"

UNIT 3 · CONFLICT & CONTEXT

- “Have you forgiven anyone you don’t want to be in close relationship with anymore?”
- “What’s a Boundary of Peace you’ve set this year that you’re proud of?”
- “What does Calling In look like for you, when you have to do it?”

UNIT 4 · COMMUNITY & LEGACY

- “What did you choose for your Grace Challenge? Why that?”
- “Where in our community is there a Grace Gap nobody is filling?”
- “What did your class decide to leave for the cohort behind you, in the Class Legacy?”

ONE LAST THING

You will not parent this stage perfectly. Neither will we teach it perfectly. The curriculum is not designed to remove the difficulty of being 14 or 15. It is designed to give your child a working vocabulary for the difficulty. You giving them the same vocabulary at home — not by quizzing them, but by living in it yourself — is the entire point.

4.7.D

The Family Grace Audit

A private family self-reflection tool — Grades 9–10 Edition. Not a test, not a judgment, not something anyone else will see. Complete it once at the start of the school year, once at the end. The comparison is the insight.

TEACHER NOTE · HOW TO DISTRIBUTE THIS AUDIT

Print Sections 4.7.D through 4.7.F as a single packet (the Audit, the Final Reflection, and the Closing Words to Families). Send the packet home twice in the school year: · Year-Start: with the Pre-Year Family Letter (Section 4.7.A), at least 10 school days before Unit 1 Lesson 1. Families complete Parts 1, 2, and 3. · Year-End: with the End-of-Year Letter (Section 4.7.B, Letter 4), after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Families complete Part 4 and the Final Reflection. Do not collect. The audit is private. Never ask a family if they completed it. Never ask what they wrote. Translate where feasible. Coordinate with the building’s ELL liaison.

HOW TO USE THIS AUDIT

This audit is for the adults in the home. Your adolescent does not need to fill it out with you, see it, know it exists, or be asked about it. It is a quiet, honest look at the grace practices already living in your house — and an honest look at where there is room to grow. The vocabulary below comes directly from your child’s classroom: the Curated Self, the Social Battery, the Integrity Anchor, the Identity Shield, the Compassionate Witness, the Internal Critic, the Backpack, Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation, the Boundary of Peace, Calling In vs. Calling Out, Charitable Interpretation, Grace Culture. Use these terms at home. Adolescents are deeply attuned to which adults around them speak the language they are learning. Take twenty minutes. Be honest. No one but your family will ever read this.

RECORD

(OPTIONAL)

START OF YEAR

END OF YEAR

9 · 10

PART 1 · THE GRACE CLIMATE IN OUR HOME

Rate your household honestly on each item below. Check the number that fits best. 1 = not yet / rarely · 5 = consistently / naturally.

THE CURATED SELF & THE AUTHENTIC SELF

Adults in our home are honest about the difference between our Curated Self (the version we present to colleagues, neighbours, social media) and our actual interior life. Our adolescent has heard us name the gap.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Our adolescent has at least one adult in this house in front of whom they can take the Curated Self off entirely.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

We do not require our adolescent to perform the Curated Version of themselves for relatives, family events, or our own social comfort.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

THE COMPASSIONATE WITNESS & THE INTERNAL CRITIC

Adults in our home name the Internal Critic out loud when it shows up in their own self-talk.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

When our adolescent is harsh with themselves, we know how to name it without lecturing — and how to drop it after.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

We can tell the difference between healthy striving and the Internal Critic in disguise. We do not respond to a perfectionist child by demanding more, or to a struggling child by demanding less.

1 2 3 4 5
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

THE BACKPACK & SUSTAINABLE ACCOUNTABILITY

When someone in our family makes a real mistake, we move them toward repair, not toward shame. We can tell the difference between guilt (about behaviour) and shame (about identity) — in practice, not just in theory.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Adults in our home model their own accountability out loud. When we mess up, our adolescent hears us repair — not just regret.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We do not bring up resolved mistakes as ammunition in new arguments. When a thing is repaired, it is repaired.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FORGIVENESS, RECONCILIATION, & THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE

We understand that forgiveness and reconciliation are different processes. We do not require either of one another.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We can set a Boundary of Peace without framing it as punishment. Our adolescent has seen a grown-up do this in real life, on someone other than themselves.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We do not require our adolescent to forgive someone who is currently still hurting them — including ourselves.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

CALLING IN, CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION, & GRACE CULTURE

When we have to address something difficult with someone, we know the difference between Calling In (inviting accountability) and Calling Out (performing righteousness). Our adolescent has watched us do the harder one.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We practise charitable interpretation out loud in everyday situations, even when no point is being made for the children's benefit.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We extend grace to people outside our family — in traffic, at the store, with difficult relatives. Our adolescent sees this regularly.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
We understand mercy as a strength, not a weakness — the choice not to use a power we have.	1	2	3	4	5
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART 2 • REFLECTION QUESTIONS

These questions are not scored. Write freely — or talk through them as adults in the home, without your adolescent present. There are no right answers.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

WHERE DOES GRACE ALREADY SHOW UP MOST NATURALLY IN OUR HOME? WHAT DOES IT LOOK LIKE, IN A REAL MOMENT FROM THIS PAST MONTH?

WHERE DOES GRACE BREAK DOWN IN OUR FAMILY? WHAT SEEMS TO SET IT OFF — TIME OF DAY, CERTAIN TOPICS, CERTAIN PEOPLE, OUR OWN DEPLETION?

WHERE IN OUR OWN LIVES ARE WE WEARING A CURATED SELF WE DON'T WANT OUR CHILD TO INHERIT? YOU DON'T HAVE TO SHARE THIS ANSWER WITH ANYONE — JUST WRITE IT HONESTLY.

WHAT DOES THE INTERNAL CRITIC SOUND LIKE IN YOUR HEAD? WHAT DOES OUR ADOLESCENT HEAR FROM US, IN MOMENTS WHEN WE ARE HARD ON OURSELVES?

WHAT IS ONE THING YOU WANT YOUR ADOLESCENT TO HAVE ABSORBED ABOUT GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR SELF-COMPASSION BEFORE THEY LEAVE YOUR HOUSE?

IS THERE SOMEONE IN YOUR FAMILY'S STORY — PAST OR PRESENT — WHO IS HARD TO EXTEND GRACE TO? YOU DON'T HAVE TO NAME THEM. JUST NOTICE WHETHER THEY'RE THERE.

PART 3 · FAMILY COMMITMENTS

Choose one or two things your family wants to practise this year. These are not assignments — they are intentions.

WE COMMIT TO—

WE COMMIT TO—

FOR EXAMPLE: "THAT SOUNDED LIKE THE INTERNAL CRITIC." OR "WHAT'S THE MOST GENEROUS READING HERE?" OR "THAT'S A BOUNDARY OF PEACE, NOT A PUNISHMENT."

FOR EXAMPLE: BRINGING UP RESOLVED MISTAKES, LECTURING RIGHT AFTER A DIFFICULT MOMENT, REQUIRING OUR ADOLESCENT TO PERFORM THE CURATED SELF FOR RELATIVES, OR COMPARING THEM TO A SIBLING, COUSIN, OR EARLIER VERSION OF THEMSELVES.

PART 4 · END-OF-YEAR REVIEW

Complete this section at the end of the school year, after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Compare your answers to Parts 1 and 2.

WHAT SHIFTED IN OUR HOME THIS YEAR — EVEN SLIGHTLY — AROUND GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR SELF-COMPASSION?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

WAS THERE A MOMENT THIS YEAR WHEN SOMEONE IN OUR FAMILY CHOSE GRACE WHEN THEY DIDN'T HAVE TO? TELL THE STORY IN THREE SENTENCES.

RETURN TO PART 1 AND RE-RATE EACH ITEM WITHOUT LOOKING AT YOUR ORIGINAL ANSWERS FIRST. THEN COMPARE. WHERE DID WE GROW? WHERE ARE WE STILL WORKING?

ONE THING OUR FAMILY WILL KEEP PRACTISING INTO NEXT YEAR, INTO BOOK FIVE, INTO THE REST OF HIGH SCHOOL.

PRIVATE · KEEP IT IN THE HOUSE

This audit belongs to your family. The school does not collect it. The teacher does not ask about it. No one ever sees it but you. Keep it somewhere you can find it again — a kitchen drawer, the inside cover of a book — and return to it. School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Grades 9–10.

4.7.E

The Family Grace Audit — Final Reflection

As Book 4 closes — after the Year-End Celebration in Unit 4 Lesson 7 — sit down as adults in the home and answer these three questions. You do not need a therapist. You do not need a curriculum. You need an honest conversation and thirty minutes.

WHAT WEIGHT DID WE HELP EACH OTHER PUT DOWN THIS YEAR? YOUR CHILD COMPLETED THE BACKPACK AUDIT IN UNIT 2 — A STRUCTURED INVENTORY OF WHAT THEY WERE STILL CARRYING AND WHAT THEY WERE CHOOSING TO PUT DOWN. AS A FAMILY, WHAT DID WE PUT DOWN THIS YEAR? WHAT DID WE CHOOSE, FINALLY, TO STOP CARRYING?

WHEN WAS A TIME WE CHOSE GRACE WHEN WE DIDN'T HAVE TO? IN OUR FAMILY, IN OUR COMMUNITY, IN THE WORLD. EVEN A SMALL MOMENT COUNTS. ESPECIALLY A SMALL ONE.

WHAT CYCLE — OF SHAME, OF UNFORGIVENESS, OF PERFECTIONISM, OF COMPARISON, OF CONTEMPT — ARE WE CHOOSING TO END WITH THIS GENERATION? NAME IT. THEN DECIDE TOGETHER: IS THIS WHERE IT STOPS?

4.7.F

Closing Words to Families

Reproduce on letterhead and send home with the year-end packet, or read aloud at the Year-End Celebration in Unit 4 Lesson 7.

THE FAÇADE COMES OFF — AND THE INTERIOR REMAINS.

Every lesson, every conversation, every moment of grace your child has practised this year has added a stone to the structure being built inside them. They leave Book 4 with something most adolescents at this age were never given: a working internal vocabulary for the most socially demanding season of their life so

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

far. They can now distinguish the Curated Self from the Authentic Self, the Internal Critic from the Compassionate Witness, forgiveness from reconciliation, a Boundary of Peace from a punishment, Calling In from Calling Out, and grace from anything that has to be earned.

They will not do any of this perfectly. Neither will you. Neither will any of us. But they have been given the language and the practice — early, while it can still take root — for naming what is happening inside them, for choosing the Compassionate Witness over the Internal Critic, for repairing what they break, for forgiving what they choose to forgive, and for refusing to forgive what is still hurting them.

That foundation matters. The work you do at home — not by lecturing them, but by speaking the same vocabulary in your own life — is where it gets built into them for keeps. Your child is becoming the person they are going to be. The Architecture of Grace is the language they will use to do it.

You are the primary architect of your child's heart. The classroom is a partner. You are the foundation. The Façade comes off, eventually — and the Interior remains.

Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year. Book Five awaits in Grades 11–12. Go build something worth living in. School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Grades 9–10

4.7.G

Administrative Forms · Master Set

PPRA Parental Notification · Student Opt-Out Request · District Implementation Checklist · Grades 9–10 Edition. Reproduce freely on school letterhead. All three documents must be on file before instruction begins in any federally funded school.

APPENDIX A — PPRA PARENTAL NOTIFICATION LETTER

Reproduce on school letterhead. Mail or email to all families at least 10 calendar days before Unit 1 Lesson 1. (See also the Pre-Year Family Letter in Section 4.7.A; this version is the formal year-start compliance letter, distributed alongside the warmer family letter.)

Date: _____

To: Parent / Guardian of: _____

From: _____

RE: NOTICE OF SUPPLEMENTAL CURRICULUM — ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE, BOOK 4, GRADES 9–10

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Our school will soon begin the Architecture of Grace social-emotional learning curriculum for Grades 9–10. To comply with the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA, 20 U.S.C. § 1232h), we are notifying you in advance that this curriculum includes activities that invite high-school students to explore personal beliefs and emotional responses through journal writing, structured discussion, and small voluntary actions. ┘

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

PPRA-DESIGNATED LESSONS IN BOOK 4 · GRADES 9–10

The following lessons are specifically designated as PPRA-triggering. Risk markers (★ / ★★) indicate counselor-coverage requirements:

- Beyond the Brand (Unit 1, Lesson 1 · ★ PPRA) — students examine the gap between the curated self and the authentic self.
- The Social Battery (Unit 1, Lesson 2 · ★ PPRA) — students reflect on patterns of social capacity and depletion.
- The Perfectionism Weight (Unit 2, Lesson 1 · ★ PPRA) — students examine internalized perfectionism.
- Sustainable Accountability (Unit 2, Lesson 3 · ★ PPRA) — students work with accountability without self-punishment.
- The Compassionate Witness (Unit 2, Lesson 6 · ★ PPRA) — students develop the corrective voice to the Internal Critic.
- The Backpack Audit (Unit 2, Lesson 7 · ★★ Counselor Required) — structured inventory of carried weight. Counselor on-site for the full lesson.
- Forgiveness vs. Reconciliation (Unit 3, Lesson 2 · ★ PPRA) — structured discussion of distinguishing forgiveness from continued relationship with someone who has caused harm.
- The Boundary of Peace (Unit 3, Lesson 3 · ★ PPRA) — students work with limits set from self-respect.
- Contextual Empathy (Unit 3, Lesson 5 · ★ PPRA) — students hold the difference between understanding and excusing.

YOUR RIGHTS UNDER PPRA

- You have the right to inspect curriculum materials before they are taught. A physical copy of Book 4 is available in the school office within 5 school days of any request.
- You have the right to opt your child out of specific activities, specific lessons, or the full programme. No academic penalty will result.
- For each lesson designated as PPRA-protected, you will receive a separate lesson-specific notification at least 10 calendar days in advance.
- To exercise opt-out rights, complete the Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) and return it to the school office. Every student also has access to a Reflection Pass on every lesson day — an in-classroom opt-out for any specific activity.

If you have questions, please contact:

School Counselor: _____

Principal / Administrator: _____

Phone / Email: _____

PPRA NOTICE · GRADES 9–10 EDITION

This notice is required under federal law for all schools receiving federal funding. Retain a copy of this letter and all returned Opt-Out Forms in the school's administrative records.

APPENDIX B — STUDENT OPT-OUT REQUEST FORM

Complete and return to the school office. Do not submit to the classroom teacher. A copy will be filed in the school's administrative records — not in the student's academic file. Grades 9–10 Edition.

Student Name: _____

Grade • Teacher: _____

Date of Request: _____

OPT-OUT TYPE • SELECT ONE

☐ **TIER 1 — Curricular Inquiry Only.** I would like to review curriculum materials before making an opt-out decision.

☐ **TIER 2 — Selective Activity Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the following specific activities or PPRA-flagged lessons. My child will remain in the classroom and receive an alternative activity during opted-out segments.

Activities or lessons opted out of: _____

(continued): _____

☐ **TIER 3 — Full Programme Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the entire Architecture of Grace SEL programme for this school year. My child will be relocated to a supervised alternative setting during the SEL block. No academic penalty will result.

ALTERNATIVE PLACEMENT • TIER 2 OR 3 ONLY

☐ Library

☐ Counselor's office

☐ Designated alternative classroom

Parent / Guardian Printed Name: _____

Parent / Guardian Signature • Date: _____

Phone / Email for Follow-Up: _____

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

Received by • Date Received: _____

Alternative placement arranged: _____

Copy filed in administrative records • Initials: _____

APPENDIX C — DISTRICT IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

To be completed and signed by the designated district administrator before instruction begins. Retain in the district's curriculum adoption file. Grades 9–10 Edition.

District Name: _____

School Name: _____

Grade Level • Academic Year: _____

Designated Administrator: _____

PRE-IMPLEMENTATION COMPLIANCE ITEMS

- ☐ **PPRA Notice.** Year-start parental notification letter (Appendix A) and the Pre-Year Family Letter (Section 4.7.A) mailed or emailed to all families at least 10 calendar days prior to Unit 1 Lesson 1.
- ☐ **Lesson-Specific PPRA Notices.** Lesson-specific PPRA notification template prepared and scheduled for each ★ and ★★ lesson, to be sent 10 calendar days before each.
- ☐ **Curriculum Inspection.** Physical copy of Book 4 available in the school office, with a 5-school-day turnaround commitment for any family review request.
- ☐ **Clinical Review.** School Psychologist or Counselor has reviewed Units 2 and 3 in full and confirmed clinical readiness in writing — with particular attention to U2 L7 (The Backpack Audit), the ★★ Counselor Required lesson.
- ☐ **Counselor Calendar.** Full Counselor Integration Calendar (Section 4.5) reviewed and counselor on-site coverage confirmed for U2 L7. No exceptions, no substitutes.
- ☐ **Reflection Pass System.** Reflection Pass cards prepared and available in every classroom; teachers briefed on the no-explanation, no-penalty opt-out for any specific activity.
- ☐ **Staff Training.** All delivering teachers have completed the Disclosure Protocol training (Section 4.4) and the Type 4 Mandatory Reporting module.
- ☐ **Re-Entry Protocol.** School Counselor and classroom teachers have reviewed and acknowledged the Post-Disclosure Re-Entry Protocol.
- ☐ **Journal Privacy.** The journal-as-private-instructional-material rule has been communicated in classroom procedures and acknowledged by teachers in writing.
- ☐ **Opt-Out Process.** Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) is available in the school office and designated staff are trained to receive and process requests.
- ☐ **Legal Review.** District legal counsel or designated administrator has reviewed Section 4.4 (Legal & Clinical Compliance) and confirmed adoption readiness.
- ☐ **Secular Documentation.** The secular nature of the curriculum was explicitly considered and documented at the time of board adoption.

ADMINISTRATOR CERTIFICATION

I certify that the above compliance items have been completed prior to the delivery of the Architecture of Grace, Book 4, Grades 9–10 curriculum in our school / district.

Administrator Signature: _____

Printed Name and Title: _____

Date: _____

DISTRICT FILE · GRADES 9–10 COMPLIANCE EDITION

School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Book 4: The Façade · Grades 9–10 · Legal & Clinical Compliance Edition. Consult your district's legal counsel with jurisdiction-specific compliance questions.

4.8 Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary

Anchor Chart A persistent visual reference, drawn before class and posted all year. Anchors a key concept in the room itself.

Authentic Self The self as it actually is — internal, unfiltered, contextual. Not opposed to the curated self; in conversation with it.

Backpack The cumulative weight of internalized labels, wounds, and self-narratives a student carries. The Backpack Audit asks: what am I still carrying, and what am I choosing to put down?

CASEL Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning. The framework Architecture of Grace is aligned to.

Class Legacy The collective artifact of the Book 4 Unit 4 capstone — what this specific class chose to leave for the cohort behind them.

Compass of Integrity The Book 5 Unit 1 capstone artifact. Names the student's Moral North Star, values-behavior gap, examined values, and emerging values.

Compassionate Witness The internal voice that observes interior states with accuracy and without judgment. Counterpart and corrective to the Internal Critic.

Curated Self The self as presented for an audience — filtered, selected, performance-aware. Not synonymous with dishonesty; performance is human.

Disclosure Any moment in which a student names personal experience that exceeds ordinary classroom share. The curriculum explicitly anticipates disclosure and provides a 6-Step Protocol.

Equity Alert A flagged content moment in which equity-specific framing is required. Not optional. Delivered as written, not as footnote.

Forgiveness · Reconciliation Two separate processes. Forgiveness is internal — a release of resentment that requires only the forgiver's choice. Reconciliation is relational — restoration of trust that requires the other party's participation. Either is available without the other.

Grace A chosen, practiced, deliberate act — not a sentiment, not a disposition. The willingness to extend more than is owed.

Grace Gap The space between what a person needs and what is being offered them. Generosity is grace gap-aware: it offers what is missing rather than what has already been provided.

Graduation of the Heart The highest-risk lesson in the K–12 curriculum (Book 5 Unit 3 Lesson 7).

Transcendent forgiveness — the forgiveness offered when the weight of carrying it is destroying something in the carrier.

Identity Shield The Book 4 Unit 1 capstone artifact. Four-quadrant exercise: core values, authentic strengths, non-negotiables, and the adult I am becoming.

In-Lesson Scan A behavioral observation prompt embedded inline at the activity it monitors. Teacher notes privately. Does not intervene publicly.

Internal Critic The internalized self-judging voice. Distinct from genuine accountability. The Compassionate Witness is its corrective.

Living Amend An ongoing changed pattern of behavior that constitutes the actual repair after harm — distinct from an apology, which is verbal.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

PPRA Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment. Federal statute requiring parental notification before any psychological self-examination activity. Eight Architecture of Grace lessons in this book are PPRA-designated.

Reflection Pass A small physical card available to every student, every lesson. Allows the student to opt out of a specific activity without explanation, without penalty.

Scenario Card A short, structured fictional scenario followed by discussion questions and a closing concept. Two cards per lesson. Cards never require students to share personal content.

Worksheet A reproducible student artifact, embedded at the end of distributing lessons. Never collected unless student chooses.

SECTION FIVE

Professional Development

Half-Day Pre-Year Module · Mid-Year 90-Minute Session · Grades 9–10

Facilitator Guide for Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, and School Counselors

5.1 Professional Development Overview

Architecture of Grace · The Façade requires two professional development sessions during the implementation year: a half-day pre-year module before Lesson 1, and a 90-minute mid-year session after Unit 2 closes. Both are structural to the curriculum — not optional add-ons. Teachers carrying 9–10 material need a room that holds them the way they are asked to hold their students.

Each session is designed to be delivered by a building principal, instructional coach, or school counselor — not only by the curriculum author. A prepared non-expert can run these days. Everything required is in this section. Read it fully before the session. Deliver it with presence.

TWO-SESSION STRUCTURE

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year	Establish theoretical foundation, trauma-informed posture, in-the-moment disclosure protocol, live lesson experience, Teacher Reflection habit, shared vocabulary	Before Unit 1 Lesson 1 (August)
5.3 Mid-Year 90 Min	Implementation debrief, disclosure protocol recalibration, teacher wellbeing, preparation for Unit 3's harder content	Within 2 weeks of Unit 2 close (December) · Must precede U3 L2

A NOTE ON TONE

Neither session is a compliance check. They are the threshold between teachers reading the curriculum and teachers being able to deliver it with the presence the work requires. Set that tone from the opening.

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year Module

3 hours 30 minutes (plus optional 30-minute extended Q&A) · Six blocks · Delivered before Lesson 1 of Unit 1

AUDIENCE	Classroom teachers (Grades 9–10) who will deliver Architecture of Grace · The Façade. School counselors and instructional coaches may attend. Administrators are welcome but should participate as learners, not evaluators.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor. No prior SEL expertise required; preparation and presence are the requirements.
PREPARATION	Read this full PD module at least 48 hours in advance. Read the Teacher Implementation Guide in full. Complete Block 5 (Teacher Reflection) personally before the day — you will model a real response, not a hypothetical one.
MATERIALS	Participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section, one per teacher) · Chart paper and markers · Printed or projected slide outline (5.4) · Journal or index cards for Block 5 · Timer visible to facilitator

BLOCK SEQUENCE

1	The Theoretical Framework — Why This Curriculum Exists	45 min
2	Trauma-Informed Delivery — Holding the Room	45 min
3	Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice	30 min
4	Live Lesson Model — U2 L1 — The Perfectionism Weight	45 min
5	Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice	30 min
6	Glossary Orientation & Q&A	15 min

5.2 · BLOCK 1 (45 MINUTES)**BLOCK 1**

The Theoretical Framework

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9-10)

Facilitator purpose: Teachers must understand the "why" before they can deliver the "what." This block builds the research foundation and establishes that the curriculum is serious work with a serious evidence base — not a feel-good add-on.

SHAME VS. GUILT RESEARCH (15 MIN)

Open with this: "Before we talk about the curriculum, I want to start with a question. Think of the last time you made a mistake at work — something you genuinely regret. Don't share it. Just hold it. Now notice: what are you feeling right now? Is it about what you did, or about who you are?" Allow 60 seconds of silence. Then: "That distinction is the heart of this curriculum."

Present the research base. Brené Brown's decade of grounded theory research established that shame — the belief that "I am bad" — is correlated with depression, anxiety, addiction, aggression, and eating disorders, and is negatively correlated with empathy, courage, and connection. Guilt — the belief that "I did something bad" — is correlated with positive outcomes including repair behavior, accountability, and prosocial action (Brown, 2010; Tangney, Stuewig & Mashek, 2007). This is not intuitive. Many adults operate with the assumption that shame is a useful motivator. The research says the opposite: shame produces hiding, not repair.

Classroom implication. When a teacher says "you should be ashamed of yourself," they are activating a neurological threat response that shuts down the learning brain and produces aggression or withdrawal — not reflection. When a teacher activates the repair pathway instead — using the curriculum's grade-band-appropriate framing — students learn to do the same for themselves. This curriculum teaches children to hold their own mistakes that way. Ask teachers: "What language did the adults in your life use when you made mistakes? How did it land?" Allow 2 minutes of pair-share.

SELF-COMPASSION SCIENCE (15 MIN)

Kristin Neff's foundational work defines self-compassion as composed of three elements: self-kindness (treating oneself with the care one would offer a good friend), common humanity (recognizing that imperfection and suffering are universal human experiences, not personal failures), and mindfulness (holding painful thoughts and feelings in balanced awareness rather than suppressing or over-identifying with them). Self-compassion is not self-esteem. Self-esteem is contingent on performance and comparison; self-compassion is unconditional. Research shows self-compassion is associated with greater emotional resilience, less anxiety and depression, more motivation after failure, and healthier coping behaviors (Neff, 2011).

FACILITATOR NOTE

Many teachers will have a visceral resistance to self-compassion as a concept. They may have been raised to believe that self-criticism is the engine of improvement. Name this directly: "If your instinct is that self-compassion sounds soft or indulgent — that is a normal and common reaction, and the research will surprise you. Self-compassion is associated with higher standards and more persistence after failure, not lower ones. The internal critic does not make us better. It makes us more afraid."

FORGIVENESS EDUCATION RESEARCH BASE (15 MIN)

Robert Enright and Richard Fitzgibbons established the empirical basis for forgiveness as a teachable, developmental skill. Their research across 35 years and multiple populations demonstrates that forgiveness interventions produce measurable reductions in anxiety, depression, and anger, and improvements in hope and self-esteem. Critically, their model defines forgiveness as a gift the forgiver gives themselves — not a transaction, not reconciliation, and not condoning harmful behavior. This distinction is foundational to the curriculum’s treatment of forgiveness in Units 2, 3, and 4.

Everett Worthington’s REACH model of forgiveness offers a complementary process-oriented framework. Where Enright and Fitzgibbons define the destination of forgiveness, Worthington’s REACH model describes the path. The five steps — Recall the hurt without rumination, Empathize with the one who caused it, offer Altruistic gift of forgiveness, Commit to the forgiveness, and Hold onto it against doubt — provide a process map. The model’s emphasis on empathy as a bridge to forgiveness (not a requirement for it) is directly consistent with the curriculum’s Unit 3 architecture.

REFERENCES FOR FURTHER READING

Brown, B. (2010). *The Gifts of Imperfection*. Hazelden. Tangney, J. P., Stuewig, J., & Mashek, D. J. (2007). Moral emotions and moral behavior. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 58, 345–372. Neff, K. (2011). Self-Compassion: The Proven Power of Being Kind to Yourself. William Morrow. Enright, R., & Fitzgibbons, R. (2015). *Forgiveness Therapy*. American Psychological Association. Worthington, E. L. (2006). *Forgiveness and Reconciliation: Theory and Application*. Routledge.

WHY THIS RESEARCH MATTERS AT GRADES 9–10

Mid-adolescence is when the curated self vs. the genuine self becomes the central developmental task. Students at 14–16 are aware that they perform identities for different audiences, and they often feel the gap as a personal failing. The curriculum reframes that gap: the awareness itself is the developmental achievement, and the work is to integrate, not to choose. Brown’s research on shame is most concentrated at this age in relation to performance, social media, and the gap between curated and genuine identity. The Façade grade band’s signature contribution is naming perfectionism as a felt weight (U2 L1) rather than a personality trait — a reframe that is decades ahead of when most adults receive it.

FACILITATOR CLOSING FOR BLOCK 1

“We are not teaching children to be nice. We are teaching them a set of internal skills that the research says are foundational to mental health, academic engagement, and the capacity to build and repair relationships across a lifetime. That is what you are being asked to deliver. Let’s talk about how.”

5.2 • BLOCK 2 (45 MINUTES)**BLOCK 2****Trauma-Informed Delivery**

Facilitator purpose: This block addresses the emotional reality of teaching this curriculum. Teachers will face activated students, and they will encounter their own material. Prepare them for both.

WHEN CONTENT ACTIVATES STUDENTS (20 MIN)

This curriculum works with real emotional material. Students will sometimes respond to lessons with unexpected emotion — tears, silence, a sudden need to leave the room, or a disclosure that goes further than the classroom context can safely hold. This is not a failure of the curriculum or the teacher. It is evidence that the curriculum is reaching something real.

Distinguishing productive discomfort from acute distress. Productive discomfort is the feeling of sitting with a hard truth or a new idea. A student who is quiet and thoughtful after a difficult lesson is likely in productive discomfort. This is the learning state. Do not rescue students from it by rushing on. A student who is crying, hyperventilating, dissociating (staring blankly, unresponsive), or who makes a disclosure suggesting active trauma or safety concern is in acute distress. This requires immediate, calm response — not curriculum delivery. Pause. Move toward the student quietly. Use the 6-step disclosure protocol (see Block 3).

High school distress often arrives in code: flatness as a tell, performance as a defense, peer-disclosure as a way to test whether the adult can be trusted with one's own material. Take peer disclosures seriously — they are almost always also self-disclosures.

FACILITATOR EXERCISE · THREE 9–10 SCENARIOS

Present the three student scenarios below. Ask teachers to identify each as productive discomfort or acute distress, and to name their immediate response. The scenarios are calibrated to 9–10 developmental reality.

Scenario 1. During U1 L1 (Beyond the Brand), a student writes intensely, then closes their laptop and stares at the desk. When you pass by quietly, they don't look up but say, "This whole class is making me realize how much of my life is fake." They are calm, almost flat. **Scenario 2.** During U3 L4 (Calling In vs. Calling Out), a student deflects every personal-connection invitation by performing for the room — wisecracks, exaggerated agreement, theatrical engagement. Three other students start mirroring the performance. The lesson energy shifts. **Scenario 3.** A student stays after class and says, "This is going to sound weird but. My friend has been posting stuff about not wanting to be here anymore. They told me not to tell anyone. I don't know what to do." Debrief as a group. Identify which scenario(s) require counselor contact within the same day, which require private check-in after class, and which require staying present without intervening.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN MATERIAL (25 MIN)

Name this directly and early: "Some of you will sit in a lesson about shame and recognize a voice you carry. Some of you will read a self-compassion prompt and realize you have never written one to yourself. Some of you will encounter the forgiveness content and feel something shift — or feel something harden. This is your material. It is not a problem. It is actually a sign that you are the right person to teach this curriculum. But you need to know it's there before you stand in front of your class, not while you're standing there."

Facilitator exercise. Ask teachers to journal privately (not shared) for 5 minutes on this prompt: "Which unit or lesson in this curriculum do you anticipate will be hardest for you to deliver — and why?" After journaling, invite (do not require) 2–3 people to share at the level they are comfortable. Normalize that this curriculum surfaces real things. The Teacher Reflection box in each lesson exists for this reason — it is a private processing tool for the teacher, not a record for anyone else.

KEY MESSAGE

You do not need to be fully healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be aware. Awareness of your own material means you will not project it onto your students, rush past the hard parts, or deliver the lesson from behind a wall of professional distance. Presence — genuine, grounded presence — is the pedagogical method of this curriculum. You cannot fake it. You can practice it.

5.2 · BLOCK 3 (30 MINUTES)**BLOCK 3****Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice**

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to practice — not just read — the in-the-moment disclosure response. The role-play scenarios below are calibrated to 9–10 developmental reality. They use fictional student names. Do not use names from the curriculum's scenario cards.

THE 6-STEP IN-THE-MOMENT RESPONSE PROTOCOL (10 MIN)

1	Pause and move toward	Stop the lesson. Walk calmly toward the student. Do not draw attention from other students if possible. Give the class independent work: "Keep working in your journal — I'll be right back."
2	Acknowledge without probing	"I can see something is happening for you right now. You don't have to explain it." Do not ask "what's wrong?" — this requires the student to explain while still activated.
3	Offer a choice	"Would you like to step into the hall with me for a minute, or would you like to stay here and just breathe?" Give the student agency. Both choices are valid.
4	Listen and assess	If the student speaks, listen without judgment. Assess: is this a Type 1–3 personal share (emotional but contained) or a Type 4 active safety concern (ongoing harm, suicidal ideation, abuse)? If Type 4: proceed to Step 5 immediately.
5	Connect to counselor (Type 4)	"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay. Contact the counselor immediately.
6	Document and debrief yourself	After class: document what happened in your Teacher Reflection space. Debrief with the counselor or a trusted colleague. You carried something real. Put it down before your next class.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

ROLE-PLAY PRACTICE (20 MIN)

Run two scenarios in pairs. One teacher plays the teacher; one plays the student. Debrief after each. Rotate roles. Use only the fictional names below — do not use names from the curriculum scenario cards. The scenarios are calibrated to 9–10 reality.

SCENARIO A · TYPE 2 PERSONAL SHARE (MILD)

During the U2 L3 discussion of Sustainable Accountability, a 9th grader named Marcus says, "My dad says if I felt bad enough about my grades I'd actually study. I don't know what to do with that. I do feel bad. It doesn't help." The class goes quiet. **Practice.** How do you acknowledge Marcus, validate the contradiction he is naming, use the curriculum's vocabulary about productive guilt vs. shame without psychologizing the parent, and bring the class back to the lesson? **Debrief.** What did you say first? Did you stay in curriculum vocabulary, or did you slip into therapy language? Did you protect the parent's dignity while validating Marcus's experience?

SCENARIO B · TYPE 4 ACTIVE SAFETY CONCERN (SERIOUS)

A 10th grader named Sage shows you a draft of a college admissions essay during office hours. The essay is well-written and includes the line: "I have been planning what I would do if I didn't get into the school I want, and the plan does not involve being alive to see another year." Sage watches your face. **Practice.** Walk through the 6-step protocol live. What do you say first? How do you address the conditional language ("if I didn't get in") without dismissing the plan? How do you move Sage to the counselor without making it feel like a betrayal? What is your first sentence to the counselor? **Debrief.** Discuss as full group after both scenarios. Note specifically: high school students often disclose in writing they are submitting for evaluation. Read everything they hand you. The protocol does not change. **Key takeaway.** By high school, most students who disclose serious content have decided the adult is trustworthy before they speak. Honor that. Do not rush. Do not try to fix it in the hallway. Use the protocol. Your job is not to assess severity — your job is to act.

5.2 · BLOCK 4 (45 MINUTES)

BLOCK 4

Live Lesson Model — U2 L1 — The Perfectionism Weight

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to experience what this curriculum feels like from the student's seat before they deliver it. **Unit 2 Lesson 1** introduces the curriculum's signature 9–10 self-compassion construct — perfectionism as a felt, carried weight rather than a personality trait. It is the most concept-dense early lesson and PPRA-flagged. It is the clearest demonstration of the curriculum's pedagogical method for early high school. Teachers must experience this lesson from the student seat before delivering it.

SETUP (5 MIN)

Announce: "For the next 35 minutes, you are a 10th grader in this classroom. I am going to deliver this lesson to you. After we finish, we will debrief together as teachers. Your job right now is not to evaluate the lesson — it is to be in it. Notice what you feel, what questions arise, and what you want to know that the lesson doesn't answer."

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

DELIVER U2 L1 IN FULL (35 MIN)

Use the lesson plan from Section 2 (The Lessons) — The Perfectionism Weight of this master document. Deliver at Grade 10 level. Use the lesson plan from Section 2 as written. Include the journaling activity, the weight-mapping reflection, and the exit ticket sentence frames. The Curated Self construct from Unit 1 should be referenced as foundation — perfectionism is what holds the curated self in place. The facilitator should deliver this with genuine presence — not as a demonstration of “how it’s done” but as an actual lesson. If something lands unexpectedly in the room, stay with it.

DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Return to teacher mode. Ask three questions:

- What did you notice in yourself during the lesson?
- What questions did the lesson raise for you that you’d want answered before teaching it?
- What moment in the lesson do you think would land hardest for your students — and what would you do?

Take 2–3 responses per question. These responses are the curriculum’s best preparation. Write the unanswered questions on chart paper. Answer them now if you can. If you cannot, acknowledge them honestly: “That’s a real question. Here’s how I’d navigate it.”

5.2 · BLOCK 5 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 5

Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice

Facilitator purpose: The Teacher Reflection box is the most important structural element in this curriculum for teacher sustainability. Introduce it as a habit before Day 1, not as an afterthought.

INTRODUCE THE TEACHER REFLECTION BOX (5 MIN)

Every lesson in this curriculum contains a Teacher Reflection prompt. It is not a form to be submitted, a record to be reviewed, or an accountability measure of any kind. It is a private processing tool for you, the teacher, after each lesson. It exists for one reason: this curriculum will do real work in you as you deliver it. If you have nowhere to put that work, it accumulates. Teachers who neglect their own reflection in emotionally demanding curricula burn out faster and deliver less effectively over time. The reflection box is your drain.

High school teachers often carry years of accumulated trust from students. That trust is the reason this curriculum can work, and it is also a load. The Reflection box is not optional. Five minutes after each lesson is professional infrastructure, not self-indulgence. With four PPRA-flagged lessons in Unit 2 alone, this grade band’s reflection load is real.

MODEL A REAL RESPONSE (10 MIN)

The facilitator shares their own Teacher Reflection response — written in advance, from a real experience with this material. Not a polished, professional response. A real one. This is non-negotiable. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable in their reflection practice if the facilitator is not willing to model it. The facilitator should have completed a reflection from Block 4’s live lesson delivery before reading it aloud.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

SAMPLE PROMPT

"What did this lesson surface for you personally? What are you still carrying from it?" Read your actual response. Sit with the silence after.

ESTABLISH THE HABIT (15 MIN)

Have each teacher write their first reflection now — from today's PD session.

REFLECTION PROMPT

"What from today do you most need to sit with before your first lesson? What do you already know about yourself that will help you deliver this curriculum? What do you not yet know?"

Allow 10 minutes of private writing. Do not collect. Do not ask for sharing. End with: "This is the habit. It takes 5 minutes after each lesson. It is the most important thing you can do to make sure you can keep delivering this curriculum at the level it deserves."

5.2 · BLOCK 6 (15 MINUTES)

BLOCK 6

Glossary Orientation & Q&A

Facilitator purpose: Every staff member who interacts with students must use the same vocabulary. Shared language is the infrastructure of this curriculum. This block is short but non-negotiable.

WALK THROUGH THE GLOSSARY (8 MIN)

Distribute the participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section). The one-pager contains the twelve most essential vocabulary terms — drawn from Section 4.8 (Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary). Walk through each term: define it, give a classroom example, and if there is a common misuse or confusion, name it.

THREE TERMS THAT REQUIRE SPECIAL ATTENTION AT GRADES 9–10

- "The Curated Self" — the central construct of the Façade grade band (introduced in U1 L1: Beyond the Brand). Every staff member who interacts with these students should be able to use the language: "that sounds like the curated self talking" / "what does the genuine self say underneath?" — without making it feel clinical.
- "Forgiveness" vs. "Reconciliation" — at high school, students often arrive having confused these. The curriculum is explicit (U3 L2 makes this the lesson): forgiveness is internal and requires nothing of the other person; reconciliation requires the other person's behavior change. They are not the same.
- "The Compassionate Witness" (U2 L6, PPRA) and "The Backpack" (U2 L7) — the central self-compassion vocabulary of this grade band. Use the metaphors as offered; do not improvise around them. The Backpack Audit is ★★ COUNSELOR REQUIRED for a reason.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

OPEN Q&A (7 MIN)

“What questions do you have that we haven’t answered today?” Take as many as time allows. Write unanswered questions on chart paper. Post them publicly. Tell teachers: “If a question came up today that you couldn’t resolve, it will come up in your classroom. That’s not a problem — it’s preparation. You now know to expect it.”

CLOSING WORDS

“You are ready. You don’t have to be perfect. You have to be present. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way.”

5.3 Mid-Year Professional Development Session

Facilitator Guide · 90 Minutes · Deliver After Unit 2 Closes (December)

TOTAL TIME	90 minutes (3 blocks · no break required)
AUDIENCE	All classroom teachers delivering Architecture of Grace · The Façade · Grades 9–10. School counselors welcome. Administrators participate as learners.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor who delivered the initial half-day PD. Read full guide 24 hours in advance.
TIMING	Deliver within 2 weeks of Unit 2 closing (December). Must precede U3 L2.
MATERIALS	Chart paper · markers · teacher journals or index cards · printed participant reference card · timer visible to facilitator
PURPOSE	Debrief implementation, recalibrate the disclosure protocol, surface teacher wellbeing concerns, and prepare teachers emotionally for Unit 3.

TONE-SETTING NOTE

This session is not a compliance check. It is a structural support. Teachers who have spent a full semester carrying emotionally weighted curriculum deserve a room that holds them the way they have been holding their students. Set that tone from the opening.

5.3 · BLOCK 1 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 1

Implementation Debrief

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have been delivering this curriculum for a full semester. Before you give them anything new, let them say what has actually happened.

OPENING (5 MIN)

Ask teachers to write privately for 3 minutes (not shared):

OPENING PROMPT

"Think of one moment from the last semester of delivering this curriculum that stayed with you after class. Not the lesson plan — the moment. What happened? What did you carry home?"

STRUCTURED DEBRIEF (20 MIN)

Post four questions on chart paper. One at a time, 4–5 minutes each. Facilitator listens and captures themes without evaluating.

- What has been working better than you expected? What surprised you about how students responded?
- What has been harder than you expected? What lesson or moment did you feel under-prepared for?
- What questions do you still have that the initial PD didn't answer?
- What are 2–3 students you are still thinking about from Units 1–2?

CAUTION

Do not let the fourth question become a student-deficit conversation. Redirect: "What does this student need from you going into Unit 3?" The question is about teacher action, not student pathology.

CLOSING THE DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Acknowledge the themes you heard without ranking them. Name anything that needs Block 2: "I heard several of you say disclosures happened differently than expected. We're going to spend the next block on exactly that."

5.3 · BLOCK 2 (35 MINUTES)

BLOCK 2

Disclosure Protocol Recalibration

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have now used the protocol in real conditions. This block connects it to what actually happened and prepares them for Unit 3's harder content.

PROTOCOL REVIEW FROM EXPERIENCE (15 MIN)

Distribute the participant reference card. Ask: "In the last semester, did anyone have a disclosure that required you to use this protocol? Which step was hardest in the moment?"

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

"I froze."	Normal. Step 1 is all you need: stop and move toward the student. Everything else follows from presence.
"I wasn't sure if it was Type 3 or 4."	When uncertain, treat as Type 4. Let the counselor assess. You are not required to assess accurately under pressure — you are required to act.
"The student said 'I'm fine' but I wasn't sure."	"I'm fine" after a significant disclosure is almost always protective. Follow up privately after class. Brief the counselor.
"Nothing came up for me."	Also valid. Some classrooms generate less activation. Unit 3 will change the frequency.

UNIT 3 PREPARATION — HIGH-RISK LESSONS (15 MIN)

U3 L2 · FORGIVENESS VS. RECONCILIATION

Some students in every classroom are in ongoing unsafe situations. This lesson may be the first time they hear clearly that they do not have to return to harm. Counselor on-site is mandatory. Before delivering U3 L2, identify 2–3 students you are watching. Know who they are before you walk in. U2 L7 — The Backpack Audit (★★ COUNSELOR REQUIRED) — the highest-risk lesson in the first half of the year — also requires counselor-on-site protocol. U3 L3 (The Boundary of Peace, ★ PPRA) and U3 L5 (Contextual Empathy, ★ PPRA) follow closely and should be flagged in your planning.

RE-PRACTICE: THE ONE SENTENCE THAT MATTERS (5 MIN)

Have teachers practice this sentence out loud with a partner — twice. It must be automatic under stress.

PRACTICE SENTENCE

"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now."

5.3 · BLOCK 3 (25 MINUTES)

BLOCK 3

Teacher Wellbeing & Entering Unit 3

Facilitator purpose: This is the most important block. Give teachers permission to care for themselves before Unit 3 begins. Name what the semester has cost them.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN REFLECTION (10 MIN)

This block begins with the facilitator modeling, not instructing. Read aloud — from your actual Teacher Reflection notes, not a prepared script — something this semester surfaced for you personally in relation to this curriculum.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

NON-NEGOTIABLE

If you have not kept Teacher Reflection notes, you must write something genuine before this session. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable if you are delivering this block from behind professional distance.

After your own reflection, give teachers 5 minutes to write privately:

PRIVATE REFLECTION PROMPT

“What has this curriculum surfaced in you personally that you have been carrying? What lesson hit closer to home than you expected? What have you been putting down after class that you haven’t named to anyone?”

TEACHER SUPPORT WEB (10 MIN)

Ask teachers to map their own support web on an index card — drawing from the same activity students did in U3 L7 — Unit Reflection: The Grace Audit.

- Who is on your support web right now?
- Have you actually used it this semester?
- Is there anything you’ve been carrying that you need to put down before Unit 3?

Before closing: “You taught your students that asking for support is wisdom, not weakness. The same is true for you. Identify one person on your support web you will contact before U3 L2 if you need to.”

CLOSING WORDS

“Your students are carrying something from this semester into Unit 3. So are you. That is not a problem — that is what this curriculum does. Go in with your eyes open, your counselor on speed dial, and the knowledge that what you have built in this room over the last five months is already changing things. Unit 3 begins next week. You are ready.”

5.4 Facilitator Slide Outline (Half-Day Module)

No design required. These headings translate directly to slides or chart paper. Add your school logo and colors as desired. The slide outline is calibrated to BOOK FOUR — The Façade (Grades 9–10).

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

1	Welcome + Opening Reflection	Opening reflection prompt (see Block 1). Why we're here. What this day is not (a compliance training).
2	Shame vs. Guilt: The Research	Brown (2010), Tangney et al. (2007). Shame = "I am bad." Guilt = "I did bad." Different neural pathways. Different behavioral outcomes. Pair-share.
3	Self-Compassion: Not What You Think	Neff (2011). Three elements. Not self-esteem. Research outcomes. Name the resistance — then address it.
4	Forgiveness Education: The Evidence Base	Enright & Fitzgibbons. What forgiveness is not (reconciliation, condoning, forgetting). What it produces in the research. Why it is teachable.
5	Holding the 9–10 Room: Productive Discomfort vs. Acute Distress	Three 9–10 scenario exercise. What is each? What is your response? Debrief.
6	Your Own Material	Private journal prompt. Optional share. You don't need to be healed. You need to be aware.
7	The 6-Step Disclosure Protocol	Display all 6 steps. Walk through. Do not rush this slide.
8	Role-Play: 9–10 Scenarios	Display scenario text. Pair practice. Full-group debrief. Key distinctions.
9	Live Lesson: U2 L1	The Perfectionism Weight delivered live. Close laptop. Be in the room.
10	Teacher Reflection: Your First Entry	Display the three reflection prompts. 10 minutes private writing. No collection. No share required. This is the habit.
11	Glossary Walk + Q&A	Refer to one-pager. 12 key terms. Special attention to the three identified for Grades 9–10. Open Q&A. Chart unanswered questions.
12	Closing: You Are Ready	"You don't have to be perfect. You have to be present." Distribute one-pager. Send teachers off.

5.5 Participant One-Pager

This single page is the teacher's take-home reference from the PD day. It contains the essential vocabulary and the disclosure protocol in compact form. Print one per teacher (Grades 9–10 edition). Laminate if possible.

12 ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY TERMS

Shame	"I am bad." Self-attack. Hides and harms.
Guilt	"I did something bad." Behavior-focused. Leads to repair.
Internal Critic	The shame voice. Attacks the person, not the behavior.
Compassionate Witness	The kind observer voice. Sees clearly without attacking.
Forgiveness	A gift to yourself. Not reconciliation. Not condoning. Not forgetting.
Grace Gap	Unearned kindness extended across a relational gap. A chosen act, not a reaction.
Self-Compassion	Treating yourself with the care you'd offer a good friend after a mistake.
Oops / Forever	Distinguishing a mistake (Oops) from a permanent identity statement (Forever).
Narrative Identity	The story a person tells about who they are, built from their experiences.
Charitable Interpretation	Choosing the most generous explanation for another's behavior.
Productive Discomfort	The learning edge. Sitting with a hard truth. Do not rescue students from it.
Community Charter	The class's year-end public commitment to grace practices. The culminating artifact.

IN-THE-MOMENT DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL (6 STEPS)

1. Pause. Move toward the student. Give class independent work.
2. "I can see something is happening. You don't have to explain it."
3. Offer a choice: hall or stay and breathe. Both are valid.
4. Listen. Assess: Type 1–3 (contained) or Type 4 (safety concern)?
5. Type 4: "Thank you for trusting me. I'm walking you to [counselor] now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay.
6. Document. Debrief with counselor or colleague. Put it down before your next class.

TEACHER REFLECTION HABIT

After every lesson: 5 minutes. Private. Not collected. Answer one of: What surfaced for me today? What did I want to rush past — and why? What do I want to carry forward?

CLOSING WORDS

"You don't need to be perfectly healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be present and aware. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way." **Architecture of Grace · The Façade · School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden**

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